MUST-SCORE FACTS

Ancient History

Consolidated Must-Score Facts and must-score drill cards for every chapter.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

Chapters

1. Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts
2. Topic 1 — Stone Age (Prehistoric India)
3. Topic 2 — Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)
4. Topic 3 — Vedic Civilization
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Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts

1. Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) Master Matrix

Site	Location / State	River	Excavator & Year	Key Unique Findings / Exam Triggers
Harappa	Sahiwal (Punjab, Pak)	**Ravi** (Left bank)	Daya Ram Sahni (1921)	6 granaries in 2 rows, Coffin burial (R-37 & H cemetery), Sandstone torso of nude male, Copper bullock cart
Mohenjodaro (*Mound of Dead*)	Larkana (Sindh, Pak)	**Indus** (Right bank)	R.D. Banerjee (1922)	**Great Bath**, **Great Granary** (largest building of Mohenjodaro), **Bronze Dancing Girl** (lost wax technique), Steatite Bearded Priest, Pashupati seal, Piece of woven cotton
Lothal	Ahmedabad (Gujarat)	**Bhogava**	S.R. Rao (1954/57)	**Tidal Dockyard** (artificial brick basin), Rice husk, Bead factory, Fire altars, Terracotta horse figurine, Persian gulf seal, Double burial (male-female)
Kalibangan (*Black Bangles*)	Hanumangarh (Rajasthan)	**Ghaggar** (ancient Saraswati)	A. Ghosh (1953), B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar	**Ploughed field surface** (furrows), Camel bones, Row of **7 fire altars**, Wooden drainage, Decorated floor tiles, Both citadel & lower town fortified
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)	**Indus**	N.G. Majumdar (1931), Mackay (1935)	**Only site without a citadel**, Bead-making factory, Lipstick/cosmetics, Inkpot, Imprint of dog's paw chasing a cat
Dholavira	Kutch (Gujarat) - Khadir Bet	Luni basin (Mansar & Manhar streams)	J.P. Joshi (1967), R.S. Bisht (1990)	**Three-tier city division** (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town), Giant **water reservoirs/dams**, Unique **10-symbol signboard**, Sports stadium; **UNESCO WHS (2021)**
Banawali	Fatehabad (Haryana)	Saraswati / Rangoi	R.S. Bisht (1974)	**Terracotta toy model of plough**, High quantity of good quality barley, Lack of systematic grid drainage
Rakhigarhi	Hisar (Haryana)	Ghaggar-Hakra	Amarendra Nath	**Largest Harappan site in India** (and overall after recent surveys)
Ropar (Roopnagar)	Punjab (India)	**Sutlej**	Y.D. Sharma (1953)	**Dog buried with human oval pit** (post-Harappan continuation), First site excavated after independence
Surkotada	Kutch (Gujarat)	Seasonal stream	J.P. Joshi (1964)	**Horse bone remains** (disputed), Pot burials, Oval citadel
Daimabad	Ahmednagar (Maharashtra)	**Pravara** (Godavari tributary)	B.P. Bopardikar	**Southernmost IVC site**, Bronze chariot with driver, Rhino, Elephant, Buffalo
Alamgirpur	Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)	**Hindon** (Yamuna tributary)	Y.D. Sharma (1958)	**Easternmost IVC site** in India; cloth impression on pottery; triangle–peacock–squirrel motifs. **Not** Rakhigarhi (Haryana = largest, not east).
Hulas	**Saharanpur** (UP; some lists tag the Baghpat belt)	Upper Ganga–Yamuna doab	**K.N. Dikshit** (ASI)	Eastern Harappan habitation: handmade + wheel-made pottery, chert blades, bone points. **UPPCS match: Hulas = Uttar Pradesh** (not Gujarat).
Mandi	**Muzaffarnagar** (UP; some lists Bijnor / Ramganga)	Doab	ASI	Late Harappan **jewellery / gold-hoard** find. **Mandi (UP) ≠ Manda (J&K)**. With Hulas, the usual UP pair that rejects **Rakhigarhi**.
Sanauli	**Baghpat** (Uttar Pradesh)	Yamuna basin	D.V. Sharma / ASI (**2018**)	About **125** graves, coffins, copper antenna swords, solid wooden-wheel **chariots**. Late Harappan / OCP — **not** a Mature grid-city with a Great Bath. Same district belt as Hulas lists, different period label.

Site	Location / State	River	Excavator & Year	Key Unique Findings / Exam Triggers
Bargaon / Ambakheri	**Saharanpur** (Uttar Pradesh)	Doab	ASI	Late Harappan / **OCP** belt of western UP (with Hastinapur, Lal Qila, Atranjikhera). Rural doab, not a citadel city.
Manda	Jammu & Kashmir	**Chenab**	J.P. Joshi (1982)	**Northernmost IVC site** in India. Trap: **Manda ≠ Mandi**.
Sutkagen Dor	Balochistan (Pak-Iran border)	**Dasht**	Aurel Stein (1927)	**Westernmost IVC site**, Coastal trading post between Harappa & Babylon
Kunal	Haryana	Saraswati	J.S. Khatri	2 silver crowns discovered
Balu	Kaithal (**Haryana**)	-	-	Earliest evidence of garlic cultivation. Trap: **Balu ≠ UP**.
Padri	Bhavnagar belt (**Gujarat**)	Coastal Saurashtra	-	**Gujarat** match in the Balu–Manda–Padri–Hulas set. Trap: **Padri ≠ Hulas**.
Bhirrana	Fatehabad (**Haryana**)	Ghaggar	ASI / L.S. Rao	Often called among the **oldest** Harappan settlements. Not a UP site.

> **UP Harappan quartet: Alamgirpur** (Meerut, east end) · **Hulas** (Saharanpur) · **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar) · **Sanauli** (Baghpat, Late / OCP chariots). **Rakhigarhi is Haryana**, not UP.
>
> **UKPCS — no mature Indus city in Uttarakhand.** Closest protohistoric belt: **Bahadrabad (Haridwar)** — OCP + Copper Hoards (Y.D. Sharma, 1951–53); **Bankot (Pithoragarh)** — 8 copper anthropomorphs (1989); **Malari (Chamoli)** — cist graves, 5.2 kg gold mask, Swat-style pottery. Do not list these as Harappa / Mohenjodaro-type cities.

2. Vedic Civilization — Literature, Philosophy & Geography

A. Rigvedic Rivers (Ancient vs Modern Name Match-up)

Rigvedic Ancient Name	Modern Name	Rigvedic Ancient Name	Modern Name
Vitasta	Jhelum	**Saraswati**	Ghaggar / Hakra (Most sacred: *Naditama*, *Devitama*)
Asikni	Chenab	**Drishadvati**	Chautang / Rakshi
Parushni	Ravi (Battle of 10 Kings on its bank)	**Kubha**	Kabul (Afghanistan)
Vipas	Beas	**Suvastu**	Swat (Afghanistan)
Sutudri	Sutlej	**Krumu**	Kurram (Afghanistan)
Sindhu	Indus (Most frequently mentioned river)	**Gomati**	Gomal (Afghanistan)
Sadaneera	Gandak (Mentioned in *Shatapatha Brahmana*)	**Marudvridha**	Maruwardwan (J&K)

B. Vedic Literature & Upanishadic Dialogues (Match Goldmine)

- **Rigveda**: 10 Mandalas, 1,028 Suktas (hymns); 3rd Mandala contains **Gayatri Mantra** (composed by Vishvamitra dedicated to solar deity Savitr); 7th Mandala describes **Dasrajan Yudha** (Battle of 10 Kings on Parushni/Ravi river won by Sudas of Bharata tribe); 9th Mandala dedicated entirely to **Soma**; 10th Mandala contains **Purusha Sukta** (first mention of 4 Varnas).
- **Samaveda**: Book of chants / melodies (*Ragas*); origin of Indian classical music; chanted by *Udgatri* priests.

- **Yajurveda**: Book of sacrificial prayers and rituals; divided into **Shukla Yajurveda** (White - poetry) and **Krishna Yajurveda** (Black - prose + verse).
- **Atharvaveda**: Charms, spells, magical formulas, everyday medicine; mentions *Sabha* and *Samiti* as twin daughters of Prajapati.
- **Key Brahmanas**:
- *Aitareya & Kaushitaki*: Rigveda.
- *Shatapatha Brahmana*: Largest and oldest Brahmana (attached to Shukla Yajurveda); story of Videgha Mathava carrying Agni across Sadaneera/Gandak.
- *Gopatha Brahmana*: Attached to Atharvaveda.
- **Famous Upanishadic Dialogues (Direct UPPSC/UKPSC Match-ups)**:
- **Mundaka Upanishad**: Sourced national motto **"Satyam Eva Jayate"** (*Truth Alone Triumphs*).
- **Katha Upanishad**: Famous philosophical dialogue between young boy **Nachiketa and Yama (God of Death)** on the nature of soul and immortality.
- **Brihadaranyaka Upanishad**: Largest Upanishad; contains celebrated philosophical debate between sage **Yajnavalkya and scholarly woman Gargi**; phrase *"Tamaso Ma Jyotirgamaya"*.
- **Chhandogya Upanishad**: Contains story of **Satyakama Jabala** (boy who spoke truth about his parentage admitted by sage Gautama); dialogue between Uddalaka Aruni and son Svetaketu (*Tat Tvam Asi*).
- **Jabala Upanishad**: First explicit mention of the **Four Ashramas** (Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa).

C. Six Vedangas (Limbs of the Vedas)

1. **Shiksha**: Phonetics and Pronunciation.
2. **Kalpa**: Ritual instructions (Shrauta Sutras, Grihya Sutras, Dharma Sutras, and **Sulba Sutras — ancient Indian Geometry & measurement!**).
3. **Vyakarana**: Grammar (Panini's *Ashtadhyayi*).
4. **Nirukta**: Etymology of Vedic words (Yaska's *Nirukta*).
5. **Chhanda**: Metrics and Poetic meters (Pingala's *Chhandasastra*).
6. **Jyotisha**: Astronomy and calculation of auspicious ritual calendar (Lagadha's *Vedanga Jyotisha*).

D. Six Schools of Indian Philosophy (Shad-Darshana)

School of Philosophy	Founder / Sage	Foundational Text	Core Philosophical Principle
1. Samkhya (*Oldest school*)	**Kapila Muni**	*Samkhya Sutra*	Dualistic realism: **Purusha** (Consciousness) and **Prakriti** (Matter); 25 basic elements
2. Yoga	**Patanjali**	*Yoga Sutra*	Eightfold path (**Ashtanga Yoga**: Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi)
3. Nyaya	**Akshapada Gautama**	*Nyaya Sutra*	Logic, epistemology, and rigorous reasoning; 4 Pramanas (Pratyaksha, Anumana, Upamana, Shabda)
4. Vaisheshika	**Kanada (Uluka)**	*Vaisheshika Sutra*	**Atomic theory (Paramanu)**; universe composed of 9 physical substances; scientific classification
5. Purva Mimamsa	**Jaimini**	*Mimamsa Sutra*	Unquestioned authority of Vedas; ritualism, Dharma, and Vedic karma
6. Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)	**Badarayana (Vyasa)**	*Brahma Sutra*	Philosophy of Upanishads; Brahman is supreme reality; developed by Shankara (Advaita) & Ramanuja

E. Vedic Political Assemblies (Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha, Gana)

Assembly	Composition & Nature	Presiding Officer	Primary Functions	Women's Status & Rigvedic vs Later Vedic Evolution
Sabha (सभा)	Council of select **elders, nobles, and Brahmanas**; smaller and more elite body	**Sabhapati** / *Sabhapala*	**Judicial and advisory**: arbitrated disputes, dispensed justice, advised king on state affairs	Women attended in Early Vedic (*Sabhavati*); **strictly excluded in Later Vedic** as royal power and patriarchy grew
Samiti (समिति)	**General folk assembly of the entire tribe (*Vis*)**; broad democratic body	**Pati** or **Ishan**	**Political and electoral**: elected and re-elected the *Rajan* (King), debated peace/war, discussed national policy; Rigveda hymn (X.191) ends with prayer for common consensus	Women had **no role**; strictly male tribal gathering. In Later Vedic, kings gradually subdued Samiti's electing power
Vidatha (विदथ)	**Oldest tribal assembly** (mentioned 122 times in Rigveda vs 8 times for Sabha, 9 for Samiti)	Tribal elder / seer	**Ritual, redistributive, and military**: distributed war spoils/booty, conducted folk rituals, settled domestic customs	**Women actively participated** (*Vidathya*) and debated alongside men. **Completely disappeared in Later Vedic times**
Gana (गण)	Assembly of warrior clans / general troop gathering	**Ganapati** / *Jyeshtha*	Military deliberations and tribal defense	Minor folk council; evolved into post-Vedic oligarchic Gana-sanghas

> **Crucial Prelims Triggers:** - **Atharvaveda (7.12.1)** explicitly calls **Sabha and Samiti the twin daughters of Prajapati** (*Prajapateh duhitarau*). - **Judicial function** belonged exclusively to **Sabha** (not Samiti). - **Electoral function** (election of the King) belonged to **Samiti** (not Sabha). - **Earliest assembly: Vidatha** (Rigveda's highest mention count: 122).

F. High-Yield Vedic Terms & Vocabulary (Match & Meaning Goldmine)

Frequently tested in UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims:

Ancient Vedic Term	Literal Meaning / Context	Historical & Exam Significance
Aghanya (अघन्या)	"Not to be killed / slain"	Refers to the **Cow**; highest penalty (capital punishment or expulsion) for hurting/killing
Gavishti / Gaveshana / Goshu	"Search for cows"	**War / Battle**; cattle raids were the prime cause of inter-tribal conflicts in Rigvedic era
Gopati (गोपति)	"Protector of cattle"	Title of the **King / Tribal Chief** (*Rajan*)
Gomat (गोमत्)	"Possessor of cattle"	A **wealthy person** (wealth was measured in cattle heads, not coins/land)
Duhitri (दुहितृ)	"One who milks the cow"	**Daughter** in the family
Goghna (गोघ्न)	"One for whom a cow is offered"	A revered **Guest** visiting the household
Godhuli (गोधूलि)	"Dust raised by returning cattle"	Evening twilight / dusk (unit of time measurement)
Gavyuti (गव्यूति)	Cattle grazing radius	Unit of **distance measurement**
Kulapa (कुलप)	Head of the *Kula* (family)	Oldest male patriarch of the family
Gramani (ग्रामणी)	Leader of the *Grama* (village)	Head of village; led local militia and ranked among the 12 Ratnins
Vispati (विशपति)	Head of the *Vis* (clan / canton)	Clan chief between village (*Grama*) and tribe (*Jana*)
Vrajapati (व्राजपति)	Master of pastures	Officer in charge of pastures and cattle camps; led village warriors

Ancient Vedic Term	Literal Meaning / Context	Historical & Exam Significance
Spasa (स्पश)	"Lookout / watcher"	**Spies / Intelligence agents** employed by the King/Varuna
Jivagribh (जीवगृभ्)	"One who seizes alive"	**Police official / arresting officer**
Duta (दूत)	Messenger	Royal envoy or ambassador
Yava (यव)	Food grain	**Barley** (the primary cereal of Rigvedic Aryans)
Godhuma (गोधूम)	Cereal grain	**Wheat** (widely cultivated in Later Vedic)
Vrihi (व्रीहि)	Cereal grain	**Rice** (extensively mentioned in Later Vedic texts)
Sira / Langala (सीर / लांगल)	Agricultural tool	**Plough**; *Sita* = furrow made by plough
Kinasha (कीनाश)	Field worker	**Ploughman / peasant cultivator**
Urvara / Kshetra (उर्वरा / क्षेत्र)	Land type	Fertile, cultivated agricultural field
Ayas (अयस्)	Metal	In Rigveda: **copper / bronze**; in Later Vedic: *Krishna-ayas / Shyama-ayas* = **iron**, *Lohita-ayas* = **copper**
Pani (पणि)	Trading folk	Wealthy non-Aryan traders/merchants; notorious in hymns as cattle-thieves
Bekhanata (बेखनाट)	Lender	**Usurer / Moneylender** who charged exorbitant interest rates
Nishka / Satamana (निष्क / शतमान)	Gold ornament / unit	In Rigveda: gold necklet/bullion; in Later Vedic: standardized gold unit of value

G. The 12 Vedic Ratnins (Jewel-Bearers of Royal Administration)

Mentioned in the Shatapatha Brahmana and Taittiriya Samhita during the Ratnahavimshi ceremony of the Rajasuya Yajna (King visits each official's home to offer oblation):

#	Ratnin (Jewel-Official)	Exact Designation / Official Portfolio	Key UPPCS Exam Trap
1	**Purohita** (पुरोहित)	Chief Royal Priest and chief political adviser to Rajan	Invariable first counselor of the realm
2	**Senani** (सेनानी)	Commander-in-Chief of the military forces	Leads the army in times of war
3	**Gramani** (ग्रामणी)	Village headman / leader of the rural militia	Represents rural folk in the royal circle
4	**Mahishi** (महिषी)	Chief Queen (first legally wedded queen)	Participated in royal consecration rites
5	**Suta** (सूत)	Charioteer, royal court minstrel, and herald	Chronicler of heroic royal deeds
6	**Sangrahitri** (संग्रहीतृ)	**Treasurer / Custodian of royal store**	Stores revenue and tribute
7	**Bhagadugha** (भागदुघ)	**Collector of the King's share (*Bhaga*) of revenue / taxes**	**UPPCS Trap:** Collects revenue (do NOT confuse with Akshavapa)
8	**Akshavapa** (अक्षावाप)	**Superintendent of gambling & royal dice accountant**	**UPPCS Trap (2023):** Dice/gambling officer, NOT revenue collector!
9	**Govikartana** (गोविकर्तन)	Keeper of forests, game master, companion in the royal hunt	Head of livestock and hunting preserves
10	**Palagala** (पालागल)	Royal courier, messenger, and confidential king's companion	Diplomatic emissary
11	**Kshattri** (क्षात्तृ)	Royal chamberlain / master of the royal household gate	Managed inner palace affairs
12	**Takshan / Rathakara** (तक्षन् / रथकार)	Chief carpenter and chariot-builder	Highest artisan status due to importance of chariots in war

3. 16 Mahajanapadas & Their Capitals (6th Century BCE)

Mahajanapada	Capital	Modern Location	High-Yield Exam Notes
Magadha	Girivraja / Rajagriha → Pataliputra	Patna & Gaya (Bihar)	Founded by Brihadratha; rose under Bimbisara (Haryanka)
Anga	**Champa** (ancient Malini)	Bhagalpur & Munger (Bihar)	Annexed by Bimbisara; major trade port to Suvarnabhumi
Kasi	**Varanasi**	Varanasi (UP)	Between Varuna and Asi rivers; famous for cotton textiles
Vatsa	**Kausambi**	Prayagraj/Kaushambi (UP)	King **Udayana** (hero of Bhasa's *Swapnavasavadattam*); Buddha visited
Kosala	**Sravasti** (North) / Saketa (South)	Ayodhya/Faizabad & Bahraich (UP)	King **Prasenjit** (contemporary of Buddha); Buddha spent most rainy seasons here
Saurasena	**Mathura**	Mathura (UP)	King Avantiputra (disciple of Buddha); Megasthenes mentions worship of Herakles (Krishna)
Panchala	**Ahichchhatra** (North, Bareilly) & **Kampilya** (South, Farrukhabad)	Rohilkhand & Central UP	Kannauj was part of it; transition from tribal to urban center
Kuru	**Indraprastha** (near Delhi) / Hastinapur	Meerut, Delhi, Thanesar	Shifted capital to Kaushambi after Hastinapur was flooded (Nichakshu)
Matsya	**Viratnagar** (Bairat, Jaipur)	Alwar, Bharatpur, Jaipur (Raj)	Hiding place of Pandavas; King Sujata
Chedi	**Suktimati** / Sotthivati	Bundelkhand (UP/MP)	King Shishupala (killed by Krishna in Mahabharata)
Avanti	**Ujjayini** (North) & **Mahishmati** (South)	Malwa / MP	King **Pradyota** (Mahasena); Jivaka (Bimbisara's physician) sent to treat his jaundice
Gandhara	**Taxila** (Takshashila) & Pushkalavati	Rawalpindi / Peshawar (Pak)	Famous university; King Pushkarasarin sent embassy to Bimbisara
Kamboja	**Rajpur** / Hataka	Rajouri & Hazara (NW frontier)	Famous for fine breed of horses; mentioned by Kautilya as *Varta-Shastropajivi*
Asmaka (Assaka)	**Potana** / Potali	Banks of river **Godavari** (Telangana/Maha)	**ONLY Mahajanapada situated south of the Vindhyas**
Vajji	**Vaishali**	Muzaffarpur / Vaishali (Bihar)	Confederacy of 8 clans (Lichchhavis, Videhas, Jnatrikas); First republican state
Malla	**Kushinagar** & **Pawa**	Deoria / Gorakhpur (UP)	Republican Gana-sangha; Buddha died at Kushinagar; Mahavira died at Pawa

> **UKPCS Special Note:** Ashoka's Major Rock Edict in Uttarakhand is at **Kalsi** (Dehradun district) on the confluence of the Yamuna and Tons rivers.

4. Ashoka's 14 Major Rock Edicts (MRE) — Complete Cheat-Sheet

Edict	Core Subject / Mandate Inscribed
Major Rock Edict I	Prohibition of animal slaughter and festive gatherings (*Samaja*).
Major Rock Edict II	Medical treatment for men and animals in his empire and border lands; mentions **Cholas, Pandyas, Satiyaputras, Keralaputras, and Antiochus II Theos of Syria**.

Edict	Core Subject / Mandate Inscribed
Major Rock Edict III	Liberal attitude towards Brahmanas and Shramanas; ordering **Yuktas, Rajukas, and Pradeshikas** to go on tour of inspection every 5 years (*Anusamyana*).
Major Rock Edict IV	Sound of Dhamma-ghosha replaced the sound of Bheri-ghosha (war drum).
Major Rock Edict V	Appointment of **Dhamma Mahamattas** (in 14th regnal year) to propagate morality.
Major Rock Edict VI	King's accessibility: reporters (**Pativedakas**) ordered to report public matters to Ashoka at all times and places.
Major Rock Edict VII	Universal religious tolerance among all sects.
Major Rock Edict VIII	Replaced royal pleasure trips (*Viharayatras*) with religious tours (**Dhammayatras**); visited Bodh Gaya in 10th regnal year.
Major Rock Edict IX	Condemned meaningless rituals and ceremonies; extolled Dhamma-mangala.
Major Rock Edict X	Denounced individual fame and glory in favour of moral attainment.
Major Rock Edict XI	Declared that the gift of Dhamma (*Dhamma-dana*) is the highest of all gifts.
Major Rock Edict XII	Directive on mutual tolerance among all religious sects; appointment of *Ithijhakha Mahamattas* (female affairs officers).
Major Rock Edict XIII	**MOST IMPORTANT EDICT**: Records the **Kalinga War (261 BCE, 8th regnal year)**, deep remorse over 1,00,000 killed and 1,50,000 captured; victory by Dhamma declared supreme; **mentions 5 contemporary Greek Kings**: 1. **Antiochus II Theos** (Syria) 2. **Ptolemy II Philadelphus** (Egypt) 3. **Antigonus Gonatas** (Macedonia) 4. **Magas** (Cyrene) 5. **Alexander** (Epirus).
Major Rock Edict XIV	Summarizes the purpose and recording of the various rock inscriptions.

5. Buddhism & Jainism Quick-Recall Matrix

A. The 4 Buddhist Councils (Memorize the Pattern!)

Council	Year	Venue	Patron King & Dynasty	President / Chairman	Landmark Accomplishment
1st	**483 BCE**	Saptaparni Cave, **Rajagriha**	**Ajatashatru** (Haryanka)	**Mahakassapa**	**Sutta Pitaka** (Ananda - Buddha's teachings) & **Vinaya Pitaka** (Upali - Monastic rules) compiled
2nd	**383 BCE**	**Vaishali**	**Kalashoka** (Shishunaga)	**Sabakami**	First schism: Split into **Sthaviravadins** (Theravadins) and **Mahasanghikas**
3rd	**250 BCE**	**Pataliputra**	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	**Moggaliputta Tissa**	**Abhidhamma Pitaka** compiled (philosophical analysis); Kathavatthu added; Missionaries sent abroad
4th	**72 CE**	Kundalvana (**Kashmir**)	**Kanishka** (Kushana)	**Vasumitra** (President), **Ashvaghosha** (Vice-President)	Final split into **Hinayana** and **Mahayana**; *Mahavibhasha Shastra* written in Sanskrit

B. Buddha's 5 Great Life Events & Symbols

1. **Janma (Birth)**: Lotus and Bull (**563 BCE**, Lumbini, Kapilavastu).
2. **Mahabhinishkramana (Great Renunciation)**: Horse (Kanthaka).
3. **Nirvana / Sambodhi (Enlightenment)**: Bodhi Tree (Pipal / Ficus religiosa) at Bodh Gaya on Niranjana (Phalgu) river.
4. **Dharmachakrapravartana (First Sermon)**: Wheel / 8-Spoked Chakra (Deer Park at Sarnath / Rishipattana).
5. **Mahaparinirvana (Death)**: Stupa / Footprints (Sal tree grove at Kushinagar, **483 BCE**, age **80**).

C. Birth and death of Buddha and Mahavira

Head	Gautama Buddha (Siddhartha)	Mahavira (Vardhamana)
Birth year	**563 BCE** (traditional; some books use a shorter chronology)	**599 BCE** (usual teaching set); some books use **540 BCE**
Birthplace	**Lumbini** (Nepal), near Kapilavastu of the **Shakya** clan	**Kundagrama** (Vaishali / Vajji belt, Bihar), **Jnatraka** clan
Parents	Father **Suddhodana**; mother **Mahamaya / Mayadevi** (Koliyan); raised by **Mahapajapati Gotami**	Father **Siddhartha**; mother **Trishala** (sister of Lichchhavi chief **Chetaka**)
Wife / child	**Yashodhara**; son **Rahul**	Jain tradition names wife **Yashoda** (a different person from Yashodhara)
Renunciation	Age **29** (*Mahabhinishkramana*; horse **Kanthaka**)	Age **30** (*grihatyaga*)
Awakening	Enlightenment at about **35**, **Bodh Gaya** (Vaishakha Purnima)	**Kevala jnana** at about **42**
Death year	**483 BCE** (*Mahaparinirvana*)	**527 BCE** (usual); some books use **468 BCE**
Death place	**Kushinagar** (UP, Malla republic), sala grove, age **80**	**Pavapuri / Pawa** (Bihar), age **72**
Proof of birthplace	Ashoka's **Rummindei** pillar at Lumbini	Kundagrama / Vaishali tradition; not marked by Rummindei

> **Logic:** Buddha **563–483 BCE**, 80 years. Mahavira **599–527 BCE**, 72 years. Do not swap Lumbini with Kundagrama, or Kushinagar with Pavapuri. **Nayaputta** is an epithet of **Mahavira**, not of Buddha. If a stem uses the shorter Jain pair **540–468 BCE**, both years still sit in the 6th–5th century BCE.

D. Jain Tirthankaras & Symbols (High-Frequency Match)

- **1st Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)**: **Bull** (Emblem) | Born in Ayodhya | Mentioned in Rigveda with Arishtanemi.
- **2nd Ajitanatha**: **Elephant** | Born in Ayodhya.
- **16th Shantinaatha**: **Deer**.
- **19th Mallinatha**: **Water Jar (Kalasha)** | Shvetambaras consider Mallinatha a female.
- **22nd Neminatha (Arishtanemi)**: **Conch (Shankha)** | Cousin of Krishna.
- **23rd Parshvanatha**: **Serpent / Hooded Cobra** | Born in Varanasi (Ashvasena's son); propounded 4 vows (*Chaturyama*).
- **24th Mahavira (Vardhamana)**: **Lion** | Born **599 BCE** at Kundagrama (Vaishali); died **527 BCE** at Pavapuri (age 72); added 5th vow: **Brahmacharya**.
- **Jain Councils**:
- **1st Council (c. 300 BCE)**: Pataliputra | Presided by **Sthulabhadra** | 12 Angas compiled | Split into Shvetambara (white-clad, led by Sthulabhadra) and Digambara (sky-clad, led by Bhadrabahu).
- **2nd Council (512 CE)**: Vallabhi (Gujarat) | Presided by **Devardhi Kshamasramana** | Final compilation of 12 Angas & 12 Upangas in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit.

6. Ancient Dynasties — From / To, Founder, Last Ruler, High-Yield

Magadha spine (do not skip a rung): **Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya → Shunga → Kanva**.

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Haryanka	**c. 544–412 BCE**	**Bimbisara** (Shrenika; annexes **Anga**; contemporary of Buddha & Mahavira)	**Nagadasaka** (weak tail; minister Shishunaga takes the throne)	**Rajagriha / Girivraja**	**Ajatashatru** — *rathamusala*, war on Vajji, **1st Buddhist Council** (Rajagriha). **Udayin** first makes **Pataliputra** the Magadhan capital (Ajatashatru only seeds Pataligrama).
Shishunaga	**c. 412–344 BCE**	**Shishunaga** (ex-viceroy of Kashi)	**Nandivardhana / Mahanandin** (overthrown by Mahapadma Nanda)	Girivraja → **Vaishali** (second capital tradition)	Founder **takes Avanti / Malwa** (ends Pradyota). **Kalashoka / Kakavarna** — **2nd Buddhist Council** at Vaishali (schism). Did **not** found Pataliputra.
Nanda	**c. 344–321 BCE**	**Mahapadma Nanda** (*Ekarat*, *Sarvakshatrantaka*, *Ugrasena*, *Aparoparashurama*)	**Dhana Nanda** (Greek **Agrammes / Xandrames**; commander Bhaddasala)	**Pataliputra**	Nine Nandas. Huge standing army; **Alexander never fought** them (326 BCE is still Dhana Nanda's reign). Hathigumpha later recalls a Nanda canal and a Jina image from Kalinga. Overthrown by **Chandragupta + Chanakya**.
Maurya	**c. 321–185 BCE**	**Chandragupta Maurya** (Greek *Sandrokottos*; Chanakya / Kautilya; treaty with Seleucus **c. 303 BCE**)	**Brihadratha** (killed by general **Pushyamitra Shunga**, 185 BCE)	**Pataliputra** (Ganga–Son)	**Bindusara** (*Amitraghata*). **Ashoka**: accession c. 272, coronation **268–232**; **Kalinga War 261 BCE** (MRE XIII); **3rd Council** at Pataliputra. Ashoka's death **232 ≠** end of empire — house runs to **185**.
Shunga	**185–73 BCE**	**Pushyamitra Shunga** (coup at a military review)	**Devabhuti** (killed / ousted by Vasudeva Kanva)	Pataliputra & **Vidisha**	Two **ashvamedhas** (Ayodhya / Dhanadeva record). **Agnimitra** (अग्निमित्र) in Kalidasa's (कालिदास) *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्). **Patanjali** (*Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य)) is Shunga-age, not Kanishka's court. Sanchi still grows.
Kanva	**73–28 BCE**	**Vasudeva Kanva**	**Susarman**	Pataliputra	Short Magadha coda after Shungas. Deccan **Satavahanas** rise as this house fades.
Satavahana (Andhra)	**c. 230 BCE – 3rd c. CE**	**Simuka**	Last great often **Yajna Sri Satakarni** (later Pulomavi line)	**Pratishthana (Paithan)** & Amaravati	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** — *Ekabrahmana*, *Trisamudrapitapoyavahana* (Nasik cave of mother **Gautami Balashri**); smashed Western Kshatrapas. **Lead & potin** coins; matrilineal *Gautamiputra / Vasisthiputra* titles. **Hala** — Prakrit *Gatha Saptasati*. Yajna Sri — **ship** on coins.
Kushana	**1st–3rd c. CE**	**Kujula Kadphises** (Kadphises I)	Last great **Vasudeva I** (then fragmentation)	**Purushapura (Peshawar)** & **Mathura**	**Vima Kadphises** — first Kushana **gold** (*dinar*). **Kanishka** — **Shaka era 78 CE** (some books peak c. 127); **4th Council** at Kundalvana (Kashmir); Gandhara + Mathura art; titles *Devaputra*. Do not make Kanishka a Gupta.

Dynasty	Period (from–to)	Founder	Last ruler	Capital	Key ruler & high-yield
Gupta	**c. 320–550 CE**	**Sri Gupta** → **Ghatotkacha** (both *Maharaja*); real imperial start **Chandragupta I** (**Maharajadhiraja**, Gupta era **319/320 CE**, queen **Kumaradevi**)	Last great **Skandagupta**; later line thins (e.g. Vishnugupta)	**Pataliputra** (CG II also uses **Ujjain**)	**Samudragupta** — Prayag Prashasti by **Harisena**; *Napoleon of India*; Aryavarta uprooted, Dakshinapatha captured-and-freed. **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya** — *Sakari*, ends Western Kshatrapas (Rudrasimha III); Mehrauli iron pillar; Fa-Hien. **Kumaragupta I** — Nalanda tradition. **Skandagupta** — **Bhitari** (Ghazipur, UP) vs **Hunas**; repairs Sudarsana lake.
Vakataka	**c. 250–500 CE**	**Vindhyashakti**	**Harishena** (Vatsagulma branch; Ajanta later caves)	**Vatsagulma** (Washim) / Nandivardhana	**Pravarasena I** — four *ashvamedhas*. Gupta–Vakataka tie: **Prabhavatigupta** (daughter of CG II) married **Rudrasena II** and ruled as regent.
Maukhari	**6th c. CE** (till **c. 606**)	**Harivarman**	**Grahavarman**	**Kannauj** (Kanyakubja, UP)	Grahavarman married **Rajyashri** (Harsha's sister); killed by **Deva Gupta of Malwa** + **Shashanka** of Gauda — the spark for Harsha's rise.
Pushyabhuti (Vardhana)	House earlier; **Harsha 606–647 CE**	**Pushyabhuti** (house); effective reunion king **Harshavardhana**	**Harsha** (no stable heir after **647**; Wang Xuance / Arunashva)	Thanesar → **Kannauj**	**Harsha-samvat 606**. Xuanzang (*Si-Yu-Ki*). Kannauj & Prayag assemblies. Stopped on the **Narmada** by **Pulakeshin II**. Banabhatta — *Harshacharita*. Not a Gupta emperor.
Badami Chalukya	**543–753 CE**	**Pulakeshin I**	**Kirtivarman II** (overthrown by Rashtrakuta **Dantidurga**)	**Vatapi (Badami**, Karnataka)	**Pulakeshin II** — defeats Harsha on Narmada; **Aihole / Meguti** prashasti by Jain poet **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) (names **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) & **Bharavi** (भारवि)). Clash with Pallavas (Narasimhavarman I sacks Vatapi — *Vatapikonda*).
Pallava of Kanchi	**c. 575–897 CE**	**Simhavishnu** (imperial line)	**Aparajita** (defeated by Chola **Aditya I**)	**Kanchipuram**	**Mahendravarman I** — *Mattavilasa Prahasana*; rock-cut start. **Narasimhavarman I Mahamalla** — defeats Pulakeshin II; **Mamallapuram** rathas / shore temple age.

> **Logic:** Maurya **321–185**, not 321–232. Gupta **320–550**, not "ends with Chandragupta II." Harsha **606–647** is Pushyabhuti, not Gupta. Shunga **185** is the Mauryan end, not Kalinga (261).

7. Epigraphy & Inscriptions (The Match-the-Following Goldmine)

Inscription	Place / State	King / Dynasty	Author / Key Fact
Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar)	Prayagraj (UP)	**Samudragupta** (Gupta)	Composed by court poet **Harisena** (हरिषेण) in *Champu* (चम्पू) (verse + prose) style in Sanskrit. Mentions *Digvijaya*, *Dakshinapatha* (12 kings - *Grahana-Mokshanugraha*), *Aryavarta* (9 kings exterminated). Also has inscriptions of Ashoka, Jahangir, Birbal!
Hathigumpha Inscription	Udayagiri hills, Bhubaneswar (Odisha)	**Kharavela** (Chedi/Mahameghavahana)	In Prakrit, Brahmi script. Mentions: canal dug by Nandaraja 300 yrs earlier brought to Kalinga, invasion of Magadha (*Bahisatimita* defeated), first epigraphic mention of **Bharatavarsha**.

Inscription	Place / State	King / Dynasty	Author / Key Fact
Junagarh Rock Inscription	Girnar, Junagadh (Gujarat)	**Rudradaman I** (Western Kshatrapa, 150 CE)	**First chaste, elaborate Sanskrit inscription**. Records history of **Sudarshana Lake**: built under Chandragupta Maurya (Pushyagupta), canal added by Ashoka (Tushaspha), repaired by Rudradaman (Suvisakha) **without levying extra tax/Vishti**, later restored by Skandagupta (Chakrapalita)!
Aihole Inscription	Bagalkot (Karnataka)	**Pulakeshin II** (Badami Chalukya)	Composed by Jain poet **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) at Meguti temple. Mentions Pulakeshin II defeating Harshavardhana on the banks of Narmada; mentions poets **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) and **Bharavi** (भारवि).
Mehrauli Iron Pillar	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Chandra** (Chandragupta II Vikramaditya)	Rustless iron metallurgy; defeated Vanga confederacy and crossed 7 mouths of Sindhu to defeat Vahlikas. Dedicated to Lord Vishnu (*Vishnupada*).
Nasik Cave Inscription	Nasik (Maharashtra)	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** (Satavahana)	Issued by his mother **Gautami Balashri**. Titles: *Ekabrahmana*, *Kshatriya-darpa-man-mardana*, *Trisamudrapitapoyavahana* (whose horses drank water of three seas).
Besnagar (Vidisha) Pillar	Vidisha (Madhya Pradesh)	**Bhagabhadra** (Shunga)	Erected by **Heliodorus** (Greek ambassador of King Antialcidas of Taxila); calls himself *Bhagavata* and dedicates Garuda-dhvaja to *Devadeva Vasudeva*.
Eran Inscription (510 CE)	Sagar (Madhya Pradesh)	**Bhanugupta** (Gupta)	**First epigraphic / dated evidence of Sati**: Goparaja (general) died fighting Hunas; his wife immolated herself on his funeral pyre.
Uttiramerur Inscription	Kanchipuram (Tamil Nadu)	**Parantaka I** (Chola, 10th c.)	In-depth details of **Chola village self-government**, Kudavolai (pot-ticket lot) system, and committee qualification rules for *Variyam*.
Rummindei Pillar Inscription	Lumbini (Nepal)	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Commemorates Ashoka's visit to Buddha's birthplace (20th regnal year). **Tax concessions**: Land revenue (*Bhaga*) reduced from 1/6th to **1/8th**, and religious tribute (*Bali*) completely abolished.
Bhabru (Bairat) Edict	Rajasthan	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Ashoka explicitly affirms faith in the **Buddha, Dhamma, and Sangha**; calls himself *Piyadassi Raja Magadha*.
Maski, Gurjara, Nittur, Udegolam	Karnataka & MP	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Inscriptions where the personal name **"Ashoka"** is explicitly written (instead of just *Devanampiya Piyadassi*).
Sohgaura (Gorakhpur) & Mahasthangarh (Bogura)	UP & Bangladesh	Maurya Period	Copper plate & limestone plaque mentioning **famine relief measures** and state granary maintenance.

8. Ancient Ports & Ancient Coins

A. Major Ancient Indian Ports (Direct Match Questions)

- **Western Coast**:
- **Bharuch / Barygaza** (Narmada estuary, Gujarat): Most active port for trade with Roman Empire.
- **Sopara (Surparaka)** (near Mumbai, Maharashtra): Ashokan edict site; major trade center.
- **Kalyan (Calliena)** (Thane, Maharashtra).
- **Muziris / Kodungallur** (Periyar river mouth, Kerala): Roman trade hub; exported black pepper (**"Yavanapriya"**); temple of Augustus built here.
- **Nelcynda & Tyndis** (Kerala coast).

- **Eastern Coast**:
- **Tamralipti / Tamluk** (Midnapore, West Bengal - Hooghly river): Premier port for trade with Southeast Asia, China, and Sri Lanka; Fa-Hien sailed back to China from here.
- **Arikamedu (Podouke)** (near Puducherry): Roman trading post; excavated by Mortimer Wheeler; Roman amphorae, Arretine ware, and Roman coins found.
- **Poompuhar / Kaveripattinam** (Kaveri mouth, Tamil Nadu): Capital port of the Early Cholas (celebrated in *Silappadikaram*).
- **Korkai** (Tamil Nadu): Famous pearl-fishery port of the Pandyas.

B. Ancient Coins & Currency Units

- **Nishka / Satamana**: Gold ornaments/weights in Vedic period; later evolved into currency terms.
- **Karshapana / Pana**: Standard **silver punch-marked coins** (bearing symbols of sun, tree, hill, peacock) in Mauryan and Mahajanapada era.
- **First Gold Coins in India**: Issued by **Indo-Greeks (2nd c. BCE)**; also first to issue coins with portraits and legends of kings.
- **Largest Number of Pure Gold Coins**: Issued by **Kushanas** (Vima Kadphises and Kanishka - *Dinar* based on Roman denarius weight standard).
- **Largest Quantity of Gold Coins**: Issued by **Guptas** (*Dinar* for gold; *Rupaka* for silver, started by Chandragupta II after defeating Shakas).
- **Lead and Potin Coins**: Distinctive currency issued by the **Satavahanas**.
- **Cowries (Kaudi)**: Common medium of exchange for daily petty transactions (recorded by Fa-Hien in Gupta era).

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9. Ancient Indian Administrative Officers Master Matrix

A. Mauryan Central Administration (Arthashastra & Edicts)

- **Central Tirthas (18 Supreme Functionaries)**: Top cabinet-level officials including *Mantri* (Prime Minister), *Purohita* (Chief Priest), *Senapati* (Army Chief), *Yuvaraja* (Crown Prince), and the two supreme fiscal heads:
- **Samaharta (समाहर्ता)**: **Collector General of Revenue** — responsible for preparing the annual state budget, assessing revenues, and overseeing tax collection across the entire empire (rural, urban, mines, forests).
- **Sannidhata (सन्निधाता)**: **Chief Treasury Officer & Custodian of Royal Storehouses** (*Koshadhyaksha*) — responsible for the safe keeping of the state treasury, constructing granaries, treasuries, and warehouses.
- **Megasthenes' Administrative Officials in *Indica***:
- **Astynomoi (नगर अध्यक्ष)**: 30 city officials of Pataliputra divided into **6 boards of 5 members each**:
  1. *Board 1*: Industrial arts & crafts inspection.
  2. *Board 2*: Care and surveillance of foreign visitors.
  3. *Board 3*: Registration of vital statistics (births and deaths).
  4. *Board 4*: Trade, commerce, and regulation of markets.
  5. *Board 5*: Inspection of manufactured goods and distinguishing new from old.
  6. *Board 6*: Collection of the **10% sales tax** on goods sold (evasion was punishable by death).
- **Agronomoi (जिला / ग्रामीण अधिकारी)**: Rural and district officers in charge of land measurement, irrigation canals, agriculture, timber, mining, and road maintenance (installed milestones every 10 stadia).
- **Ashoka's Key Administrative Cadres**:
- **Rajuka (रज्जुक)**: District administrator in charge of land survey, revenue assessment, and judicial administration (Ashoka granted them full independence in judicial punishment).
- **Yukta (युक्त)**: Subordinate secretarial officer / district accountant assisting the Rajukas.

- **Pradeshika (प्रादेशिक)**: Head of provincial/divisional administration on regular five-year inspection tours (*Anusamyana*).
- **Dhamma Mahamatta (धम्म महामात्र)**: High-ranking moral officials instituted in Ashoka's 14th regnal year (Rock Edict V) to propagate Dhamma, prevent arbitrary imprisonment, and supervise religious harmony.

B. Kautilya's 20+ Key Adhyakshas (Department Superintendents)

Adhyaksha (Superintendent)	Department / Administrative Portfolio	Exam Keyword / Function
Sitadhyaksha (सीताध्यक्ष)	**Agriculture & Crown Lands**	Supervised state farms (*Sita* lands) and farming labour
Pautavadhyaksha (पौतवाध्यक्ष)	**Weights and Measures**	Standardized scales and measures across markets
Panyadhyaksha (पण्याध्यक्ष)	**Trade and Commerce**	Regulated supply, pricing, and distribution of state merchandise
Samsthadhyaksha (संस्थाध्यक्ष)	**Markets and Guilds**	Monitored markets, prevented cartelization and cheating
Sulkadhyaksha (शुल्काध्यक्ष)	**Tolls, Customs & Octroi**	Collected transit duties and import/export taxes
Rupadarshaka (रूपदर्शक)	**Currency & Coinage Inspector**	Examined purity of punch-marked silver coins (*Pana*)
Akshapataladhyaksha (अक्षपटलाध्यक्ष)	**Accountant General & Archives**	Maintained central accounts, ledgers, and state audit
Mudradhyaksha (मुद्राध्यक्ष)	**Passports & State Seals**	Issued identity tokens and regulated travel/emigration
Navadhyaksha (नावाध्यक्ष)	**Shipping, Ferries & Waterways**	Managed maritime trade, rivers, ports, and toll-ferries
Akaradhyaksha (आकराध्यक्ष)	**Mines and Metallurgy**	Controlled state monopoly over mineral extraction
Lohadhyaksha (लोहाध्यक्ष)	**Iron and Metal Manufacture**	Supervised manufacture of iron weapons and tools
Suradhyaksha (सुराध्यक्ष)	**Liquor and Excise**	Regulated state breweries and alcohol taverns
Sunadhyaksha (सूनाध्यक्ष)	**Slaughterhouses & Animal Care**	Prevented cruelty and controlled meat production
Ganikadhyaksha (गणिकाध्यक्ष)	**Courtesans & Entertainers**	Regulated public entertainers, dancers, and royal spies
Vivitadhyaksha (विवीताध्यक्ष)	**Pastures and Grazing Lands**	Managed grazing grounds, dug wells, maintained security
Kupyadhyaksha (कुप्याध्यक्ष)	**Forest Produce & Timber**	Managed state forests, timber, and wild elephant reserves
Koshadhyaksha (कोषाध्यक्ष)	**Imperial Treasury**	Subordinate to Sannidhata; guarded gold, gems, and bullion
Ayudhagaradhyaksha (आयुधागाराध्यक्ष)	**Armoury & Weapons Storage**	Manufactured and preserved arms and military gear
Hastyadhyaksha (हस्त्यध्यक्ष)	**War Elephant Force**	Training, feeding, and deploying royal elephant corps
Ashvadhyaksha (अश्वाध्यक्ष)	**Cavalry & Royal Stables**	Imported and maintained war horses

C. Gupta & Harsha Administrative Officers

Officer Designation	Dynasty / Period	Portfolio / Exact Role
Kumaramatya (कुमारमात्य)	Gupta	**Elite administrative cadre**; equivalent to modern IAS; served as provincial governors, ministers, generals
Mahabaladhikrita (महाबलाधिकृत)	Gupta & Harsha	**Commander-in-Chief** of the imperial army
Mahadandanayaka (महादंडनायक)	Gupta	**Chief Judicial & Police Magistrate** (Harisena held Kumaramatya, Sandhivigrahika, and Mahadandanayaka)
Sandhivigrahika (सांधिविग्रहिक)	Gupta (started under Samudragupta)	**Minister for Peace and War** (Foreign Minister)

Officer Designation	Dynasty / Period	Portfolio / Exact Role
Mahapratihara (महाप्रतिहार)	Gupta & Harsha	**Chief of Palace Guards** and Lord Chamberlain
Uparika (उपरिक)	Gupta & Harsha	**Provincial Governor**; head of a *Bhukti* (province)
Vishayapati (विषयपति)	Gupta	**Head of a District** (*Vishaya*); administered with 4-member city council (*Adhisthana-adhikarana*): 1. *Nagara-sreshthi* (Chief of guild/banker) 2. *Sarthavaha* (Caravan merchant chief) 3. *Prathama-kulika* (Chief artisan) 4. *Prathama-kayastha* (Chief scribe/writer)
Pustapala (पुस्तपाल)	Gupta	**Keeper of land records and revenue surveys**
Shaulkika (शौल्किक)	Gupta	Collector of toll and customs duties (*Shulka*)
Dandapasika / Chauroddharanika	Gupta	Police officer / investigator in charge of catching thieves and criminals
Bhandagaradhikarana	Harsha	Chief superintendent of the royal treasury and storehouse

D. Chola Local Administration & Committees (Uttiramerur Inscription)

- **Three Core Assemblies**:
- **Ur**: General assembly of common tax-paying villagers in non-Brahmana settlements.
- **Sabha / Mahasabha**: Assembly of learned Brahmanas in tax-free **Brahmadeya / Agrahara** villages.
- **Nagaram**: Council of merchants and traders in commercial towns.
- **Variyam (Executive Standing Committees of Sabha)**:
- **Samvatsara-variyam**: Annual executive governing committee.
- **Eri-variyam**: **Tank and irrigation committee** (supervised desilting and water sharing).
- **Totta-variyam**: Garden and orchard committee.
- **Pon-variyam**: Gold and treasury assessment committee.
- **Panchavara-variyam**: Standing committee for general supervision.
- **Kudavolai System (कुदवोलाई)**: Pot-ticket lot system where candidates' names on palm leaves were drawn from an earthen pot by a young boy to ensure impartial committee selection.

10. Ancient Indian Taxes & Fiscal Terms Master Matrix

Tax / Fiscal Term	Period / Civilization	Nature of Levy / Source of Collection	High-Yield Exam Lock
Bali (बलि)	Vedic → Maurya	Vedic: Voluntary offering to Rajan in Rigveda → **Compulsory tax** in Later Vedic. Maurya: Religious tribute / additional land cess (Ashoka abolished Bali at Lumbini).	Voluntary in Rigveda; compulsory later
Bhaga (भाग)	Vedic → Maurya → Gupta	**King's royal share of agricultural produce**, traditionally fixed at **1/6th (*Shadbhaga*)**. Reduced to 1/8th by Ashoka at Lumbini.	Standard 1/6th land revenue
Sita (सीता)	Mauryan	**Revenue from crown agricultural lands** managed directly by the *Sitadhyaksha*.	Crown land revenue (distinct from Bhaga)
Kara (कर)	Mauryan & Gupta	Periodical tax levied on property, or specific tax levied on fruit, flower, and vegetable orchards.	Specific / periodic property tax
Vishti (विष्टि)	Maurya & Gupta	**Forced, unpaid labor** demanded by the state from artisans and peasants for public works.	Unpaid forced labor; treated as state income in Junagarh
Pranaya (प्रणय)	Mauryan	**Emergency war tax / gift of affection** levied during acute financial crisis (demanded 1/3 to 1/4 of produce).	Emergency fiscal levy

Tax / Fiscal Term	Period / Civilization	Nature of Levy / Source of Collection	High-Yield Exam Lock
Vartani (वर्तनी)	Mauryan	**Transit duty / road cess** collected on goods by frontier officers (*Antapala*).	Transit duty / toll
Shulka (शुल्क)	Vedic → Gupta	**Customs duty, octroi, and toll taxes** levied on merchandise entering ports or market towns.	Toll / customs tax
Udakabhaga (उदकभाग)	Mauryan	**Water tax / irrigation cess** levied on farmers using state-constructed canals/lakes (varying from 1/5th to 1/3rd).	Irrigation / water cess
Hiranya (हिरण्य)	Maurya & Gupta	**Tax paid in cash / gold** (as opposed to payment in agricultural kind).	Cash tax (gold/coins)
Pindakara (पिण्डकर)	Mauryan	Lump-sum tax assessed collectively on an entire village community.	Collective village tax
Bhoga (भोग)	Gupta	**Daily customary tribute** of fruits, flowers, vegetables, and firewood offered by villagers to the king.	Daily tribute in kind (fruit/firewood)
Udranga (उद्रंग)	Gupta	Land revenue tax levied on **permanent tenants / water tax**.	Tax on permanent cultivators
Uparikara (उपरिकर)	Gupta	Additional tax levied on **temporary cultivators / non-permanent tenants**.	Tax on temporary tenants
Halikakara (हलिककर)	Gupta	**Plough tax** levied per plough owned by the peasant.	Tax per plough
Kadamai / Kudimai	Chola	**Primary land revenue** payable in paddy or cash to the king.	Main Chola land revenue
Vetti / Vetti-muttavalu	Chola	**Unpaid communal forced labor** for public tanks, temples, and palaces.	Chola forced labor (equivalent to Vishti)
Amanji	South India	Gratuitous labor or personal service to royal officials.	Personal royal service
Iraiyili (इरैयिली)	Chola / South India	**Tax-free land grant** bestowed upon temples (*Devadana*) or Brahmanas (*Brahmadeya*).	Tax-exempt land
Karai (करै)	Sangam	Land tax levied on agricultural produce by Tamil kings.	Sangam land tax
Ulgu / Sungam	Sangam & Chola	Customs duties, transit fees, and octroi tolls on trade caravans.	Toll / customs
Iravu (इरवु)	Sangam	Extra forced contribution or emergency demand made by the king.	Forced emergency demand

11. Ancient Land Classifications, Social Systems & Sangam Eco-Zones

A. 5 Types of Land in Ancient India (Gupta Inscriptions & Amarakosha)

1. **Kshetra (क्षेत्र)**: Land fit for **cultivation and agriculture**.
2. **Khila (खिल)**: **Waste, fallow, or uncultivated land**.
3. **Aprahata (अप्रहत)**: **Virgin, uncultivated jungle / forest land**.
4. **Vasti (वास्तु)**: **Habitable land** suitable for building homesteads and residential houses.
5. **Gapata-Sarah (गपत-सरह)**: **Pasture land** reserved for grazing cattle.

> **Ancient Land Tenure Systems:** - **Nivi-dharma (नीवी धर्म)**: Perpetual land endowment where the recipient enjoys income in perpetuity without right to sell or transfer ownership. - **Aprada-dharma (अप्रदा धर्म)**: Grantee can enjoy the revenue but has zero right to alienate or destroy property. - **Bhumi-chhidra-nyaya (भूमि-छिद्र-न्याय)**: Customary right of first clearance: anyone who clears virgin/waste land acquires ownership rights over it.

B. The 8 Types of Hindu Marriage (Manusmriti)

- **Approved / Dharmya Marriages (Prashasta — 4 Types)**: 1. **Brahma**: Father gifts decorated daughter to a learned, virtuous groom without demanding dowry (Highest & purest form). 2. **Daiva**: Father gives daughter to an officiating priest during a formal Vedic sacrifice. 3. **Arsha**: Groom offers a pair of cows and a bull to the bride's father to fulfill religious duties (not as bride-price). 4. **Prajapatya**: Father gifts daughter with blessing: *"May both of you perform your religious duties together"*.
- **Unapproved / Adharmya Marriages (Aprashasta — 4 Types)**: 5. **Asura**: Groom buys the bride by paying money/wealth to her father and relatives (Bride-price marriage). 6. **Gandharva**: Love marriage based on mutual passion between bride and groom without parents' consent (e.g., Dushyanta & Shakuntala). 7. **Rakshasa**: Forcible abduction and marriage of a crying maiden after fighting and slaying her kinsmen. 8. **Paishacha**: Ravishing a maiden while she is asleep, intoxicated, or mentally deranged (Lowest and most sinful form).

> **Varna Marriage Rules:** - **Anuloma (अनुलोम)**: Marriage of a higher varna male with a lower varna female (Permitted by Dharma texts). - **Pratiloma (प्रतिलोम)**: Marriage of a lower varna male with a higher varna female (Severely condemned; produced untouchables/Chandalas).

C. Sangam Five Landscapes (Ainthinai / 5 Tinai)

Each Tinai represents an ecological zone, characteristic deity, and primary livelihood:

Tinai (Landscape)	Eco-Zone / Topography	Presiding Deity	Primary Livelihood / Occupation
Kurinji (குரிஞ்சி)	**Hilly / Mountainous**	**Murugan** (Seyon - God of War)	Hunting, honey-gathering, shifting cultivation
Mullai (முல்லை)	**Forest / Pastoral Grasslands**	**Mayon** (Vishnu / Krishna)	Cattle-rearing, pastoralism, dairy farming
Marudam (மருதம்)	**Fertile Agricultural Plains**	**Vendan** (Indra - God of Rain)	Wet-paddy agriculture, farming
Neydal (நெய்தல்)	**Coastal / Littoral Belt**	**Varunan** (God of the Sea)	Fishing, boat building, salt manufacturing
Palai (பாலை)	**Arid / Desert / Parched Land**	**Korravai** (Goddess of Victory/War)	Highway robbery, raiding, military plunder

Topic 1 — Stone Age (Prehistoric India)

Consolidated — 42 Must-Score Facts

1. Indian prehistory runs **Paleolithic → Mesolithic → Neolithic → Chalcolithic**. Paleolithic people used **chipped** tools and lived by hunting and gathering. Neolithic people used **polished or ground** stone, pottery, and farming.
2. Lower Paleolithic tools are **handaxes and cleavers** (Acheulian). Middle Paleolithic tools are **flakes** made by the Levallois method. Upper Paleolithic tools are **blades, burins, and scrapers**.
3. The **Soanian** industry of the Soan–Siwalik belt used pebble **chopper-chopping** tools. The **Acheulian** industry of the peninsula and Narmada used **handaxe-cleaver** tools. Do not mix the two traditions.
4. **Hathnora** on the Narmada in Madhya Pradesh yielded a ***Homo erectus*** skull, found by **Arun Sonakia** in **1982**. It is not a modern *Homo sapiens* fossil.
5. **Attirampakkam** in the Kortallayar valley of Tamil Nadu has Acheulian tools about **1.5 million years** old. It is a **tool** site, not a hominin fossil site.
6. **Robert Bruce Foote** recognised the first Indian Paleolithic tools at **Pallavaram** (Tamil Nadu) in **1863**. He is called the Father of Indian Prehistory.
7. **Bagor** on the Kothari in Rajasthan is the Mesolithic **animal-domestication** key. **V.N. Misra** excavated it. It is not a Paleolithic shrine.
8. **Sarai Nahar Rai** (सराय नाहर राय), **Mahadaha**, and **Damdama** in Pratapgarh, Uttar Pradesh, are Mesolithic **burial** sites of the Ganga plain. Domestication is Bagor; burials are Pratapgarh.
9. A **microlith** is a tiny blade about **1–8 cm**, hafted as a composite tool. It is the hallmark of the **Mesolithic**. It is not a Lower Paleolithic handaxe.
10. **Non-geometric** microliths (backed blades) belong to the earlier Mesolithic. **Geometric** microliths (lunates, triangles, trapezes) belong to the later Mesolithic.
11. **Mehrgarh** (मेहरगढ़) in Balochistan is the earliest farming village of the subcontinent, around **7000 BCE**. First crops are **wheat and barley**. Period I is **aceramic** (farming without pottery).
12. **Koldihwa** and **Mahagara** in the Belan valley of Mirzapur–Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, are the early **rice** pair. **G.R. Sharma** excavated them.
13. **Mahagara** alone has the **cattle pen with hoof marks**. **Koldihwa** is known for **rice-husk impressions** in pottery. Keep the two sister facts separate.
14. **Lahuradewa** in **Sant Kabir Nagar**, Uttar Pradesh, has early Ganga-plain **rice** at a lake edge. It is **not** a Belan valley site.
15. **Burzahom** (बुरज़होम) near Srinagar has Neolithic **pit dwellings** about 2–4 m deep and a famous **dog burial**. **Gufkral** in Pulwama means "cave of the potter."
16. **Chirand** in Saran, Bihar, is the Gangetic Neolithic site famous for **bone and antler tools**. It has no Burzahom-style pit dwellings and no South Indian ash mounds.
17. **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) in Raisen, Madhya Pradesh, was first recognised by **V.S. Wakankar** in **1957–58**. UNESCO listed it in **2003**. There are about **750+** shelters and **500+** painted ones.
18. **Baghor** in the Son valley of Madhya Pradesh is an Upper Paleolithic stone **shrine**. **Bagor** in Rajasthan is Mesolithic **domestication**. Never swap the spellings.
19. Chalcolithic cultures used **copper plus stone** in **rural** villages. They are **not** Harappan planned cities with citadels and covered drains.
20. **Inamgaon** in Maharashtra is the **Jorwe** type site. **Navdatoli** on the Narmada in Madhya Pradesh is **Malwa** culture, excavated by **H.D. Sankalia**.
21. **OCP** (Ochre Coloured Pottery) belongs to the western UP–Haryana–Rajasthan **doab**. **Hastinapur** (हस्तिनापुर) is a classic OCP site. It is not mature Harappan urban ware.
22. **Megaliths** are mainly **Iron Age** burial monuments of the Deccan and south (dolmens, cists, stone circles). They are not Stone Age Chalcolithic villages. Classic names include **Brahmagiri**, **Adichanallur**, **Maski** (मास्की), and

Hallur.

23. Uttar Pradesh Stone Age facts cluster on the **Belan** (Chopani Mando, Koldihwa, Mahagara), **Lahuradewa**, Pratapgarh Mesolithic cemeteries, **Morhana Pahar** (Sonbhadra paintings), and **Lekhahia** (Mirzapur rock art).
24. A **rock shelter** is a natural overhang (Bhimbetka). A **carved cave** like Ajanta is cut by humans. Do not call Bhimbetka an Ajanta-style cave.
25. **V. Gordon Childe** coined the phrase **Neolithic Revolution** for the shift from food collection to food production. The change in South Asia was staggered by region, not one national year.
26. South Indian Neolithic sites often show **ash mounds** (Piklihal, Utnur, Kodekal) linked to cattle pens. Ash mounds are **not** a Chirand or Burzahom feature.
27. **H.D. Sankalia** excavated **Langhnaj** (Gujarat Mesolithic) and **Navdatoli**. He did **not** discover Bhimbetka. **Madho Swaroop Vats** is a Harappan archaeologist and a Bhimbetka distractor.
28. **Chopani Mando** in the Belan valley of Uttar Pradesh shows Paleolithic–Mesolithic–Neolithic **continuity** and wild-rice gathering before full Belan farming.
29. The **Ahar–Banas** culture of Rajasthan used copper and white-painted **black-and-red ware**. The **Jorwe** culture of Maharashtra used painted **black-on-red** ware and fades around **1000 BCE**.
30. Red animals and white human figures is a useful **Bhimbetka** colour heuristic. Prehistoric art here is multi-period; not every painting is Paleolithic.
31. **Prehistoric** = no writing. **Proto-historic** = undeciphered script (Indus / Copper Age). **Historic** North India is often dated from about the **6th century BCE**.
32. **Damdama** has a **triple** burial; **Sarai Nahar Rai** has a **four-skeleton** grave. Bone implements cluster at **Mahadaha** and **Sarai Nahar Rai**.
33. **Lahuradewa** (Sant Kabir Nagar) is the booklet key for earliest subcontinental **agriculture / rice** when listed; otherwise **Mehrgarh** is the wheat–barley settled-life key.
34. **OCP** was christened by **B.B. Lal** at **Hastinapur**. **Jorwe** adults lie **north–south** under house floors; children often rest in **double urns**.
35. The **Kayatha** culture sits on the **Chambal in Madhya Pradesh** and is known for sturdy **red-slipped** ware. It is not Malwa Navdatoli and not Ahar–Banas.
36. The **Savalda** culture on the **Tapi in Maharashtra** is the **pre-Jorwe** Deccan Chalcolithic horizon. **Jorwe** is the later painted black-on-red phase with Inamgaon as type site.
37. **Ganeshwar–Jodhpura** in Rajasthan is a copper-working culture that supplied metal toward the Harappan zone. **Balathal** shows an early fortification-like wall in the Ahar belt.
38. Prehistory is dated by **tool typology**, **stratigraphy** (deeper = older), **pollen**, **C-14** (organic only), and **TL/OSL** (fired clay / sediments). Stratigraphy alone cannot print "2600 BCE."
39. **Patne** in Maharashtra is Upper Paleolithic and is known for **ostrich eggshell** beads. **Kurnool caves** (Andhra Pradesh) yield Upper Paleolithic **bone** tools.
40. **Hunsgi** and **Isampur** in Karnataka are Acheulian factory / quarry sites. **Gudiyam** in Tamil Nadu is a Paleolithic rock-shelter / cave site.
41. **Ahar–Banas** (Mewar, Rajasthan, about **2100–1500 BCE**) is **contemporary with the Harappan** civilisation, knew **rice**, and used white-painted **black-and-red ware**. The stem "rice was unknown to them" is false.
42. **Adamgarh** near Hoshangabad, Madhya Pradesh, shows a Paleolithic-to-Mesolithic sequence on the Narmada and early domestication claims. **Sivapithecus** Siwalik fossils are **not** *Homo* evidence against Hathnora.

📋 Must-score facts — period, site, excavator

Period ↔ tool / economy

Period	Lock
Lower Paleolithic	Handaxes / cleavers (**Acheulian**)

Period	Lock
Middle Paleolithic	Flakes (Levallois)
Upper Paleolithic	Blades, burins, scrapers
Mesolithic	**Microliths** (1–8 cm); hunting–gathering
Neolithic	Polished stone; pottery; farming
Chalcolithic	Copper + stone; **rural** villages
Soanian	Pebble chopper–chopping (Soan–Siwalik)
Acheulian	Handaxe–cleaver (peninsula / Narmada)

Site ↔ specialty

Site	Lock
Hathnora (MP)	*Homo erectus*; **Arun Sonakia 1982**
Attirampakkam (TN)	Old Acheulian **tools** (~1.5 mya); no fossil
Pallavaram (TN)	First Paleolithic tools; **Foote 1863**
Bagor (RJ)	Mesolithic **domestication** (V.N. Misra)
Baghor (MP)	Upper Paleolithic **shrine** (Son valley)
Sarai Nahar Rai / Mahadaha / Damdama	UP Mesolithic **burials** (Pratapgarh)
Mehrgarh	Earliest farming (~**7000 BCE**); wheat–barley; aceramic I
Koldihwa	Belan **rice-husk** pottery (G.R. Sharma)
Mahagara	Belan **cattle pen / hoof marks**
Lahuradewa	Sant Kabir Nagar early **rice** (not Belan)
Burzahom	Kashmir **pit dwellings** + dog burial
Chirand (Bihar)	Bone / antler tools
Bhimbetka (MP)	Rock shelters; **Wakankar 1957–58**; UNESCO 2003
Inamgaon	**Jorwe** type site (MH)
Navdatoli	**Malwa** culture (Sankalia)
Hastinapur	Classic **OCP** (B.B. Lal)

UP Stone Age cluster

Belan (Chopani Mando, Koldihwa, Mahagara) · **Lahuradewa** · Pratapgarh Mesolithic · **Morhana Pahar** · **Lekhahia**

Topic 2 — Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)

Consolidated — 40 Must-Score Facts

1. The Indus Valley Civilization is a **Bronze Age urban** culture. The Mature phase is about **2600–1900 BCE**. Early is roughly **3300–2600 BCE** and Late about **1900–1300 BCE**.
2. It is also called **Harappan** after the first excavated site. The economy type in match-lists is **Urban**, not pastoral. Pastoral belongs to the Rigvedic age.
3. **Charles Masson** noticed Harappa ruins in **1826**. **Daya Ram Sahni** excavated Harappa in **1921**. **R.D. Banerji** excavated Mohenjo-daro in **1922**. **John Marshall** announced the civilization in **1924**.
4. Geographic extremes are **Sutkagen-dor** (west), **Alamgirpur** (आलमगीरपुर) in Meerut, UP (east), **Manda** (मांडा) on the Chenab in Jammu (north), and **Daimabad** in Maharashtra (south).
5. Uttar Pradesh Harappan sites are **Alamgirpur** (Meerut), **Hulas** (हुलास) (Saharanpur), and **Mandi** (मंडी) (Muzaffarnagar). **Rakhigarhi** is in Hisar, **Haryana**, not Uttar Pradesh.
6. **Alamgirpur** marks the **eastern boundary** of Harappan culture. Do not give that role to Rakhigarhi or Manda.
7. **Sanauli / Sinauli** (सनौली) in Baghpat, Uttar Pradesh (ASI, D.V. Sharma & S.K. Manjul, **2018**), is a Late Harappan / Copper Hoard necropolis with **wooden-wheel chariots**, copper-antenna swords, and coffined burials (~2000–1800 BCE). It is **not** a Mature grid-city with a Great Bath.
8. The **Great Bath** is at **Mohenjo-daro** (मोहनजोदड़ो). The famous **dockyard** (गोदीबाड़ा) is at **Lothal** (Gujarat), excavated by **S.R. Rao**. Boat evidence is linked with Mohenjo-daro and Lothal.
9. **Dholavira** (धोलावीरा) in Gujarat is known for water reservoirs, a **three-part** town plan (citadel, middle town, lower town), and a large **signboard**. UNESCO listed it in **2021**.
10. **Kalibangan** (कालीबंगा) in Rajasthan shows a **ploughed field** and **fire altars**. Its drainage is weaker than Mohenjo-daro's.
11. **Chanhudaro** (चन्हूदड़ो) is a craft town famous for **bead-making** and has **no citadel**.
12. Harappan bricks commonly follow the ratio **1: 2: 4**. Cities show a **citadel** (usually west) and a larger **lower town** (east).
13. The civilization used **bronze** (copper plus tin). There was **no iron** and **no coined money**. The script on seals is still **unread**.
14. The most common seal animal is the **unicorn**. Weights often follow a binary and decimal pattern with a key unit of **16**.
15. Cotton is among the **earliest** known Harappan plant fibres. Agriculture included wheat, barley, and pulses; rice appears at some eastern or later contexts.
16. Match facts for scattered sites include **Balu–Haryana**, **Manda–Jammu & Kashmir**, **Padri–Gujarat**, and **Hulas–Uttar Pradesh**.
17. **Rakhigarhi** in Hisar is the **largest Harappan site in India**. Size does not make it the eastern boundary.
18. **Surkotada** in Gujarat is often cited for **horse** bone claims. Treat the claim carefully; it is not a pan-Harappan horse culture.
19. **Banawali** in Haryana shows Early and Mature levels and a plough-mark tradition similar in spirit to Kalibangan.
20. **OCP** (Ochre Coloured Pottery) of the western UP doab overlaps Late Harappan decline and comes **before PGW**. It is rural ochre-wash pottery, not mature urban Harappan ware.
21. Copper Hoard objects (harpoons, celts, anthropomorphs) often appear with the doab **OCP** belt. They are not proof of a second Indus capital in Uttar Pradesh.
22. Foreign trade reached Mesopotamia; Meluhha in Mesopotamian texts is commonly linked with the Indus. Ports and coastal Gujarat matter more than any UP river dock.
23. Decline around **1900 BCE** is read as climate shift, river drying, and de-urbanisation. Wheeler's Aryan-massacre story at Mohenjo-daro is **rejected**.

24. **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar, UP) must not be confused with **Manda** (Jammu, northernmost site).
25. **Lothal** is the dockyard fact. **Dholavira** is the reservoir-and-signboard fact. Do not swap those identities.
26. Harappan religion shows mother-goddess figurines, a "Pashupati"-like seal, and sacred animals; there are **no** large free-standing temples of later Hindu type.
27. **Mortimer Wheeler** improved excavation method at Harappa but did **not** discover the civilization. Discovery credit stays with Sahni, Banerji, and Marshall's announcement.
28. **B.B. Lal** excavated **Kalibangan** and later Hastinapur OCP levels. **R.S. Bisht** excavated **Dholavira** and Banawali.
29. Doab pottery sequence runs **Late Harappan / OCP** → **PGW** → **NBPW**. Keep that order for Later Vedic and mahajanapada questions.
30. Harappan sites in Uttar Pradesh are the **eastern fringe**, smaller and pottery-heavy, not Indus-core megacities like Mohenjo-daro or Harappa.
31. IVC is **proto-historic**: writing exists but the script is **undeciphered**. It is a **Bronze Age** culture with **no iron**.
32. The **cow** is **not** shown on Harappan seals or terracotta; unicorn, bull, elephant, rhino, and tiger are.
33. Decline theories to name: flood (Marshall / Mackay / S.R. Rao), Aryan attack (Wheeler — now rejected), climate (Stein / Ghosh), geological change (M.R. Sahni / Lambrick), epidemic (Kennedy). IIT Kharagpur drought reading cites about **900** dry years.
34. **Cemetery R-37** = Harappa Mature coffin cemetery; **Cemetery H** = Late Harappan urn / fractional burial at Harappa. **Dockyard** = Lothal; **ploughed field** = Kalibangan; **Dancing Girl** = Mohenjo-daro.
35. **Early Harappan** builds regional cultures and fortifications before full urban grids; **Mature** is the peak of citadel–lower-town planning; **Late** is de-urbanisation and regional successors including doab OCP overlap.
36. Harappan polity leaves **no** royal palace names or king-lists. Organisation reads as **civic / corporate elite** control (standard brick, seals, weights), not a named pharaoh-style monarchy.
37. **Daimabad** (Maharashtra) is the southernmost Harappan / Late Harappan site and yielded famous **bronze** figurines (chariot, buffalo, elephant, rhino). Those bronzes are **not** the same as Sanauli's wooden chariot burials.
38. **Chanhudaro** = bead craft town, **no citadel**. **Harappa** = granaries and Cemetery R-37. **Mohenjo-daro** = Great Bath and Dancing Girl. Keep site signatures separate.
39. Weights follow a binary then decimal series with a key unit near **16**. Trade seals are often **steatite**; the most common animal motif is the **unicorn**.
40. **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar jewellery / treasure find) and **Hulas** (Saharanpur) are the usual UP Harappan pair in stems. **Sanauli** is Baghpat Late Harappan / OCP — add it only when chariots or coffins are asked.

📋 Must-score facts — site, excavator, UP trio

Discoverer / excavator ↔ site

Person	Lock
Charles Masson	Noticed Harappa **1826**
Daya Ram Sahni	Excavated **Harappa 1921**
R.D. Banerji	Excavated **Mohenjo-daro 1922**
John Marshall	Announced civilization **1924**
S.R. Rao	**Lothal** dockyard
B.B. Lal	**Kalibangan**
R.S. Bisht	**Dholavira**

Site ↔ specialty

Site	Lock
Mohenjo-daro	**Great Bath**; boat models
Lothal	**Dockyard**; boat models
Dholavira	Reservoirs; 3-part plan; signboard; UNESCO **2021**
Kalibangan	Ploughed field; fire altars
Chanhudaro	Bead craft; **no citadel**
Rakhigarhi	Largest Harappan site in **India** (Haryana)
Surkotada	Horse-bone claims (careful)
Sanauli (Baghpat, UP)	Late Harappan / OCP **chariots** (2018)

Geographic extremes

Extreme	Site
West	**Sutkagen-dor**
East	**Alamgirpur** (Meerut, UP)
North	**Manda** (Chenab, J&K)
South	**Daimabad** (MH)

UP Harappan trio

Site	District
Alamgirpur	Meerut (eastern boundary)
Hulas	Saharanpur / Baghpat belt
Mandi	Muzaffarnagar / Bijnor belt

Trap: Mandi (UP) ≠ Manda (J&K). Rakhigarhi ≠ UP.

Quick locks

Fact	Lock
Mature phase	**~2600–1900 BCE**
Brick ratio	**1 : 2 : 4**
Metal	Bronze; **no iron**; **no coined money**
Script	Undeciphered seals
Common seal animal	**Unicorn**
Economy type	**Urban** (not pastoral)

Topic 3 — Vedic Civilization

Consolidated — 42 Must-Score Facts

1. The **Early / Rigvedic** age is about **1500–1000 BCE** in the **Sapta Sindhu** (Punjab) belt. Its economy type is **pastoral**.
2. The **Later Vedic** age is about **1000–600 BCE** in the **Ganga–Yamuna doab**, including much of western–central Uttar Pradesh. Its economy type is **agrarian**, with iron and **PGW**.
3. The Early Vedic **rajan** (राजन) was a tribal chief, not an absolute king. Later Vedic kingship became more **hereditary** and stronger over land and ritual.
4. **Sabha** (सभा) was an assembly of elders or nobles. **Samiti** (समिति) was the wider tribal assembly that could **choose the rajan** (राजन).
5. **Vidatha** (विदथ / विधाता) is the **oldest** gathering, with economic and ritual roles and women's presence. It **fades first** in Later Vedic times.
6. **Bhagadugha** (भागदुघ) collected the king's share (**bhaga** (भाग)). **Sangrahitri** (संग्रहीतृ) was the **treasurer**. **Akshavapa** (अक्षावाप) handled **dice / gambling**. Do not swap revenue with dice.
7. The **Rigveda** (ऋग्वेद) has **1028** hymns in **10 mandalas**. Mandala **2–7** are the oldest family books. Mandala **9** is Soma. Mandalas **1** and **10** are latest.
8. Hymn-count facts are roughly **Indra ~250**, **Agni ~200**, **Soma ~120**, and **Ashvins 50+**. **Varuna** has fewer hymns but guards **rita** (ऋत - cosmic moral order).
9. Early popular gods are **Indra, Agni, Soma, Varuna, Ushas, and Savitr**. **Vishnu** and **Rudra** are minor in the Rigveda and rise in Later Vedic religion.
10. Later Vedic ritual elevates **Prajapati**, and **Vishnu** and **Rudra** grow in importance beside older storm and fire gods.
11. **Shukla (White) Yajurveda** is the **Vajasaneyi** (वाजसनेयी) school, with mantra and prose kept separate. **Krishna** (कृष्णा) here means **Black Yajurveda**, not the god Krishna.
12. Black Yajurveda schools include **Taittiriya** (तैत्तिरीय), **Kathaka**, and **Maitrayani**, where mantra and Brahmana prose are mixed.
13. Vedic literature order is **Samhita (संहिता) → Brahmana (ब्राह्मण) → Aranyaka (आरण्यक) → Upanishad (उपनिषद्)**. Samhitas are hymns; Brahmanas explain ritual in prose.
14. **Aranyakas** (आरण्यक) are forest texts of symbolic ritual. **Upanishads** (उपनिषद्) teach **Brahman–Atman** philosophy (Vedanta).
15. The six **Vedangas** (वेदांग) are **Shiksha (शिक्षा - phonetics), Kalpa (कल्प - rituals), Vyakarana (व्याकरण - grammar), Nirukta (निरुक्त - etymology), Chhanda (छन्द - metrics), and Jyotisha (ज्योतिष - astronomy)**. They are tools of the Veda, not the Upanishads themselves.
16. **Varna** (वर्ण) is the four-fold order (Purusha Sukta; more rigid later). **Jati** (जाति) is later birth-group identity. Do not treat them as identical.
17. **Gavishti** (गविष्टि) means cattle-raid or war for cows. **Bali** (बलि) is tribute to the king. **Nishka** (निष्क) is a gold ornament or value-unit, **not** coined money.
18. **Shruti** (श्रुति) is "heard" Vedic revelation. **Smriti** (स्मृति) is remembered later dharma literature.
19. **PGW** (Painted Grey Ware), about **1100–600 BCE**, is the Later Vedic **doab** (दोआब) marker: grey pottery with black geometric paint.
20. Later Vedic iron appears in texts as **shyama ayas / krishna ayas** (श्याम अयस / कृष्ण अयस). Early Rigvedic **ayas** (अयस) usually means copper or bronze, not iron.
21. Doab pottery sequence continues **PGW → NBPW** (~700–200 BCE) into the mahajanapada / second-urbanisation age.
22. Uttar Pradesh Later Vedic geography centres on **Kuru–Panchala**, **Kosala**, and **Kashi**. Key sites include **Hastinapur** (हस्तिनापुर), **Atranjikhera**, and **Ahichchhatra**.

23. Rigvedic culture is **not** a UP heartland story. Its core is Punjab / Sapta Sindhu.
24. **OCP** is pre-PGW ochre-wash doab rural pottery. **PGW** is iron-age painted grey ware of Later Vedic settlements.
25. Later Vedic society shows stronger **raja** (राजा), rising **Brahmana** (ब्राह्मण) ritual power, more settled agriculture, and clearer varna ranking than the Early Vedic pastoral tribes.
26. Political institutions to fact are **Sabha, Samiti, and Vidatha**. Vidatha fades; Sabha becomes more exclusive; Samiti remains the broader tribal body in Early Vedic memory.
27. The **Atharvaveda** (अथर्ववेद) adds charms and domestic rites beside the three liturgical Vedas (Rig, Yajur, Sama).
28. **Brahmana** texts are ritual prose, not the same as the **Brahmana** varna. Context decides which meaning is asked.
29. **Videha** (north Bihar, Janaka tradition) is east of the UP doab but linked in Later Vedic texts such as the Shatapatha Brahmana.
30. Match economy types carefully: Indus = **Urban**, Rigvedic = **Pastoral**, Later Vedic = **Agrarian**, Medieval landlordism is a later match-list item.
31. **Arya** in classical Sanskrit means a **noble** person. Homeland theories include Tilak's **Arctic** (*The Arctic Home in the Vedas*), Max Müller's **Central Asia**, and others — none is a closed scientific proof.
32. **Sindhu** is named most often in the Rigveda; **Saraswati** is the most sacred (*Naditama / Devitama / Matetama* / नदीतमा, देवितमा, मातेतमा). Afghanistan rivers in the hymns include **Kubha, Krumu, Gomati, Suvastu**.
33. **Gayatri** (RV III.62.10, Vishvamitra → Savitr); **Satyameva Jayate** (*Mundaka*); **Tamaso mā jyotir gamaya** (*Brihadaranyaka*); Nachiketa–Yama (*Katha*).
34. **Boghaz-köi** (Hittite / Asia Minor) names **Indra, Varuna, Mitra, Nasatya**. Cow is **aghanya** (अघन्या - not to be killed). **Dasharajna** (दशराज्ञ युद्ध) was fought on the **Parushni** (परुष्णी / रावी).
35. Later Vedic kings advertise power through **Rajasuya** (consecration), **Ashvamedha** (horse sacrifice / territory claim), and **Vajapeya**. **Ashvamedha** is treated in the **Shatapatha Brahmana**; **Rajasuya** in the **Aitareya Brahmana**.
36. Four **ashramas** (Brahmacharya → Grihastha → Vanaprastha → Sannyasa) and four **purusharthas** (Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha) are systematized in the Later / post-Vedic horizon.
37. Core Vedic officers: **purohita** (priest-adviser), **senani** (army), **gramani** (village head). Later Vedic **ratnins** expand the jewel-officer household around the king.
38. Early Vedic staple grain is **yava** (barley). Later crop vocabulary adds **vrihi** (rice), **godhuma** (wheat), **mudga**, and **ikshu**. Wealth is still counted in **cows**.
39. The **Purusha Sukta** (Rigveda **X.90**, late Mandala X) names the four **varnas**; **Shudra** appears clearly here. It is **not** the oldest hymn of the Rigveda.
40. Kinship terms **kula / vamsha / gotra** are not the same as **kosha** (treasury). **Gotra** is clan identity; **kosha** is the store.
41. **Sama Veda** is chant / melody drawn largely from Rigvedic verses. **Yajurveda** is the ritual-formula Veda (White / Black schools). **Atharvaveda** is charms and household rites.
42. **Aitareya** and **Shatapatha** are key **Brahmana** texts. **Brihadaranyaka** and **Chandogya** are major early **Upanishads**. **Mundaka** gives *Satyameva Jayate*.

📋 Must-score facts — Early vs Later, assemblies, texts

Age ↔ geography / economy

Age	Lock
Early / Rigvedic (~1500–1000 BCE)	**Sapta Sindhu**; **pastoral**
Later Vedic (~1000–600 BCE)	**Ganga–Yamuna doab**; **agrarian**; iron + **PGW**

Assembly / official ↔ role

Term	Lock
Sabha (सभा)	Elders / nobles
Samiti (समिति)	Wider assembly; could **choose the rajan** (राजन)
Vidatha (विदथ)	Oldest gathering; fades first
Bhagadugha (भागदुघ)	King's share (**bhaga** / भाग) collector
Sangrahitri (संग्रहीतृ)	Treasurer
Akshavapa (अक्षावाप)	Dice / gambling (not revenue)

Veda / text tags

Item	Lock
Rigveda	**1028** hymns; 10 mandalas; 2–7 oldest; 9 = Soma; **Hota** recites
Shukla Yajurveda	**Vajasaneyi**; mantra/prose separate
Krishna Yajurveda	Black; mixed mantra + Brahmana
Literature order	Samhita → Brahmana → Aranyaka → Upanishad
Brahmin Era	**800–600 BCE** (Brahmana prose period; Sutra period = 600–300 BCE)
Six Vedangas	Shiksha, Kalpa, Vyakarana, Nirukta, Chhanda, Jyotisha
Upanayana meters	**Brahmin = Gayatri** · **Kshatriya = Trishtubh** · **Vaishya = Jagati**
Puranas (18)	**Pancha-Lakshana** (Sarga, Pratisarga, Vansa, Manvantara, Vanshanucharita) · **Vishnu Purana = Maurya** · **Vayu Purana = Gupta** · **Matsya = Satavahana**
Mahabharata	**Jayasamhita** (8,800) → **Bharata** (24,000) → **Shatasahasri-Samhita** (100,000)
Upanishads	**Shvetashvatara** = "carried on a white horse" · **Brihadaranyaka** = *Tamaso Ma Jyotirgamaya* & Yagnavalkya-Gargi · **Chandogya** = Satyakama Jabala
Teachers	**Upadhyaya** = taught for livelihood/fees · **Acharya** = initiated & taught full Veda free
PGW	~1100–600 BCE Later Vedic doab marker
OCP → PGW → NBPW	Pottery ladder

Economy type ladder

Indus = Urban · Rigvedic = Pastoral · Later Vedic = Agrarian · Medieval = Land Lordism

UP Later Vedic sites

Hastinapur · Atranjikhera · Ahichchhatra (Kuru–Panchala belt)

Topic 4 — Religious Movements

Consolidated — 48 Must-Score Facts

1. **Shramana** (श्रमण) renouncer traditions (often **nastika** (नास्तिक) / नास्तिक - non-Vedic) include Buddhism, Jainism, Ajivika, and Charvaka. **Astika** (आस्तिक) schools accept the authority of the Veda.
2. Buddha's life geography runs **Lumbini** (birth) → **Bodh Gaya** (enlightenment / सम्बोधि) → **Sarnath** first sermon (**Dharmachakrapravartana** / धर्मचक्रप्रवर्तन - UP) → **Kushinagar** Mahaparinirvana (**Mahaparinirvana** / महापरिनिर्वाण - UP).
3. Key persons: wife **Yashodhara**, son **Rahula**, attendant **Ananda**, Vinaya specialist **Upali**, schismatic **Devadatta**, and first nun **Mahapajapati**.
4. Buddhist Councils in order are **Rajagriha** → **Vaishali** → **Pataliputra** → **Kundalvana** (राजगृह → वैशाली → पाटलिपुत्र → कुण्डलवन). Remember place order, not a bare code.
5. The **Tripitaka** (त्रिपिटक) has three baskets: **Vinaya** (विनयपिटक - monk rules), **Sutta** (सुत्तपिटक - discourses), and **Abhidhamma** (अभिधम्मपिटक - philosophy).
6. The Second Council split produced **Sthaviravada** (स्थविरवाद - elders) and **Mahasanghika** (महासंधिक - great assembly). **Theravada** (थेरवाद / विभज्जवाद) is the surviving Hinayana line linked with the Third Council.
7. **Sarvastivada** (सर्वास्तिवाद) teaches *sarvam asti*, uses **Sanskrit**, and is tied to the Fourth Council at **Kundalvana**. **Vaibhasika (Vaibhashika)** (वैभाषिक) trusts Abhidharma; **Sautrantika** (सौत्रांतिक) trusts sutra only.
8. **Hinayana** (हीनयान) aims at the **arhat** (अर्हत्) and uses Pali. **Mahayana** (महायान) elevates the **bodhisattva** (बोधिसत्व) ideal and uses Sanskrit. **Vajrayana** (वज्रयान) adds tantra and mantra (Padmasambhava toward Tibet).
9. Mahayana philosophy facts: **Madhyamaka** (माध्यमिक / शून्यवाद) of **Nagarjuna** (नागार्जुन) and **Yogacara** (योगाचार / विज्ञानवाद) of **Asanga–Vasubandhu** (असंग एवं वसुबन्धु). Do not confuse Nagarjuna with **Nagasena** (नागसेन).
10. Major bodhisattvas: **Avalokiteshvara / Padmapani** (अवलोकितेश्वर / पद्मपाणि - compassion), **Manjushri** (मंजुश्री - wisdom), **Vajrapani** (वज्रपाणि - power), **Maitreya** (मैत्रेय - future Buddha), and **Tara** (तारा).
11. The *Milinda Panha* is a dialogue between Indo-Greek king **Menander (Milinda)** and monk **Nagasena**.
12. Ashoka convened the **Third Council** at **Pataliputra**. **Dhamma-mahamatras** (धम्म महामात्र) appear in his **14th year**. His Dhamma is **not** simply "taken from the Rahulovada."
13. **Barabar** caves were gifted to **Ajivikas** (आजीविक), not to Buddhists. **Ajanta** (अजंता) is later Buddhist painted cave architecture.
14. **Chaitya** (चैत्य) is a prayer hall. **Vihara** (विहार) is a monastery. Keep the architectural pair straight.
15. Jainism has **24 tirthankaras** (तीर्थंकर). **Mahavira** is the 24th with the **lion** (सिंह) symbol and nirvana at **Pavapuri** (पावापुरी). **Parshvanatha** (पार्श्वनाथ) is the 23rd with the **serpent** (सर्प) and a Varanasi birth tradition.
16. Mahavira's usual timeline is birth about **599 BCE**, renunciation at **30** (गृहत्याग), kevala at **42** (कैवल्य / केवल ज्ञान - supreme omniscience), and nirvana at Pavapuri about **527 BCE** (निर्वाण).
17. Nirvana geography: about **20** tirthankaras at **Sammed Shikhar** (सम्मेद शिखर - Jharkhand). Four separate sites are **Ashtapad**, **Champapuri**, **Girnar**, and **Pavapuri**. **Vasupujya** is **not** Sammed Shikhar (correct = Champapuri).
18. **Rishabhanatha** (ऋषभदेव / आदिनाथ) has an **Ayodhya** birth tradition. **Bahubali / Gomateshwara** (बाहुबली / गोमटेश्वर) is famous but is **not** one of the 24 tirthankaras.
19. **Digambara** (दिगम्बर) monks are sky-clad and deny women's moksha as women. **Svetambara** (श्वेताम्बर) monks wear white and allow women's liberation. **Tattvartha Sutra** is accepted by both.
20. Jain council memory: early Magadhan compilation under **Sthulabhadra** at **Pataliputra**, later work at Mathura / Vallabhi lines, and final Svetambara writing under **Devardhigani** at **Vallabhi**. **Vallabhi** is not Buddhist Vaishali or Kundalvana.
21. Mahavira taught **five** great vows (**Pancha Mahavrata** / पंच महाव्रत: अहिंसा, सत्य, अस्तेय, अपरिग्रह, ब्रह्मचर्य); Parshvanatha's older set is remembered as **four** (**Chaturyama** / चातुर्याम). **Anekantavada** (अनेकांतवाद) is many-sided reality; **Syadvada** (स्याद्वाद) is seven-fold predication.

22. Buddhism teaches **anatta** (अनात्मवाद - no permanent soul). Jainism teaches a real **jiva** (जीव / आत्मा). That soul contrast is a standard confused pair.
23. **Ajivika** (आजीवक) doctrine centres on **Makkhali Gosala** (मक्खलि गोशाल) and fatalist **niyati** (नियतिवाद). **Charvaka / Lokayata** (चार्वाक / लोकायत) is materialist and accepts **perception** only (**Pratyaksha** (प्रत्यक्ष) / प्रत्यक्ष प्रमाण).
24. **Bhagavatism** is the early **Vasudeva-Krishna** cult centred on **Mathura** (मथुरा). The **Heliodorus** pillar at Besnagar shows a Greek ambassador as a Bhagavata.
25. Uttar Pradesh Buddhist circuit facts: **Sarnath** (first sermon), **Kushinagar** (death), **Shravasti / Jetavana**, **Sankisa** (descent tradition), and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी).
26. Uttar Pradesh Jain–Hindu facts: Parshvanatha–**Varanasi** (वाराणसी), Rishabha–**Ayodhya**, Jain images at Mathura **Kankali Tila**, Krishna–**Mathura–Vrindavan**, and Kashi Vishwanath.
27. **Lumbini** (Buddha's birth) is in **Nepal**, not Uttar Pradesh — a common geography trap.
28. Four Noble Truths diagnose **dukkha**. The **Eightfold Path** is the Magga prescription that ends craving.
29. Mahasanghika is an early Vaishali **split school**. Mahayana is the later **great vehicle**. Do not treat the names as identical.
30. Ashokan patronage spread stupas and Dhamma officers, but Barabar remains an **Ajivika** gift. Ghantasala is remembered for **Aryaka-pillars** on a platform.
31. Shaivism centres on **Shiva / linga**. Vaishnavism centres on **Vishnu and avatars**. Bhagavatism is the early Krishna-Vasudeva stream inside the wider Vaishnava world.
32. Heterodox sixth-century teachers include the six titthiyas: Purana Kassapa, Gosala, Ajita, Pakudha, Nigantha (Mahavira), and Sanjaya — the wider shramana field around Buddha.
33. Buddha life symbols: birth **lotus / bull**, Mahabhinishkramana **horse**, enlightenment **Bodhi tree**, first sermon **wheel**, Mahaparinirvana **stupa** (स्तूप).
34. **Rummindei** (रुम्मिनदेई) (Ashoka) proves Lumbini as birthplace.
35. The Buddha's last convert is remembered as **Subhadda**.
36. His last rains are often placed at **Vaishali** (वैशाली).
37. **Mahapajapati** is the first nun, ordained at Vaishali through **Ananda**.
38. Councils presidents: **Mahakassapa** (1st), **Sabakami** (2nd), **Moggaliputta Tissa** (3rd), **Vasumitra** (4th, Ashvaghosha deputy).
39. **Triratna** = Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha.
40. *Light of Asia* is by **Edwin Arnold**, drawn from the *Lalitavistara*.
41. **Nayaputta** is Mahavira, not Buddha.
42. **Karle** has the largest western Hinayana **chaitya** hall. **Bhaja, Bedsa, and Kondane** are sister western chaitya sites.
43. **Ajanta** is famous for Buddhist **paintings** (Phase I aniconic / Hinayana; Phase II Mahayana Padmapani). **Ellora** is multi-religion: Buddhist 1–12, Hindu 13–29, Jain 30–34; Cave **16** Kailasa is **Shaiva**.
44. Stupa vocabulary: **anda** (dome), **harmika** (square railing), **chhatra** (umbrella), **pradakshina** (clockwise walk). **Ghantasala** is the named **aryaka-pillar** platform site.
45. **Sanchi** and **Bharhut** are early stupa / railing sites. Sanchi is **not** tied to one Buddha-life episode the way Lumbini, Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, and Kushinagar are.
46. **Nalanda** carries a Gupta–**Kumaragupta I** foundation tradition. **Vikramashila** is Pala **Dharmapala** (also founded **Somapura Mahavihara** at Paharpur). **Odantapuri** is Pala **Gopala**; **Jagaddala** is Pala **Ramapala**. **Vallabhi** was founded by Maitraka ruler **Bhattarka** in Gujarat.
47. Jain **Chaturyama** (four vows of Parshva) plus Mahavira's added **brahmacharya** make the **Pancha Mahavrata**. **Tattvartha Sutra** is accepted by both Digambara and Svetambara.
48. **First Council** (Rajagriha, Ajatashatru, Mahakassapa) compiles Sutta–Vinaya; **Second** (Vaishali) splits Sthavira / Mahasanghika; **Third** (Pataliputra, Ashoka, Moggaliputta) adds Abhidhamma / missions; **Fourth** (Kundalvana, Kanishka, Vasumitra) seals Mahayana–Hinayana memory.

📋 Must-score facts — Buddha life, councils, Jain tags

Buddha life geography

Event	Place
Birth	**Lumbini** (Nepal)
Enlightenment	**Bodh Gaya**
First sermon	**Sarnath** (UP)
Mahaparinirvana	**Kushinagar** (UP)

Buddhist Councils (order)

Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalvana

Vehicle	Lock
Hinayana	Arhat ideal; Pali
Mahayana	Bodhisattva; Sanskrit
Vajrayana	Tantra / mantra
Tripitaka	Vinaya · Sutta · Abhidhamma

Jain tirthankara tags

Item	Lock
Mahavira (24th)	**Lion**; nirvana **Pavapuri**
Parshvanatha (23rd)	**Serpent**; Varanasi birth tradition
Rishabhanatha	**Ayodhya** birth tradition
~20 tirthankaras	Nirvana at **Sammed Shikhar**
Digambara vs Svetambara	Sky-clad vs white; women's moksha dispute
Anatta vs jiva	Buddhism = no permanent soul; Jainism = real soul

Key persons / texts

Pair	Lock
Menander–Nagasena	*Milinda Panha*
Nagarjuna	Madhyamaka (≠ Nagasena)
Barabar caves	Gifted to **Ajivikas**
Chaitya vs Vihara	Prayer hall vs monastery
Ashoka 3rd Council	**Pataliputra**; Dhamma-mahamatras in **14th** year

Buddha life symbols

Event	Symbol
Birth	Lotus / bull
Great Departure	Horse
Enlightenment	Bodhi tree
First sermon	Wheel
Nirvana	Stupa

Topic 5 — Sixth Century BCE

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. The sixth–fourth centuries BCE bring **iron**, **NBPW**, punch-marked silver (**Aahat**), and the **second urbanisation**. This is still **before** the Mauryan empire.
2. Sources for the sixteen mahajanapadas include the Buddhist **Anguttara Nikaya** and the Jain **Bhagavati Sutra** (different name-set). **Panini's Ashtadhyayi** names about **22** janapadas and stresses **Magadha, Asmaka, and Kamboja**.
3. The four great monarchies were **Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, and Avanti**. Republics (**gana-sangha** (गण-संघ)) include **Vajji** and **Malla**. Papers often call the **Licchavis of Vaishali** the world's first republic.
4. **Vajji** was a confederacy with capital **Vaishali** (वैशाली) (called *Magadhham Puram* in the Suttanipata). **Malla** held **Kushinagar** (कुशीनगर) and **Pava**. **Asmaka** was the only mahajanapada **south of the Vindhyas**.
5. Classic capital matches: **Matsya–Viratnagar**, **Kuru–Indraprastha**, **Surasena–Mathura**, **Asmaka–Potana**, **Chedi–Suktimati / Sotthivati**, **Anga–Champa**.
6. Early strongest was often **Kashi** (काशी). **Anga** was Magadha's first major bite. **Avanti** survived until the **Shishunaga** conquest.
7. Eight mahajanapadas touch **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश): Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Kuru, Panchala, Malla, Surasena, and Chedi.
8. Not UP: **Magadha / Anga / Vajji** are Bihar-centred, **Avanti** is Madhya Pradesh, and **Matsya** is Rajasthan.
9. UP capital facts: Kashi–**Varanasi** (वाराणसी), Kosala–**Ayodhya / Shravasti** (crescent plan at Saheth–Maheth), Vatsa–**Kaushambi** (कौशांबी), Kuru–**Hastinapur / Indraprastha**, Panchala–**Ahichchhatra / Kampilya**, Malla–**Kushinagar**, Surasena–**Mathura** (मथुरा), Chedi–Bundelkhand edge.
10. **Rajagriha / Girivraja** was early Magadha's hill capital. **Ajatashatru** (अजातशत्रु) fortifies / founds the **Pataligrama** seed; **Udayin** first makes **Pataliputra** (पाटलिपुत्र) the capital (Ganga north, Son west).
11. Haryanka order: **Bimbisara** (alliances and **Anga**) → **Ajatashatru** (war on **Vajji**, *rathamusala* (रथमुसल)) → **Udayin** (Pataliputra as capital).
12. **Shishunaga** rule took **Avanti**. **Kalashoka** is linked with the **Second Buddhist Council**. The last Shishunaga is often named **Nandivardhana**.
13. **Mahapadma Nanda** is remembered as *ekarat* (एकराट्) / *sarvakshatrantaka* (सर्वक्षत्रान्तक) / *ugrasena* (उग्रसेन) / *aparoparashurama* (अपरोपरशुराम). **Dhana Nanda** was the last Nanda, called **Agrammes** by the Greeks; commander **Bhaddasala**.
14. Greek writers give the Nanda army huge figures (about 2 lakh foot, 20k horse, 2k chariots, 3k elephants). **Alexander never fought** the Nandas.
15. A **janapada** (जनपद) is clan territory. A **mahajanapada** (महाजनपद) is one of the sixteen large states of this age.
16. **Monarchy** means hereditary kingship. **Gana-sangha** (गण-संघ) means oligarchic clan-council rule, as in Vajji. **Yaudheya** is a later gana — not in the Buddha-period "early republic" list that papers use.
17. **NBPW** (Northern Black Polished Ware) is the deluxe black pottery of mahajanapada / early historic cities. It is **not** Later Vedic **PGW**.
18. Magadha rose through river trade, iron, elephants, and aggressive conquest from Anga toward Vajji and finally Avanti.
19. **Champa** (epic **Malini**) was the river-port capital of **Anga**. **Varanasi** was the capital of **Kashi**. Do not swap them.
20. **Potana** is the Asmaka capital in standard match lists. Later **Pratishthana / Paithan** belongs to Satavahana geography, not the 2020 Asmaka key.
21. **Kushinagar** and **Pava** are **Malla** towns. Jain **Pavapuri** (पावापुरी) (Mahavira's nirvana) is a Magadha-site fact, not the same as Malla Pava in every stem.
22. Magadha's expansion wars should be read as Cause → Course → Result: Anga first, then Kosala/Vajji pressure, then Avanti under Shishunaga, then Nanda imperial climax before Mauryas.

23. Punch-marked **silver** (रूपक) coins and NBPW mark the money-and-city package of second urbanisation.
24. **Ajatashatru** is the parricide king who broke the Licchavi confederacy. **Bimbisara** is the alliance-builder who took Anga. **Jivaka** was Bimbisara's physician, sent also to treat **Chanda Pradyota** of Avanti.
25. The sixteen names are fixed furniture; capitals and UP/non-UP sorting decide most prelims marks.
26. Second urbanisation centres sit on river corridors of the middle Ganga, not on Harappan Indus grids. Six Buddha-age metros in the *Mahaparinirvana-sutra*: **Champa, Rajagriha, Varanasi, Saketa, Kaushambi, Shravasti**.
27. After the Nandas comes the Mauryan takeover under **Chandragupta** (चंद्रगुप्त) — that story belongs to the next topic, not this one.
28. Keep pottery chronology: **PGW** (Later Vedic) then **NBPW** (mahajanapada / early historic). Mixing them is a frequent trap.
29. **Udayana–Vasavadatta** (Bhasa's *Svapnavasavadattam* (स्वप्नवासवदत्तम्)) is tied to **Ujjain** (उज्जैन), not to Kaushambi alone as the love-story setting.
30. **Kalpi** (ancient **Kalpriya**) sits on the **Yamuna** (यमुना) in Jalaun (UP). Dynasty dates for Magadha houses: Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya → Shunga.
31. **Prasenjit** of **Kosala** (Shravasti) is Buddha's contemporary monarch. **Udayana** of **Vatsa** (Kaushambi) is the other famous middle-Ganga king of the same horizon.
32. **Ghositarama** at Kaushambi is the famous Buddhist monastery of the Vatsa capital. **Saheth–Maheth** is the twin mound of **Shravasti**.
33. Magadha's geographic advantages are **iron**, **elephants**, **Ganga–Son** river trade, and aggressive conquest from **Anga** toward **Vajji** and finally **Avanti**.
34. Canonical Buddhist sixteen are fixed furniture; Jain **Bhagavati** uses a different name-set. Capitals and UP/non-UP sorting decide most stems.

📋 Must-score facts — capitals, UP list, Magadha order

Master Table — All 16 Mahajanapadas (सोलह महाजनपद)

(Canonical list according to Buddhist Anguttara Nikaya and Jain Bhagavati Sutra; high-yield for match-the-column with ancient capitals & modern regions)

No.	Mahajanapada (महाजनपद)	Capital(s) (राजधानी)	Modern Region (वर्तमान क्षेत्र)	Polity Type / Contemporary Ruler	High-Yield Exam Note
1	**Kashi** (काशी)	**Varanasi** (वाराणसी)	Varanasi, UP	Monarchy; King Ashvasena (Parshvanatha's father)	Conquered by Kosala before Buddha's death
2	**Kosala** (कोसल)	**Shravasti** (श्रावस्ती) / Ayodhya / Saketa	Faizabad, Gonda, Bahraich (Awadh, UP)	Monarchy; King **Prasenjit** (contemporary of Buddha)	Sarayu river divided into North (Shravasti) & South (Kushavati)
3	**Anga** (अंग)	**Champa** (चंपा) (ancient Malini)	Bhagalpur & Munger, Bihar	Monarchy; King Brahmadatta	Annexed by Bimbisara into Magadha; great river trade port
4	**Magadha** (मगध)	**Girivraja / Rajagriha** → **Pataliputra**	Patna, Gaya, Nalanda, Bihar	Monarchy; Bimbisara, Ajatashatru	Emerged as the supreme empire of 6th c. BCE
5	**Vajji** (वृज्जि)	**Vaishali** (वैशाली)	Muzaffarpur, Vaishali, N. Bihar	**Gana-Sangha** (Confederacy of 8 clans including Lichchhavis)	World's first republic; Ajatashatru defeated after 16-yr war
6	**Malla** (मल्ल)	**Kushinagar** (कुशीनगर) & **Pava** (पावा)	Deoria, Gorakhpur, Kushinagar, UP	**Gana-Sangha** (Oligarchy/Republic)	Buddha attained *Mahaparinirvana* at Kushinagar; Mahavira at Pava

No.	Mahajanapada (महाजनपद)	Capital(s) (राजधानी)	Modern Region (वर्तमान क्षेत्र)	Polity Type / Contemporary Ruler	High-Yield Exam Note
7	**Chedi** (चेदि)	**Suktimati** (शुक्तिमती) / Sotthivati	Bundelkhand (UP & MP borders)	Monarchy; King Shishupala (Mahabharata)	Located along Ken river (*Shuktimati*)
8	**Vatsa** (वत्स)	**Kaushambi** (कौशाम्बी)	Prayagraj & Kaushambi, UP	Monarchy; King **Udayana** (hero of *Svapnavasavadattam*)	Famous Buddhist centre; Ghositarama monastery
9	**Kuru** (कुरु)	**Indraprastha** (इन्द्रप्रस्थ) / Hastinapur	Meerut, Delhi, Thanesar (Haryana/UP)	Monarchy → later republican tendencies	King Koravya at Buddha's time
10	**Panchala** (पांचाल)	North: **Ahichchhatra** (बरेली); South: **Kampilya** (फर्रुखाबाद)	Bareilly, Badaun, Farrukhabad (Rohilkhand, UP)	Monarchy → later Gana-Sangha	Divided by Ganga into North & South Panchala
11	**Matsya** (मत्स्य)	**Viratnagar** (विराटनगर / Bairat)	Jaipur, Alwar, Bharatpur (Rajasthan)	Monarchy	King Sujata; annexed into Magadha empire
12	**Surasena** (शूरसेन)	**Mathura** (मथुरा)	Mathura, Braj region, UP	Monarchy; King Avantiputra (disciple of Buddha)	Associated with Yadava clan & Krishna cult
13	**Ashmaka / Assaka** (अश्मक)	**Potana / Potali / Podana / Potil** (पोटिल)	Godavari Valley (Maharashtra / Telangana)	Monarchy; King Brahmadatta	**ONLY Mahajanapada situated South of Vindhyas / on Godavari river**
14	**Avanti** (अवन्ति)	North: **Ujjain** (उज्जयिनी); South: **Mahishmati** (माहिष्मती)	Malwa region, Madhya Pradesh	Monarchy; King **Pradyota** (*Chanda Pradyota*)	Vetravati river divided it; physician Jivaka sent by Bimbisara
15	**Gandhara** (गांधार)	**Taxila** (तक्षशिला) & Pushkalavati	Rawalpindi, Peshawar, NWFP (Pakistan)	Monarchy; King Pukkusati	Famous university & trade crossroad on Uttarapatha
16	**Kamboja** (कंबोज)	**Rajapura / Rajpur** (राजपुर) / Hathaka	Hazara, Kashmir border, Pamir/Hindukush	Monarchy → later republic	Renowned for fine breed of **horses** (*Ashva-kendra*)

Geographical Classification of the 16 Mahajanapadas:

- **8 in Modern Uttar Pradesh:** Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Malla, Surasena, Panchala, Kuru (partly), Chedi (partly).
- **3 in Bihar:** Magadha, Anga, Vajji.
- **1 in Madhya Pradesh:** Avanti (plus parts of Chedi).
- **1 in Rajasthan:** Matsya.
- **1 in South India (Godavari basin):** Ashmaka (Assaka).
- **2 in Northwest / Beyond Indus:** Gandhara, Kamboja.
- **Gana-Sanghas (Republics / Non-monarchical): Vajji** (8 confederate clans) and **Malla** (two branches: Pava and Kushinara).

Master Breakdown — The 5 Buddhist Nikayas of Sutta Pitaka (सुत्तपिटक के 5 निकाय)

The **Sutta Pitaka** (doctrine & dialogues of Buddha, recited by **Ananda** at the 1st Buddhist Council) is divided into **five Nikayas**:

Nikaya (निकाय)	Meaning / Scope	Key Suttas & Canonical Contents	High-Yield PYQ Reference
1. Digha Nikaya (दीघ निकाय)	*Long Discourses* (34 long suttas)	• **Mahaparinibbana Sutta** (Buddha's final days, relics, last words) • **Brahmajala Sutta** (62 philosophical wrong views) • **Ambattha Sutta** (caste debate) • **Sigalovada Sutta** (layman ethics)	UPPCS Spl Pre 2004 Q2 (Digha Nikaya = Buddhist canonical text, not Jain)
2. Majjhima Nikaya (मज्झिम निकाय)	*Middle-length Discourses* (152 suttas)	• **Angulimala Sutta** (conversion of bandit Angulimala) • **Ratthapala Sutta** • Dialogues on meditation, karma, dependent origination (*Pratityasamutpada*)	UPPCS Pre 2008 (canon classification)
3. Samyutta Nikaya (संयुक्त निकाय)	*Connected / Grouped Discourses* (~2,900 suttas)	• **Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta** (First Sermon at Sarnath; Four Noble Truths & Eightfold Path) • Anattalakkhana Sutta (no-soul doctrine)	Core source for Four Noble Truths & Eightfold Path
4. Anguttara Nikaya (अंगुत्तर निकाय)	*Numerical / Gradual Discourses* (over 9,500 short suttas)	• **Lists the 16 Mahajanapadas** (सोलह महाजनपद सूची) • Grouped by numbers: sets of 1s, 2s, 3s… up to 11s	Direct source for 16 Mahajanapadas list
5. Khuddaka Nikaya (खुद्दक निकाय)	*Minor Collection* (15 distinct poetic & narrative books)	• **Jatakas** (547 stories of Buddha's previous births) • **Dhammapada** (423 verses of moral wisdom) • **Theragatha** (verses of elder monks) • **Therigatha** (verses of elder nuns - earliest women's poetry) • Sutta Nipata, Khuddakapatha	UPPCS 2008 / Mains: Jatakas & Therigatha belong to Khuddaka Nikaya

Topic 6 — Foreign Invasions

Consolidated — 42 Must-Score Facts

1. North-west doors into India are the **Khyber** and **Bolan** routes. After Achaemenid Persians came Macedon, then **Indo-Greek → Shaka → Parthian → Kushan**.
2. Correct invader order is **Greeks → Sakas → Kushans**. Kushans do **not** come before Sakas.
3. **Darius I** (about **518 BCE**) took **Gandhara** (गांधार) and **Hindush** as the **20th** satrapy with gold-dust tribute. Behistun lists many provinces of his empire; Herodotus makes India the twentieth. **Skylax** explored the Indus. **Kharoshthi** (खरोष्ठी) grew from Aramaic. **Ctesias** was physician to **Artaxerxes II**.
4. **Alexander** entered India about **327–325 BCE** (year often **326**). The campaign lasted roughly **19 months**. He returned west from the Indus mouth / Paatal region about **325 BCE**.
5. **Ambhi** of Taxila was Alexander's **ally**. **Porus** fought him at the **Hydaspes (Jhelum)** and was then restored and enlarged.
6. The army mutinied at the **Hyphasis (Beas)**. Alexander raised twelve altars there and turned back. Hydaspes is the battle; Beas is the turn-back.
7. On the return, Alexander stormed **Sangala**, was wounded among the **Malloi**, sent **Nearchus** by sea, crossed harsh **Gedrosia**, and died at Babylon in **323 BCE**.
8. **Kalanos** went with Alexander and later self-immolated. **Dandamis** refused to follow. **Aristotle** tutored Alexander but **never** came to India. **Deimachus** also did **not** come with Alexander — he is later Seleucid envoy to **Bindusara** (बिन्दुसार).
9. Greek writers' **Sandrokottos** is **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य) — the main Greek peg for early Indian chronology. Last Nanda **Dhana** is **Agrammes / Xandrames**; commander **Bhaddasala**.
10. **Seleucus Nicator** fought Chandragupta about **305–303 BCE**, ceded Arachosia, Gedrosia, and Paropamisadae, and received **500 elephants** plus the envoy **Megasthenes** (मेगस्थनीज).
11. Those elephants later mattered at **Ipsus (301 BCE)** in the western Diadochi wars.
12. Indo-Greek power grew after **Diodotus** freed Bactria and **Demetrius** entered India. **Menander (Milinda)** ruled from **Sagala** (Sialkot) and dialogued with **Nagasena** (नागसेन).
13. Early Indo-Greek coins of **Agathocles / Pantaleon** show Brahmi and Vaishnava types (Balarama / Vasudeva). Portrait die-struck coins carry Greek and Kharoshthi.
14. The **Heliodorus** pillar at **Besnagar** (about **113 BCE**) shows a Greek ambassador as a Bhagavata. The *Yuga Purana* remembers Yavanas at Pataliputra.
15. **Shakas** (Indo-Scythians) used the title **kshatrapa**. **Maues / Moga** was first strong at Taxila–Gandhara.
16. Western Kshatrapa lines: **Kshaharata Nahapana** was checked by **Gautamiputra Satakarni** (गौतमीपुत्र शातकर्णि) (Nasik). **Kardamaka Chashtana** leads to **Rudradaman** (रुद्रदामन) of the Junagadh Sanskrit inscription.
17. **Sudarshana lake** history runs **Pushyagupta** (Chandragupta Maurya) → **Tushaspha** (Ashoka) → repair by **Rudradaman**.
18. **Parthians (Pahlavas)** under **Gondophares** (about **19–45 CE**) held a brief north-west phase, remembered at **Takht-i-Bahi**, before the Kushan peak.
19. Kushans rose from a **Yuezhi** clan: **Kujula** unified, **Vima** issued famous **gold** (*Shaonanoshao*), and **Kanishka** (कनिष्क) marked the imperial climax.
20. Kushan capitals include **Purushapura** (Peshawar) and **Mathura** (मथुरा). Art schools are **Gandhara** and **Mathura**.
21. Kanishka's Fourth Buddhist Council is placed in **Kashmir** (Vasumitra / Ashvaghosha tradition). The **Shaka era** of **78 CE** is linked with Kanishka, not with Vikrama **57 BCE**.
22. **Devaputra** (देवपुत्र) is a Kushan royal title. The **Rabatak** inscription helps Kushan genealogy.
23. **Sagala** is Menander's Sialkot seat. **Sangala** is the Kathaioi town Alexander stormed. Do not merge the spellings.
24. **Bucephala** commemorated Alexander's horse. **Nicaea** commemorated victory after Hydaspes.

25. **Megasthenes** was Seleucus's envoy after the Chandragupta treaty. **Nearchus** was Alexander's admiral. Keep envoy and admiral separate.
26. Alexander's line stops at the **Beas** (ब्यास). There was **no** Macedonian campaign in Awadh, Kashi, or Magadha.
27. Indo-Greek political centres stay in the north-west (**Taxila / Sagala**). The middle-Ganga foreign layer, including **Mathura**, is mainly **Kushan** (कुषाण).
28. **Maues** is Shaka at Taxila. **Gondophares** is Parthian at Takht-i-Bahi. **Kanishka** is the Kushan peak — three different horizons.
29. **Hathigumpha** is Kharavela's Kalinga cave text. **Junagadh** is Rudradaman's Shaka rock. Do not swap those epigraphs.
30. Persian rule first planted the satrap idea (**kshatrapa**) and Aramaic writing habits that later feed Kharoshthi.
31. Menander is the Indo-Greek **Milinda**. **Nagarjuna** (नागार्जुन) is the later Madhyamaka philosopher — a common name trap beside Nagasena.
32. After Kushan decline, north-west politics again fragment; the next big imperial story in Magadha is Gupta, not another Alexander.
33. Alexander's Indian success is usually read as **no central power**, a **superior army**, and help from **traitorous Indian rulers** (e.g. Ambhi). Being a "good administrator" is **not** a standard cause of that victory.
34. Headline Indo-Greek kings to name: **Demetrius I** (first big Indian push), **Apollodotus** (early Indian-side silver), **Menander / Milinda** (Sagala; *Milinda Panha*), **Antialcidas** (sends Heliodorus), **Agathocleia–Strato I**, late **Hermaeus / Strato II**.
35. Headline Shaka kings: **Maues / Moga** (first at Taxila), **Azes I**, **Nahapana** (नहपान) (Kshaharata; beaten by Gautamiputra), **Chashtana** then **Rudradaman I** (Kardamaka; Junagadh).
36. Headline Kushan kings: **Kujula Kadphises** (unifier; mainly copper) → **Vima Kadphises** (gold; *Shaonanoshao*) → **Kanishka** → **Huvishka** → **Vasudeva I**.
37. The headless **Mat** statue near **Mathura** shows **Kanishka** in Central Asian dress: long quilted coat / caftan, **trousers**, and heavy **padded boots**, holding a **mace** and **sword**.
38. Kushan royal dress is steppe riding kit — **not** the Indian dhoti style of Mauryan royal memory. Coins and Mat / Surkh Kotal portraits keep that look.
39. North Indian **Surya** images often wear tunic, trousers, and boots (**udichya-vesa**) under Shaka–Kushan influence. That boot-clad Surya is a foreign-wave art fact.
40. **Gandhara** art uses grey / green **schist** and Greco-Roman Buddha modelling in the NW. **Mathura** art uses mottled **red sandstone** and indigenous types in **UP**.
41. Early anthropomorphic **Buddha** (बुद्ध) images grow under Indo-Greek to Kushan patronage at both schools. Kanishka's coins and the Sarnath image of monk **Bala** (year 3) are dated Buddhist-icon pegs.
42. Classic **Nataraja** (Chola lost-wax bronze, damaru–agni–Apasmara) is **not** a Kushan sculpture fact. Kushan Mathura shows early **Shiva** as linga / mukhalinga and as **Oesho** on coins — not the Chola Nataraja type.

📋 Must-score facts — Alexander, order, kings

Invader order

Greeks → Sakas → (Parthians) → Kushans

Alexander tags

Item	Lock
Entry	~**327–325 BCE** (~19 months)
Ally	**Ambhi** (Taxila)
Battle	**Hydaspes (Jhelum)** vs Porus

Item	Lock
Turn-back	Army mutiny at **Hyphasis (Beas)**
Admiral	**Nearchus**
Death	Babylon **323 BCE**
Sandrokottos	**Chandragupta Maurya**

Seleucus / Indo-Greek

Item	Lock
Seleucus treaty	~**305–303 BCE**; **500 elephants**; envoy **Megasthenes**
Menander (Milinda)	Capital **Sagala**; *Milinda Panha* with **Nagasena**
Heliodorus pillar	Besnagar ~**113 BCE**; Bhagavata
Sagala vs Sangala	Menander's Sialkot vs Alexander's stormed town

Shaka / Parthian / Kushan

King	Lock
Maues / Moga	First strong Shaka at Taxila
Nahapana	Kshaharata; checked by Gautamiputra
Rudradaman	Kardamaka; **Junagadh** Sanskrit; Sudarshana repair
Gondophares	Parthian; **Takht-i-Bahi**
Kujula	Kushan unifier (mainly copper)
Vima	Imperial **gold**; *Shaonanoshao*
Kanishka	Peak; **Shaka era 78 CE**; 4th Council Kashmir; **Devaputra**

Art pair

Gandhara (Greco-Buddhist schist) · **Mathura** (red sandstone)

Topic 7 — Mauryan Empire

Consolidated — 42 Must-Score Facts

1. The Mauryan empire runs about **322–185 BCE**. Buddhist tradition links the clan to **Moriya / Pipphalivana**; some Puranas smear a "low origin."
2. King order is **Chandragupta (322–297)** → **Bindusara Amitraghata** (अमित्रघात) **(297–273)** → **Ashoka** (अशोक) (accession about **272**, coronation **268–232**) → last **Brihadratha**, killed by **Pushyamitra Shunga (Pushyamitra Sunga)** (पुष्यमित्र शुंग) in **185 BCE**.
3. Chandragupta, guided by **Chanakya / Kautilya**, overthrew the last Nanda (**Dhana Nanda**) and later treaty-settled with **Seleucus** about **303 BCE**.
4. Seleucus ceded north-west districts and received **500 elephants**. **Megasthenes** (मेगस्थनीज) came as envoy and wrote the lost *Indica* (known through Strabo and Arrian).
5. Pliny's army figures for Chandragupta are huge (about 6 lakh foot, 30k horse, 9k elephants). Money used punch-marked **pana** (पण). Material culture shows **NBPW** and ring-wells.
6. Empire extent ran from **Kandahar to Bengal** and Himalaya to Karnataka. **Chola, Pandya, Satiyaputra, and Keralaputra** appear as **neighbours**, not Mauryan provinces.
7. Ashoka's titles include **Devanampiya Piyadassi** (देवानांप्रिय प्रियदर्शी). The personal name **Ashoka** appears at **Maski, Gujarra, Nittur, and Udegolam**.
8. The **Kalinga war** (about **261 BCE**) is narrated in **Rock Edict XIII** (traditional figures of 1 lakh killed and 1.5 lakh deported). Separate Kalinga edicts at **Dhauli / Jaugada** soften the tone ("all men are my children").
9. **Rock Edict XII** teaches **samavaya** (समवाय) — religious concord / synthesis. Do not give that role to RE XIII.
10. **Dhamma-mahamatras** (धम्म महामात्र) were appointed in Ashoka's **14th year** (RE V). Dhamma is ethical **state policy**, not identical with the Buddhist religion he patronised.
11. The Bhabru edict lists Buddhist texts such as *Laghulovada* for monks. That does **not** mean "Ashoka's Dhamma is defined as Rahulovada."
12. Scripts: **Brahmi** (ब्राह्मी) is the main Prakrit script. **Kharoshthi** appears at **Shahbazgarhi** (शाहबाजगढ़ी) and **Mansehra** (मानसेहरा). **Greek and Aramaic** appear at **Kandahar** (कंधार).
13. The **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) four-lion capital is India's **national emblem**. **Ahraura** in Mirzapur is Uttar Pradesh's own **Minor Rock Edict**.
14. **Barabar** caves were gifted to **Ajivikas** (आजीविक). Their polish is Mauryan; they are not Ajanta-style Buddhist painted caves.
15. **Kanaganahalli** (कनगनाहल्ली) preserves a label reading **"Raya Asoka."** Schism edicts appear at Sarnath and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी).
16. **Samaharta** (समाहर्ता) collects revenue. **Sannidhata** (सन्निधाता) stores the treasury (**kosha** (कोष)). Never reverse collector and storekeeper.
17. **Rajuka** (रज्जुक) handled land and justice (pillar edicts). **Dhamma-mahamatras** (धम्म महामात्र) handled moral and welfare work (RE V).
18. Provincial princes (**kumara** (कुमार) / aryaputra) are classically posted at **Taxila, Ujjain, Suvarnagiri, and Tosali**. Kashi–Kosala–Vatsa sat in the imperial core, not as a separate kumara province label.
19. Kautilya's toolkit facts: **Saptanga** (सप्तांग) state limbs, **four vidyas** (विद्या), **four upayas** (उपाय), **18 tirthas** (तीर्थ), and **15 adhikaranas** (अधिकरण). Spies are **sanstha** (संस्था - stationary) and **sanchara** (संचारा - mobile).
20. Greek *Agronomai* in Megasthenes match rural **revenue / land** officers. **Pautavadhyaksha** (पौतवाध्यक्ष) is the weights official — a common wrong option.
21. Six city boards and six army boards in the Greek account cover crafts, foreigners, census, and military arms. They are parallel lists, not one board doing both jobs.
22. **Bhaga** (भाग) is the produce share. **Bali** (बलि) is an extra or religious levy. Rummindei notes remission of *bali* at Lumbini.

23. **Sudama** and **Lomas Rishi** (लोमश ऋषि) are Barabar cells; Lomas Rishi shows the famous horseshoe chaitya-arch facade.
24. UP Mauryan facts: Ahraura MRE (Mirzapur), Sarnath lions, Allahabad / Kaushambi pillar tradition, Meerut pillar moved by Firoz Shah, and Sankissa elephant capital.
25. **Bindusara** is remembered as **Amitraghata** (अमित्रघात - "slayer of foes") and held the empire between Chandragupta and Ashoka. Greek writers call him Amitrochates.
26. **Bherighosha** (भेरीघोष) is the war-drum. **Dhammaghosha** (धम्मघोष) is the dhamma-drum of RE IV / XIII — Ashoka's metaphor for moral conquest.
27. Major Rock Edicts are the **14**-edict set under the Piyadassi title. Minor Rock Edicts are local; Maski is the name-fact for "Ashoka."
28. Pillar Edict V lists protected animals. Rock Edict V creates dhamma-mahamatras. Same number, different medium and content.
29. Chandragupta Maurya (322 BCE founder) is not **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya** of the Gupta age.
30. Pushyamitra's coup in **185 BCE** ends Mauryan rule and begins Shunga power. Post-Ashoka decline had already weakened the periphery.
31. Kautilya's *Arthashastra* (अर्थशास्त्र) is the Sanskrit statecraft text. Megasthenes' *Indica* is the Greek outsider report. Use each for the questions it can answer.
32. Ashoka's empire neighbours in the far south stayed independent; edicts speak to them as border peoples, not as conquered Magadhan districts. **Sri Lanka (Tamraparni)** is a neighbour / mission land, **not** a Mauryan province.
33. **Sohgaura** (Gorakhpur, UP) and **Mahasthan** (महास्थान) (Bangladesh) are Mauryan famine / grain-store records. Mauryas did **not** make religious land grants as a system (that epigraphy starts with Satavahanas).
34. **Pranaya** (प्रणय) is the Mauryan **emergency** tax. **Sita** (सीता) is crown-land produce under the *sitadhyaksha* (सीताध्यक्ष). *Pankodakasannirodhe* (पंकोदकसन्निरोधे) is the penalty for fouling roads with mud and water.
35. Courts in the *Arthashastra*: **Dharmasthiya** (धर्मस्थीय - civil) and **Kantakashodhana** (कण्टकशोधन - criminal). The text also allows divorce in listed cases. **Manusmriti** (मनुस्मृति) blocks widow remarriage and calls non-conforming foreigners **fallen kshatriyas**.
36. **Vishnugupta** (विष्णुगुप्त) is Chanakya's other name (papers often treat it as the childhood / alternate identity). *Arthashastra* is compared with Machiavelli's *Prince*. *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) calls Chandragupta **Vrishal / Kulheen**; Dhundiraja wrote a commentary.
37. **Justin** remembers Sandrokottos meeting Alexander. **William Jones** first equated Sandrokottos with Chandragupta Maurya. Jain texts call Bindusara **Simhasena**; his mother is **Durdhara**.
38. City officials in *Indica* are **Astynomoi**. The caravan chief in the *Arthashastra* is **Sarthavaha** (सार्थवाह). Birth–death registration is one of the six municipal boards that still echoes modern municipal work.
39. Ashoka convened the **Third Buddhist Council** at **Pataliputra** about **250 BCE**. **Moggaliputta Tissa** presided; missions went to Kashmir–Gandhara and Sri Lanka (**Mahinda / Sanghamitta**). Edicts do **not** date the council.
40. After Bodh Gaya, Ashoka's traditional **dhamma yatra** circuit is **Lumbini → Kapilavastu → Bodh Gaya → Sarnath → Kushinagar → Shravasti**. **Rummindei** marks Lumbini; **Bhabru / Bairat** shows him as a Buddhist patron.
41. **Sanchi** (Raisen, MP) is the best-preserved early stupa core begun under Ashoka. **Bharhut** railings bloom mainly in the **Shunga** age — do not treat both as identical Ashokan art facts.
42. Mauryan **spies** (*gudhapurusha*) split into **sanstha** (stationary) and **sanchara** (mobile). The Gupta–Harsha ages do **not** run the same paid spy-state image.

📋 Must-score facts — kings, edicts, officials

King order

Chandragupta (322–297) → Bindusara Amitraghata (297–273) → Ashoka (c. 272/268–232) → … → Brihadratha (killed by Pushyamitra **185 BCE**)

Edict / title tags

Item	Lock
Devanampiya Piyadassi	Ashoka on edicts
Personal name “Ashoka”	**Maski** (मास्की), Gujarra, Nittur, Udegolam
RE XIII	**Kalinga war** (~261 BCE)
RE XII	**Samavaya** (religious concord)
RE V	**Dhamma-mahamatras** (14th year)
Scripts	Brahmi main; Kharoshthi at Shahbazgarhi / Mansehra; Greek–Aramaic at Kandahar
Barabar	Gifted to **Ajivikas**
Sarnath lions	National emblem
Ahraura (Mirzapur)	UP **Minor Rock Edict**

Official / tax tags

Term	Lock
Samaharta (समाहर्ता)	Collects revenue
Sannidhata (सन्निधाता)	Stores treasury (**kosha** (कोष))
Rajuka (रज्जुक)	Land / justice
Agronomai	Greek = rural revenue / land officers
Bhaga (भाग)	Produce share
Bali (बलि)	Extra / religious levy
Pranaya (प्रणय)	Emergency tax
Sita (सीता)	Crown-land produce

Kumara posts

Taxila · Ujjain · Suvarnagiri · Tosali

Neighbours (not provinces)

Chola · Pandya · Satiyaputra · Keralaputra · Sri Lanka (Tamraparni)

Topic 8 — Post-Mauryan India

Consolidated — 45 Must-Score Facts

1. The Mauryan empire ended in **185 BCE** when general **Pushyamitra Shunga** (पुष्यमित्र शुंग) killed the last Mauryan **Brihadratha**. The **Shungas** then ruled Magadha about **185–73 BCE**, and the short **Kanva** (कण्व) house followed about **73–28 BCE**.
2. Pushyamitra's **two ashwamedhas** are recorded in the **Ayodhya** (अयोध्या) inscription of Dhanadeva. That record is **not** Besnagar and **not** Hathigumpha.
3. Northwest invader order for the match paper is **Greeks → Sakas → Kushans**. Parthians often drop out of short lists, but they sit between Shakas and Kushans in the northwest belt.
4. **Hathigumpha** at Udayagiri (Odisha) belongs to **Kharavela** (खारवेल) of Kalinga, a Jain Mahameghavahana / Chedi king. Ashoka, Harsha, and Kanishka are the usual wrong options.
5. The **Besnagar** Garuda pillar is the **Heliodorus** Bhagavata dedication for **Vasudeva**. It is **not** Pushyamitra's ashwamedha record.
6. The **Satavahanas** were the Deccan / Andhra house. Tradition names **Simuka** as founder, and the capitals are **Pratishthana (Paithan)** and **Amaravati** (अमरावती).
7. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** (गौतमीपुत्र शातकर्णि) defeated Shaka **Nahapana** (नहपान) of the **Kshaharata** house. The victory is recorded in the **Nasik prasasti** of **Gautami Balashri**.
8. Satavahanas nurtured **Prakrit** and pushed **public Buddhist art** (Amaravati, Karle, Nasik). **Hala** wrote the Prakrit *Gatha Saptasati*. **Yajna Sri Satakarni** put a **ship** on coins as a sea-trade stamp.
9. After Satavahana decline, the **Ikshvakus** ruled coastal Andhra from **Nagarjunakonda** (नागार्जुनकोंडा). They are a post-Satavahana Andhra house, not the mythic Ayodhya Ikshvaku line.
10. Peninsula **megaliths** are Iron Age burials with **dolmens**, **cists**, and **hero stones**, often with **black-and-red ware** and iron. Classic sites include **Brahmagiri**, **Adichanallur**, and **Maski** (मास्की).
11. The greatest Indo-Greek name is **Menander (Milinda)**. His capital is **Sagala (Sialkot)**, and the *Milinda Panha* records his debate with **Nagasena** (नागसेन). Indo-Greeks also issued the first **portrait** die-struck coins in India.
12. The first Shaka king named in India is **Maues / Moga** at Taxila–Gandhara. **Nahapana** is the greatest **Kshaharata**; **Rudradaman I** is the greatest **Kardamaka**.
13. Rudradaman's **Junagadh / Girnar** inscription is the first long literary **Sanskrit** prose record in India. It tells how the **Sudarshana lake** was built under **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य), adorned under **Ashoka** (अशोक), and **repaired** by Rudradaman.
14. The brief Parthian / Pahlava bridge king is **Gondophares**. The northwest Buddhist site fact for this age is **Takht-i-Bahi**.
15. Kushans rise from the **Yuezhi**. **Kujula Kadphises** founds the house; **Vima Kadphises** floods India with imperial **gold**; **Kanishka** (कनिष्क) is the greatest ruler.
16. Kushan main capital is **Purushapura (Peshawar)**. **Mathura** (मथुरा) in Uttar Pradesh is the second great Indian centre. Art pairs **Gandhara** (गांधार) Greco-Buddhist schist with **Mathura** red sandstone.
17. Coaching keys peg Kanishka's accession to **78 CE**, the start of the **Shaka era**. Do **not** confuse it with **Vikrama Samvat 57 BCE**.
18. Kanishka convened the **Fourth Buddhist Council** in Kashmir at **Kundalvana**. **Vasumitra** is remembered as president, and **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) belongs to this age. Kanishka's title is **Devaputra** (देवपुत्र).
19. Sangam Tamilakam's **Muvendar** are **Chera** (bow), **Chola** (चोल) (tiger), and **Pandya** (fish). Capitals are **Vanji / Karur**, **Uraiyur**, and **Madurai** (मदुरै).
20. **Karikala** is the Sangam Chola who built the **Kallanai** on the Kaveri. He is **not** imperial **Rajaraja I** of Thanjavur.
21. Sangam seat tradition is **Madurai** under the Pandyas. Three assemblies: **1st Madurai** (Agastya / Tolkappiyar), **2nd Kapadapuram** (Agastya), **3rd Madurai** (**Nakkirar**). **Tolkappiyam** (तोल्काप्पियम्) is the earliest Tamil grammar. **Akam** is love poetry; **Puram** is war and kingship poetry.

22. Sangam ports fact as **Muziris** (Chera / Roman pepper), **Puhar** (Chola), and **Korkai** (Pandya pearl coast). West-coast Periplus ports also include **Tondi**, **Mushiri / Muziris**, and **Nelcynda**. **Arikamedu** (Periplus **Poduke**) yields Roman amphorae.
23. Later south dynasty matchs: **Mahendravarman I** (महेन्द्रवर्मन प्रथम) is **Pallava**; **Kadungon** is **Pandya**; **Amoghavarsha I** is **Rashtrakuta** (राष्ट्रकूट); **Rajaraja I** is **Chola**.
24. **Gandhara** art is Kushan northwest Greco-Buddhist. **Amaravati** art is Satavahana Andhra limestone narrative relief. Do not swap the schools.
25. Ashoka's Rock Edict II names Chola, Pandya, Keralaputra, and Satiyaputra as **independent neighbours**, not Mauryan provinces.
26. In Uttar Pradesh, **Ayodhya** is the Pushyamitra ashwamedha fact, and **Mathura** is the Kushan second capital and Mathura-art home.
27. **Patanjali** (पतंजलि) of the *Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य) and Kalidasa's (कालिदास) *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्) (Agnimitra (अग्निमित्र)) sit in Shunga-court tradition, but Buddhist books stay hostile to Pushyamitra even while Sanchi still grows. **Patanjali is Shunga-age — not Kanishka's court.**
28. Satavahana personal names are often **metronymic** (Gautamiputra, Vashishthiputra). After their decline, Deccan power thins toward the third century CE.
29. **Vima Kadphises** (Kadphises II) issues the first large-scale **gold** for regular use; title **Sarvalokeshvara**. **Kujula** mainly issues **copper**. **Kanishka** puts **Buddha** (बुद्ध) on coins.
30. **Rabatak** lists Kushan cities **Saketa, Kaushambi, Pataliputra, and Champa** — **not Shravasti**. Sarnath Kanishka Buddha image inscription is dated about **81 CE** (year 3 of his era).
31. Vikrama **57 BCE** and Shaka **78 CE** differ by **135 years**. Indian national calendar **Chaitra 1** matches **22 March** (21 March in a leap year).
32. **Ashvaghosha** (*Buddhacharita*, *Saundarananda*, *Sariputraprakarana* (शारिपुत्रप्रकरण)), **Vasumitra**, **Nagarjuna** (नागार्जुन), **Parsva**, and physician **Charaka** (चरक) adorn Kanishka's court. Chinese texts remember **Pan Chao** defeating Kanishka's force.
33. Kushans traded via the Persian Gulf and Red Sea (**Periplus**, Arikamedu evidence) but had **no** strong naval-force tradition. Child marriage custom is often dated from the **Kushan** (कुषाण) age.
34. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is **Ekabrahmana** / protector of the varna order (Nasik of Gautami Balashri). Satavahanas issue punch-marked, lead, copper, silver, potin — **not gold**. **Matsya Purana** gives the longest Andhra list (~30 kings).
35. Rudradaman's Junagadh is the earliest long literary **Sanskrit / kavya-style** prose. He repaired Sudarshana **without forced labour**. **Yaudheya** coins show **Kartikeya** with a peacock.
36. **Strato II** issued **lead** coins. **Agathocles** put **Sankarshana (Balarama) and Vasudeva** on bilingual coins. Gandhara sculpture often uses **green schist**; **Bamiyan** held colossal Buddha images.
37. Sangam titles for the king include **Kon**, **Ko**, and **Mannan**. The ordinary word *vendan* also means king.
38. Sage **Agastya** is remembered as having Aryanised the south and as the **Father of Tamil Literature**. **Tolkappiyar**, author of *Tolkappiyam*, is listed among Agastya's twelve disciples.
39. *Silappadikaram* (शिलप्पदिकारम्) is by **Ilango Adigal** (इलंगो अडिगल) (linked as grandson of Chola **Karikala**) and narrates **Kannagi** and **Kovalan**. *Tirukkural* (*Kural* / **Muppal**) by **Tiruvalluvar** (तिरुवल्लुवर) is called the Bible and **Laghuveda** of Tamil literature. *Ramavataram* (रामावतारम्) (Tamil Ramayana) is by **Kamban** (कंबन).
40. **Uraiyur** (also **Koli** / **Varanam**) on the Kaveri at Tiruchirappalli was the Sangam Chola capital and a major **cotton** centre in the *Periplus*.
41. Sanskrit *Yavanapriya* means **pepper** (काली मिर्च) — the Greek / Roman favourite spice. An **amphora** is the tall double-handled Roman jar for wine or oil found at Arikamedu.
42. **Vattakirutal** in Sangam poems is the defeated king's ritual suicide by **fasting unto death**.
43. Sangam literature names **Chera, Chola, and Pandya** only among the great houses. **Pallava** and **Kadamba** are **not** Sangam ruling dynasties in that corpus.

44. A **Pandya** king sent an ambassador to **Rome in 26 BCE**. Pandya heartland lies south of the Kaveri around **Madurai**; the river of that core is the **Vaigai** (some MCQ banks print it as "Vengi" — do not confuse with Eastern Chalukya **Vengi**).
45. **Udiyanjiral** belongs to the **Chera** line and is often treated as the first historical Chera of the Sangam age. Chera capital memory is **Vanji / Vanchi / Karuvur (Karur)**.

📋 Must-score facts — Shunga, Satavahana, Sangam, Kushan

House / inscription tags

Item	Lock
Pushyamitra Shunga	Kills Brihadratha **185 BCE**; two ashwamedhas (**Ayodhya** inscription)
Hathigumpha	**Kharavela** (Kalinga Jain)
Besnagar	**Heliodorus** Bhagavata pillar (≠ Pushyamitra)
Satavahana founder	**Simuka**; capitals **Pratishthana / Amaravati**
Gautamiputra	Defeats **Nahapana**; **Nasik** (नासिक) prasasti of Balashri
Hala	*Gatha Saptasati* (Prakrit)
Yajna Sri	**Ship** on coins
Ikshvakus	Post-Satavahana Andhra; **Nagarjunakonda**

Sangam Muvendar

Dynasty	Emblem	Capital
Chera	Bow	**Vanji / Karur**
Chola	Tiger	**Uraiyur**
Pandya	Fish	**Madurai**
Port	Lock	
------	------	
Muziris	Chera / Roman pepper	
Puhar	Chola	
Korkai	Pandya pearls	
Arikamedu	Periplus **Poduke**; Roman amphorae	

Karikala = Sangam Chola (**Kallanai**); ≠ imperial Rajaraja I.

Kushan quick tags

Item	Lock
Capitals	**Purushapura** + **Mathura**
Shaka era	**78 CE** (≠ Vikrama 57 BCE)
4th Council	Kashmir **Kundalvana**
Art	Gandhara + Mathura

Master Table — Ancient Indian Eras (संवत एवं काल-गणना)

(Tested in chronological arrangement & match-the-column questions)

Era Name (संवत)	Starting Year	Founder / Associated Event	Key Inscriptional / Historical Usage
Kali Era (कलि संवत)	**3102 BCE**	Traditional start of Kali Yuga (Mahabharata war end)	Mentioned in Aihole inscription of Pulakeshin II (634 CE)
Saptarshi / Laukika Era	**3076 BCE**	Cycle of 2,700 years (100 yrs per Nakshatra)	Prevalent in Kashmir (used by Kalhana in *Rajatarangini*)
Mahavira Nirvana Era	**527 BCE**	Nirvana of 24th Jain Tirthankara Vardhamana Mahavira	Core era used in Jain historical chronology
Buddha Nirvana Era	**483 / 544 BCE**	Mahaparinirvana of Gautama Buddha	Widely used in Sri Lankan chronicles (*Mahavamsa*, *Dipavamsa*)
Maurya Era	**322 BCE**	Coronation of Chandragupta Maurya	Used in select Jain & Greek references
Vikrama Samvat (विक्रम संवत)	**57 BCE**	King Vikramaditya of Ujjain (victory over Shakas); also called **Krita Era** (कृत संवत) or **Malava Era** (मालव संवत)	Most popular Hindu calendar era; difference from Shaka Era is **135 years** (57 + 78 = 135)
Shaka Samvat (शक संवत)	**78 CE**	Accession of Kushan Emperor **Kanishka I** (or Chashtana)	Adopted as **India's National Calendar** (22 March 1957; Chaitra 1); used in royal epigraphs across India
Kalachuri / Chedi Era	**248–249 CE**	Founded by Abhira King **Ishwarsena** / Traikutaka kings	Used by Kalachuris of Tripuri & Chedi dynasties
Gupta Samvat (गुप्त संवत)	**319–320 CE**	Coronation of **Chandragupta I** (*Maharajadhiraja*); identical to **Vallabhi Era**	Used in Gupta pillar inscriptions (Mathura, Sarnath, Eran)
Harsha Era (हर्ष संवत)	**606 CE**	Accession of King **Harshavardhana** of Kannauj/Thanesar	Used in Harsha's copper plates (Banskhera, Madhuban)
Hijri Era (हिजरी संवत)	**622 CE**	Migration (*Hijra*) of Prophet Muhammad from Mecca to Medina	Islamic lunar calendar; used throughout Medieval India
Kollam Era (कोल्लम संवत)	**825 CE**	Founded in Kerala (also called *Malayalam Era*)	Used in South Indian temple records and Kerala history
Chalukya-Vikrama Era	**1076 CE**	Founded by Western Chalukya King **Vikramaditya VI**	Replaced Shaka era in Chalukya empire; commemorated by poet Bilhana
Lakshmana Sena Era	**1119 CE**	Coronation of Sena King **Lakshmanasena** of Bengal	Used in Mithila (Bihar) and Bengal medieval records
Ilahi Era (इलाही संवत)	**1584 CE**	Promulgated by Mughal Emperor **Akbar** (retroactive to 1556)	Solar administrative calendar used in Mughal revenue records

Master Table — Ancient Indian Coinage & Metrology (प्राचीन भारतीय सिक्के)

(High-yield for coin types, metals, issuing dynasties, and symbols)

Coin Type / Dynasty	Primary Metals	Distinguishing Features & Motifs	Key Rulers / Canonical References
Punch-Marked Coins (*Aahat / Karshapana / Pana / Dharana*)	Silver & Copper	• **Earliest coins of India** (6th c. BCE Mahajanapadas & Mauryas) • Irregular shape, stamped with separate punches (sun, six-armed symbol, tree-in-railing, hill, bull) • **NO royal portraits, NO written legends**	Mentioned by Panini (*Ashtadhyayi*) & Kautilya (*Arthashastra*); *Lakhana-adhyaksha* (mint superintendent)
Indo-Greek Coins	Gold, Silver, Copper, Nickel	• **FIRST to issue GOLD coins in India** • **FIRST inscribed coins with ruler portraits & names** • Bilingual and biscript (Greek on obverse, Kharosthi/Brahmi on reverse)	**Menander I (Milinda)**, **Agathocles** (earliest depiction of Hindu deities: Vasudeva-Krishna & Balarama-Sankarshana)

Coin Type / Dynasty	Primary Metals	Distinguishing Features & Motifs	Key Rulers / Canonical References
Kushana Coins (*Dinar* / *Suvarna*)	Gold & Copper	• **FIRST LARGE-SCALE IMPERIAL GOLD COINAGE** with highest purity (equal to Roman Denarius) • Images of rulers in Central Asian coat & boots + multicultural deities (Shiva with Nandi/Trishula, Buddha, Oesho, Nana, Mihira) • Issued heavy copper coins for common daily circulation	• **Vima Kadphises**: first Kushan gold coins (*Sarvalokeshvara*) • **Kanishka I**: put image of **standing Buddha** with Greek legend *BODDO* • **Huvishka & Vasudeva I**
Satavahana Coins	**Lead (सीसा), Potin (पोटीन)**, Copper, Silver	• **NEVER ISSUED GOLD COINS** (high-frequency trap!) • Bilingual silver coins (*Gautamiputra Satakarni* restruck Nahapana's silver coins at Jogalthambi) • Distinctive motif: **Ship with double masts** representing active Indian Ocean maritime trade	**Yajna Sri Satakarni** (ship-type coins); **Gautamiputra Satakarni** (Jogalthambi hoard)
Yaudheya Coins (Tribal / Republican)	Copper & Bronze	• Issued by republican warrior clan of Punjab/Haryana/Rajasthan • Reverse shows **Karttikeya (Brahmanyadeva)** holding spear with peacock (*Mayura*), six-headed (*Shadanana*) • Legend: *Yaudheya Ganasya Jaya* ("Victory to the Yaudheya Republic")	UPPCS Special Mains 2008 Q14 (Yaudheyas = Karttikeya coins)
Gupta Coins (*Dinar* gold, *Rupaka* silver)	Gold, Silver, Copper	• **LARGEST NUMBER OF GOLD COINS** in ancient India (*Dinar*) • Elaborate artistic classical types: Archer type, Tiger-slayer, Lion-slayer, Ashwamedha type, Lyrist (Veena) type, King-and-Queen (*Chandragupta I & Kumaradevi*) • Silver coins (*Rupaka*) first issued by **Chandragupta II** after conquering Western Kshatrapas of Malwa/Saurashtra	• **Samudragupta**: Veena/Lyrist type & Ashwamedha type • **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya**: Lion-slayer & Silver Rupaka • **Kumaragupta I**: Karttikeya type & maximum number of hoards (Bayana hoard in Bharatpur, Rajasthan)

Topic 9 — Gupta Age

Consolidated — 40 Must-Score Facts

1. The imperial Gupta line runs **Sri Gupta** → **Ghatotkacha** → **Chandragupta I** → **Samudragupta** → **Chandragupta II** → **Kumaragupta I** → **Skandagupta**. Coaching often pegs Sri Gupta about **275 CE**; the imperial span is roughly **320–550 CE**, with capital **Pataliputra** (पाटलिपुत्र).
2. **Sri Gupta** and **Ghatotkacha** carry only the title **Maharaja** (महाराज). The first Gupta **Maharajadhiraja** (महाराजाधिराज) is **Chandragupta I**.
3. Chandragupta I married Lichchhavi princess **Kumaradevi**. The **king-and-queen** gold type belongs to this pair, and the Gupta era is usually pegged at **319–320 CE**.
4. **Samudragupta** is the digvijaya (**Digvijaya** / दिग्विजय) king. **V. A. Smith** called him the **Napoleon of India**. In the north he **uprooted** nine kings and annexed land; in the south he **defeated then restored** twelve kings as tribute.
5. The south matches are **Dhananjaya–Kusthalapura**, **Nilaraja–Avamukta**, **Ugrasena–Palaka**, and **Vishnugopa–Kanchi**. **Mahendra** is the Kosala king named in the Prashasti.
6. The **Prayag Prashasti** (प्रयाग प्रशस्ति) is **Harishena's** (हरिषेण) eulogy of Samudragupta, carved on the **Allahabad** (इलाहाबाद) Ashokan shaft. The prashasti is the **text**; the pillar is the **shaft**.
7. **Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya)** (विक्रमादित्य) ended the Western Kshatrapas (क्षत्रप) by defeating **Rudrasimha III**. He took the title **Sakari** (शकारि - destroyer of Shakas). **Ujjain** (उज्जैन) became a second pole while Pataliputra stayed the old capital.
8. The strongest Shaka-victory proof for Chandragupta II is his **silver** coins (**rupaka** / रूपक) weighing about **33 grains**. Gold dinaras (**dinara** (दीनार) / दीनार) are prestige types, not that proof.
9. **Fa-Hien** (फाह्यान) visited India about **399–414 CE** under Chandragupta II. Traveller order is **Fa-Hien** → **Hiuen Tsang** → **I-Tsing** → **Al-Biruni**.
10. **Kumaragupta I (Mahendraditya)** (महेन्द्रादित्य) is the traditional founder-patron of **Nalanda** (नालंदा). Chinese visitors later studied there; they did not found it.
11. **Skandagupta** is the last great imperial Gupta. The **Bhitari** pillar (Ghazipur, UP) records his **Huna** war, and he also repaired the **Sudarsana** lake at Girnar.
12. Gupta provinces are **bhukti** (भुक्ति) under an **uparika** (उपरिक). Districts are **vishaya** (विषय) under a **kumaramatya** (कुमारमात्य). Between them sits **vithi** (वीथि). The ladder is **Bhukti** → **Vishaya** → **Vithi** → **Grama** (भुक्ति → विषय → वीथि → ग्राम). The **sandhivigrahika** (संधिविग्रहिक) handles peace and war.
13. Gupta rule runs through **samantas** (सामंत) and land grants (**agrahara** / अग्रहार). It is **not** a Mauryan spy-state, and "Guptas more central than Mauryas" is the trap.
14. Gold coin types: **king-queen** = Chandragupta I; **lyrist / horse / battle-axe / tiger** = Samudragupta (about **six** famous gold types); **archer** = Chandragupta II; peacock types often mark **Kumaragupta I**.
15. **Nalanda** is Gupta (Kumaragupta I). **Takshashila** is the older Gandhara town. **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला) is Pala **Dharmapala** (धर्मपाल). **Vallabhi** is Maitraka Gujarat.
16. The classical **Sarnath Buddha** has a plain drape and halo. It is Gupta art, **not** Kushan **Gandhara** (गांधार) Greco-Buddhist sculpture.
17. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) belongs to the Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) court tradition. Plays (नाटक): *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्), *Vikramorvashiyam* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्). Mahakavyas (महाकाव्य): *Raghuvamsa* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव). Lyrics (गीतिकाव्य): *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार). *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) is **Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि), not Kalidasa.
18. Later author–book facts: **Trivikrama Bhatta** (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट)–*Nala Champu* (नल चम्पू), **Somadeva** (सोमदेव)–*Kathasaritsagara* (कथासरित्सागर), **Jayadeva** (जयदेव)–*Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद), **Kshemendra** (क्षेमेन्द्र)–*Brihatkathamanjari* (बृहत्कथामंजरी).
19. Science facts: **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote the *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय) and taught Earth's rotation; **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote the *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता); **Brahmagupta** (ब्रह्मगुप्त) describes cyclic quadrilaterals.

20. The **Mehrauli** iron pillar's "Chandra" is usually taken as **Chandragupta II** (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय). It stands as a **Vishnu dhvaja** on **Vishnupada**. **Udayagiri** (उदयगिरि) Varaha caves also sit in his reign.
21. Chandragupta II's daughter **Prabhavatigupta** married Vakataka **Rudrasena II** and later ruled as regent. Do not confuse Chandragupta II with Chandragupta Maurya.
22. The **Vishnu Purana** carries Maurya genealogy. The **Vayu Purana** does **not** give a usable Gupta system of governance.
23. **Bhitargaon** (भीतरगाँव) (Kanpur belt) is a Gupta-age brick temple in Uttar Pradesh. **Deogarh** (देवगढ़) Dashavatara is an early stone shikhara temple.
24. Gupta samvat and imperial titles start with Chandragupta I; Samudragupta's *kaviraja* (कविराज) pose is backed by the **lyrist / veena** gold type.
25. After Skandagupta the imperial centre thins through the sixth century. The next north reunion is **Harsha** (हर्ष), not another Gupta emperor.
26. Fa-Hien is two centuries earlier than Hiuen Tsang. Fa-Hien is Chandragupta II's witness; Xuanzang is Harsha's.
27. Ajanta's famous painted caves are largely **Vakataka** Deccan allies with Gupta-age style links, not the default Sarnath Gupta fact.
28. Land tax **bhaga** (भाग) / **udranga** (उद्रंग - fixed land tax) is remembered as about **1/6**. Irrigation dues appear as **udakabhoga** (उदकभाग). Forced labour **vishti** (विष्टि - unpaid forced labour / बेगार) is listed as a state take. Guilds (**shreni** (श्रेणी) / श्रेणी) kept their own rules under Gupta rule.
29. Samudragupta's frontier tribute includes Samatata, Davaka, Kamarupa, Nepala, and Karttripura; ganarajya tribute includes Malava, Yaudheya, Arjunayana, and Madraka.
30. Do not confuse **Chandragupta I** (Licchavi marriage founder) with **Chandragupta II** (Vikramaditya, Shaka silver), or either with **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य) (~322 BCE).
31. Chandragupta II's other names in Sanchi / Vakataka lore are **Devagupta**, **Devraja**, and **Devashri**.
32. The largest Gupta gold hoard is remembered from **Bayana** (Bharatpur, Rajasthan).
33. Fa-Hien remembers **cowries** in routine trade and a free **hospital / charity house at Pataliputra**.
34. First inscriptional **sati** memory is the **Eran** record of **~510 CE**, for the widow of commander **Goparaja**.
35. East trade door is **Tamralipti** (ताम्रलिप्ति); west trade door is **Bhrigukachchha (Bharuch)**. Textile centres include Gujarat, Bengal, Deccan, and Tamil country.
36. **Dashpur / Mandasor** silk-weavers' guild under **Bandhuvarman** (Kumaragupta I age) built and later repaired a **Sun** temple — often called India's earliest "advertisement" style record.
37. Vakataka **Pravarasena I** took the title **Samrat** (सम्राट), performed **four ashvamedhas**, and is the real early empire-builder after founder **Vindhyashakti**. **Pravarasena II** composed *Setubandha*.
38. Sri Lankan king **Meghavarman** sought Samudragupta's leave to build a Buddhist monastery at **Bodh Gaya** (बोधगया).
39. *Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्) by **Sudraka** (शूद्रक) is the urban love story of **Charudatta** (चारुदत्त) and **Vasantasena** (वसन्तसेना). Chess as **Chaturanga** (चतुरंग) is a Gupta-age culture note.
40. **Dhanvantari** (धन्वंतरि) is the Navaratna medicine name. **Bhaskara II** (भास्कर द्वितीय) (*Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Siddhanta Shiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि)) is **12th century**, not a Gupta contemporary.

📋 Must-score facts — kings, coins, admin, travellers

Imperial line

Sri Gupta → Ghatotkacha → Chandragupta I → Samudragupta → Chandragupta II → Kumaragupta I → Skandagupta

King	Tag
Chandragupta I	First **Maharajadhiraja**; Kumaradevi; era ~**319–320**

King	Tag
Samudragupta	Digvijaya; **Prayag Prashasti** (Harishena); Napoleon of India
Chandragupta II	**Vikramaditya / Sakari**; ends Western Kshatrapas; Fa-Hien
Kumaragupta I	**Nalanda** founder-patron
Skandagupta	Last great; **Bhitari** Huna war; Sudarsana repair

Coin types

Type	King
King–queen	Chandragupta I
Lyrist / horse / battle-axe / tiger	Samudragupta
Archer	Chandragupta II
Silver ~**33 grains**	Chandragupta II Shaka-victory proof
Peacock types	Often Kumaragupta I

Admin ladder

Bhukti (uparika) → Vishaya (kumaramatya) → Vithi → Grama

Term	Lock
Sandhivigrahika	Peace and war
Bhaga / udranga	Land tax ~**1/6**
Vishti	Forced labour

Traveller order

Fa-Hien → Hiuen Tsang → I-Tsing → Al-Biruni

South Prashasti matches

King	Place
Dhananjaya	Kusthalapura
Nilaraja	Avamukta
Ugrasena	Palaka
Vishnugopa	**Kanchi** (कांची)

Topic 10 — Post-Gupta Period

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. After the imperial Guptas break about **550 CE**, the **Hunas** are led first by **Toramana**, then by **Mihirakula** of **Sakala (Sialkot)**. **Yashodharman** of Malwa boasts the Huna check at **Mandasor** about **532 CE**. **Vasula** is remembered as composer of Yashodharman's Sondani / Sondhni record.
2. Regional houses to fact: **Pushyabhutis** at **Thanesar**, **Maukharis** at **Kannauj**, **Later Guptas** in Magadha, **Maitrakas** at **Valabhi** (वलभी), and **Gauda** under **Shashanka** at **Karnasuvarna**.
3. **Harsha** (हर्ष) of the **Pushyabhuti** house ruled **606–647 CE**. He is a post-Gupta reunion king, **not** a Gupta emperor. **Harsha-samvat** starts in **606 CE**. Founder-memory of the house is **Pushyabhuti**.
4. Early capital is **Thanesar (Sthaneshvara)** in Haryana. Later capital is **Kannauj (Kanyakubja)** in **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश).
5. Elder brother **Rajyavardhana** was killed by **Shashanka** of Gauda. Sister **Rajyashri** had married Maukhari **Grihavarman** of Kannauj; Harsha later rescued her and united the two houses.
6. Chinese title for Harsha is **Siladitya** (शीलादित्य). Family memory starts Shaiva; later he is a loud **Buddhist patron** while still hosting Brahmans. East ally is **Bhaskaravarman** of Kamarupa.
7. About **630–634 CE**, **Pulakeshin II** of Badami stopped Harsha at the **Narmada** (नर्मदा). The boast sits in the **Aihole** (ऐहोल) inscription of **Ravikirti** on the Meguti temple.
8. Harsha held the **Kannauj assembly** in **643** to honour Xuanzang, and the **Prayag Moksha-parishad / Mahamoksha** every five years for charity give-aways.
9. Harsha's copper-plate facts are **Banskhera** (with his signature) and **Madhuban**. The **Sonpat** seal is Pushyabhuti family. Hathigumpha is **not** Harsha — it is **Kharavela** (खारवेल).
10. After **647** there is no stable heir. The Chinese envoy **Wang Xuance** is attacked by **Arunashva** of Tirhut, and the north fragments again.
11. **Banabhatta** (बाणभट्ट) is Harsha's court poet from **Pritikuta** (Son bank, Bihar tradition / Shravasti belt in notes). He writes ornate Sanskrit prose, not Gupta-age verse drama like **Kalidasa** (कालिदास). *Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी) of Kalhana (कल्हण) also carries later Harsha-age memory.
12. *Harshacharita* (हर्षचरित) is Bana's prose **biography** of Harsha (**akhyayika**). *Kadambari* (कादंबरी) is his unfinished prose **romance** (**katha**), finished by tradition by son Bhushanabhatta.
13. **Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang)** was in India about **630–644**, studied at **Nalanda** (नालंदा) under **Shilabhadra**, and wrote the ***Si-Yu-Ki***. He is Harsha's Chinese witness, not Fa-Hien.
14. Traveller chronology: **Fa-Hien** (फाह्यान) (~399–414, Chandragupta II) → **Sung-yun** (~518–521) → **Hiuen Tsang** (ह्वेनसांग) (~630–644, Harsha) → **I-Tsing** (~671–695, after Harsha) → **Al-Biruni** (~1017).
15. Maukhari inscription facts: **Ishanavarman–Haraha** (Barabanki, UP, **554 CE**), **Ishvaravarman–Jaunpur** stone, **Jivitagupta II–Deo-Baranark**.
16. **Sarvavarman–Gaya copper plate** is **NOT** matched. The Gaya plate is Gupta / **Samudragupta** (समुद्रगुप्त). Sarvavarman's fact is the **Asirgarh** seal.
17. Harsha's administration reuses Gupta vocabulary: **uparika**, **mahasandhivigrahika** (महासांधिविग्रहिक), **mahapratihara**, and **bhandagaradhikarana** (भाण्डागाराधिकरण). He did **not** invent the Uparika.
18. The state is personal: **mahasamanta** (महासामंत) feudatories and agrahara grants continue, and the machine collapses when Harsha dies in **647**. Post-Gupta north shows clearer **feudal / lord–vassal land control** than Mauryan central pay.
19. Three plays often given to Harsha are *Nagananda* (नागानन्द), *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली), and *Priyadarshika* (प्रियदर्शिका). *Nagananda* carries the Buddhist flavour of the three.
20. **Rajyashri did not marry Dhruvasena** of Valabhi. She is Grihavarman's widow; Maitraka **Dhruvasena II** was restored as an ally.

21. Mihirakula's remembered seats include **Sakala**, the **Gwalior** inscription, and Kashmir memory in the *Rajatarangini*. Toramana appears on the **Eran** boar inscription.
22. Later Gupta **Adityasena** has the **Aphsad** inscription in Bihar. Maitraka founder-memory is **Bhatarka** at Valabhi.
23. Fa-Hien came mainly for **Vinaya** under Chandragupta II. Xuanzang came for **Mahayana** (महायान) texts under Harsha. Nalanda's founder-patron remains **Kumaragupta I**.
24. Do not confuse **Thanesar** (early Haryana capital) with **Kannauj** (later UP capital), or **Banabhatta** with **Kalidasa** (कालिदास).
25. The Narmada stop is **not** the Battle of Kannauj **1540** (Sher Shah / Humayun). It is Pulakeshin II's Chalukya check of Harsha.
26. After Harsha, the later Kannauj fight among Pratihara–Pala–Rashtrakuta belongs to early medieval; keep only a pointer here — full cards live in the Early Medieval Regional Kingdoms chapter.
27. Xuanzang notes **Mathura** for **cotton** textiles and **Varanasi** (वाराणसी) for **silk**. Thanesar's prosperity is remembered as trade-based.
28. Chinese writers call India **Yin-tu / Thian-tu**. Silk cloth in this age can appear as **kausheya**.
29. Post-Harsha credit notes remember **hundi** as a bill of exchange in trade.
30. **I-tsing** comes by sea after Harsha (~671–695), studies at Nalanda, and returns via Sumatra.
31. Nalanda's final medieval destruction is linked to **Bakhtiyar Khalji** (~1193) — Pala–Sena age, not Harsha's lifetime.
32. Shankaracharya's four maths and Chardham traps belong to Bhakti / Vedanta notes — do not merge them into Harsha's court card.
33. Harsha's moving royal camp is remembered as **skandhavara**. Administration reuses Gupta vocabulary; the state dies with the king in **647**.
34. **Pushyabhuti** house founder-memory is **Pushyabhuti**; Harsha's Chinese title is **Siladitya**. Do not call Harsha a Gupta emperor.

📋 Must-score facts — Harsha, travellers, houses

Regional houses after Guptas

House	Seat
Pushyabhuti	**Thanesar** → later **Kannauj**
Maukhari	**Kannauj**
Later Gupta	Magadha
Maitraka	**Valabhi**
Gauda (Shashanka)	**Karnasuvarna**
Huna	Toramana → **Mihirakula** (Sakala)

Harsha tags

Item	Lock
Reign	**606–647 CE**; Harsha-samvat **606**
Chinese title	**Siladitya**
Early capital	**Thanesar** (Haryana)
Later capital	**Kannauj** (UP)
Ally	**Bhaskaravarman** (Kamarupa)
Narmada stop	**Pulakeshin II**; **Aihole** (Ravikirti) ~630–634

Item	Lock
Assemblies	Kannauj **643**; Prayag Moksha every 5 years
Grants	**Banskhera** (signature); **Madhuban**
Court poet	**Banabhatta** — *Harshacharita* (bio); *Kadambari* (romance)
Plays	*Nagananda*, *Ratnavali*, *Priyadarshika*

Traveller chronology

Traveller	When / under
Fa-Hien	~399–414; Chandragupta II
Sung-yun	~518–521
Hiuen Tsang	~630–644; Harsha; *Si-Yu-Ki*; Nalanda / Shilabhadra
I-Tsing	~671–695; after Harsha
Al-Biruni	~1017

Maukhari inscription pairs

Ruler	Record
Ishanavarman	**Haraha** (Barabanki, UP, 554)
Ishvaravarman	**Jaunpur** (जौनपुर) stone
Jivitagupta II	**Deo-Baranark**
Sarvavarman	**Asirgarh** seal (≠ Gaya plate)

Topic 11 — Ancient Indian Administration

Consolidated — 36 Must-Score Facts

1. Political time-order for titles and inscriptions runs **Vedic rajan (राजन)** → **Magadha houses** → **Maurya** → **Shunga / Kharavela / Kushan / Satavahana** → **Gupta** → **Harsha**.
2. **Ashoka** on edicts is **Devanampiya Piyadassi** (देवानांप्रिय प्रियदर्शी). His personal name appears at **Maski** (and Gujarra, Nittur, Udegolam). **Bindusara** is **Amitraghata** (अमित्रघात).
3. **Chandragupta I** is the first Gupta **Maharajadhiraja** (महाराजाधिराज). **Chandragupta II** is **Vikramaditya** (विक्रमादित्य). **Harsha** is Chinese **Siladitya** (शीलादित्य). **Kanishka** is **Devaputra** (देवपुत्र).
4. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is **Dakshinapathapati** (दक्षिणापथपति). **Kharavela** is **Mahameghavahana** (महामेघवाहन). **Rudradaman I** is **Mahakshatrapa** (महाक्षत्रप). **Mahapadma Nanda** is **Ekarat / Sarvakshatrantaka** (एकराट् / सर्वक्षत्रान्तक).
5. **Hathigumpha** = **Kharavela**. **Ayodhya** (अयोध्या) = Pushyamitra's two **ashwamedhas**. **Besnagar** = Heliodorus, **not** Pushyamitra.
6. **Prayag Prashasti** (प्रयाग प्रशस्ति) = **Samudragupta** (समुद्रगुप्त) by **Harishena** on the Allahabad Ashokan shaft. **Aihole** (ऐहोल) = **Pulakeshin II** stopping Harsha.
7. **Girnar / Junagadh** rock carries three ages: **Ashoka**, then **Rudradaman** (रुद्रदामन), then **Skandagupta**.
8. **Sarvavarman–Gaya copper plate** is **NOT** matched. The Gaya plate is **Samudragupta**. Sarvavarman's fact is the **Asirgarh** seal.
9. Correct Maukhari / later pairs: **Ishanavarman–Haraha**, **Ishvaravarman–Jaunpur**, **Jivitagupta II–Deo-Baranark**.
10. Vedic **Bhagadugha** (भागदुघ) is the **revenue** collector of the king's share. **Akshavapa** (अक्षावाप) is the **dice / gambling** officer — the classic trap.
11. Vedic **Sabha** (सभा) is the smaller elder council. **Samiti** (समिति) is the larger tribal assembly. There is no Samaharta or Uparika in the Vedic list.
12. Mauryan **Samaharta** (समाहर्ता) collects revenue. **Sannidhata** (सन्निधाता) stores the treasury. Do not reverse collector and treasurer.
13. Megasthenes' **Agronomai** are Mauryan **revenue** officers. Weights belong to the *pautavadhyaksha* (पौतवाध्यक्ष); roads are the wrong option.
14. Ashoka appointed **dhamma-mahamatras** (धम्म महामात्र) in the **14th** year after coronation (RE V). The claim that dhamma's definition comes from the *Rahulovada-sutta* is **false**.
15. Gupta province is **bhukti** (भुक्ति) under **uparika** (उपरिक). District is **vishaya** (विषय) under **kumaramatya** (कुमारमात्य). **Sandhivigrahika** (संधिविग्रहिक) handles peace and war.
16. Harsha reuses Gupta titles at a higher grade: **mahasandhivigrahika** (महासांधिविग्रहिक), **mahapratihara** (महाप्रतिहार), **bhandagaradhikarana** (भाण्डागाराधिकरण), still with **uparika** (उपरिक). He invents no new machine.
17. Mauryan rule is **centralised** through salaried **amatyas** (अमात्य). Gupta and Harsha run a looser **samanta** (सामंत) (feudatory) system.
18. Kautilya's **saptanga** (सप्तांग) has seven limbs: swami (स्वामी), amatya (अमात्य), janapada (जनपद), durga (दुर्ग), kosha (कोष), bala (बल), and mitra (मित्र). Adhyakshas (अध्यक्ष) are department heads under that machine.
19. **Nasik prasasti** of Gautami Balashri records Gautamiputra against Nahapana. **Naneghat** records queen **Naganika** with Satakarni I.
20. **Mehrauli** (मेहरौली) iron pillar's "Chandra" is usually **Chandragupta II**. **Bhitari** pillar is **Skandagupta** versus the Hunas. **Banskhera** and **Madhuban** are Harsha grants.
21. Samudragupta's south contemporaries: **Dhananjaya–Kusthalapura**, **Nilaraja–Avamukta**, **Ugrasena–Palaka**, **Vishnugopa–Kanchi**.
22. Coin evidence ladder: punch-marked silver → Indo-Greek portraits → Kushan gold → Gupta dinara; Chandragupta II's **silver ~33 grains** proves the western Shaka victory.

23. The **Vishnu Purana** carries Maurya genealogy. The **Vayu Purana** does **not** throw light on Gupta governance.
24. **Rajuka** (रज्जुक) is Mauryan district land and justice. **Uparika** (उपरिक) is Gupta provincial governor. Do not swap the ages.
25. Best king ID order is **inscription first**, then coins, then Puranas. Foreign accounts (Megasthenes, Fa-Hien, Xuanzang, I-tsing) sit beside that ladder.
26. **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य) is Greek **Sandrokottos** (~322 BCE). He is **not** Chandragupta I or Chandragupta II of the Gupta house.
27. **Rummindei** (रुम्मिनदेई) pillar records Ashoka's Lumbini visit. **Rabatak** gives Kanishka genealogy. **Haraha** (554 CE) is Maukhari Ishanavarman in Barabanki, UP.
28. Title inflation grows from Gupta grants onward. **Chakravartin** (चक्रवर्ती) is the ideal wheel-turning monarch, not one king's exclusive stamp; a feudatory is **samanta / mahasamanta** (सामंत / महासामंत).
29. Vedic core officers are **purohita** (priest-adviser), **senani** (army), and **gramani** (village head), beside **bhagadugha / sangrahitri / akshavapa**. There is no Samaharta or Uparika in the Vedic list.
30. Vedic **Vidatha** is the oldest kin-ritual gathering and fades first. **Sabha** becomes more exclusive; **Samiti** remains the broader tribal body in Early Vedic memory.
31. Mauryan provinces (*pradesha / chakra*) place royal princes (**kumara / aryaputra**) at **Taxila, Ujjain, Suvarnagiri, and Tosali**. Village stack runs empire → province → *ahara/vishaya* → *sthanika / gopa* → village.
32. Mauryan revenue language: **bhaga** (produce share), **pindakara** (pasture), **sulka** (tolls). **Samaharta** collects; **Sannidhata** stores; ***pautavadhyaksha*** does weights.
33. Mauryan spies (*gudhapurusha*) include secret agents, wandering ascetics, and household informers — a **centralised** watch. Gupta–Harsha lean on **samanta** ties instead.
34. Gupta ladder is **Bhukti (uparika)** → **Vishaya (kumaramatya)** → **Vithi** → **Grama**. Land grants thicken as **agrahara / brahmadeya**. Harsha reuses the same titles at **maha-** grade.
35. Foreign administration witnesses: **Megasthenes** (*Indica*) for Mauryas; **Fa-Hien** for Chandragupta II; **Xuanzang** for Harsha; **I-tsing** after Harsha. Use each for the age it saw.
36. Harsha's state is **personal**: **mahasamanta** feudatories and agrahara grants continue, and the machine collapses when he dies in **647**. Post-Gupta north shows clearer lord–vassal land control than Mauryan central pay.

📋 Must-score facts — titles, inscriptions, officials

Title ↔ ruler

Title	Ruler
Devanampiya Piyadassi (देवानांप्रिय प्रियदर्शी)	**Ashoka**
Amitraghata (अमित्रघात)	**Bindusara**
Maharajadhiraja (महाराजाधिराज) (first Gupta)	**Chandragupta I**
Vikramaditya (विक्रमादित्य)	**Chandragupta II**
Siladitya (शीलादित्य)	**Harsha**
Devaputra (देवपुत्र)	**Kanishka**
Dakshinapathapati (दक्षिणापथपति)	**Gautamiputra Satakarni**
Mahameghavahana (महामेघवाहन)	**Kharavela**
Mahakshatrapa (महाक्षत्रप)	**Rudradaman I**
Ekarat / Sarvakshatrantaka (एकराट् / सर्वक्षत्रान्तक)	**Mahapadma Nanda**
Sandrokottos	**Chandragupta Maurya**

Inscription ↔ owner

Inscription	Lock
Hathigumpha	**Kharavela**
Ayodhya	Pushyamitra **ashwamedhas**
Besnagar	**Heliodorus** (≠ Pushyamitra)
Prayag Prashasti	**Samudragupta** / Harishena
Aihole	**Pulakeshin II** vs Harsha
Junagadh / Girnar	Ashoka → Rudradaman → Skandagupta
Nasik prasasti	Gautamiputra vs Nahapana
Bhitari	**Skandagupta** vs Hunas
Mehrauli iron pillar	Usually **Chandragupta II**
Banskhera / Madhuban	**Harsha**
Rummindei	Ashoka at Lumbini
Haraha	Maukhari **Ishanavarman**

Official ↔ age

Official	Age / role
Bhagadugha (भागदुघ)	Vedic revenue
Akshavapa (अक्षावाप)	Vedic dice (trap)
Samaharta (समाहर्ता)	Mauryan collector
Sannidhata (सन्निधाता)	Mauryan treasurer
Agronomai	Mauryan rural revenue (Greek)
Rajuka (रज्जुक)	Mauryan land / justice
Uparika (उपरिक)	Gupta province
Sandhivigrahika (संधिविग्रहिक)	Gupta / Harsha peace–war

Topic 12 — Ancient Indian Economy

Consolidated — 36 Must-Score Facts

1. Economy match ladder: **Indus = Urban**, **Rigvedic = Pastoral**, **Later Vedic = Agrarian**, and the medieval slot is **landlordism**. The Indus uses weights and seals but has **no coins**.
2. Vedic **nishka** (निष्क) is a gold unit or ornament. It is **not** a minted coin. The first Indian coins are **punch-marked silver** from about the sixth century BCE (**karshapana / pana** / कार्षापण या पण - आहत सिक्के).
3. Mauryas keep punch-marks and also issue **cast copper**. The weights officer is the ***pautavadhyaksha*** (पौतवाध्यक्ष).
4. **Indo-Greeks** bring the first **portrait** die-struck coins, with Greek and Kharoshthi legends. Portraits do **not** begin with the Guptas.
5. **Vima Kadphises** and the **Kushans** make gold coinage common in India. Gupta **dinara** (दीनार) is later prestige gold named through the Roman *denarius* path.
6. Gupta gold types: **king-queen** = Chandragupta I; **lyrist / horse** = Samudragupta; **archer** = Chandragupta II. Gold often weighs about **120–144 grains**.
7. Chandragupta II's Shaka-victory proof is **silver** (*rupaka* / रूपक) coins of about **33 grains**. Gold dinara is the trap option.
8. **Yajna Sri Satakarni** put a **ship** on some Satavahana coins as a Deccan sea-trade stamp.
9. Early trade texts and archaeology both show **river-ports** and large **entrepots** (warehouse / redistributor hubs). An entrepot is not "any landing point."
10. **Shreni** (श्रेणी) is the general craft or trade guild headed by a **shreshthin** (श्रेष्ठिन्) or **jyeshthaka** (ज्येष्ठक). **Nigama** (निगम) is a merchant association; **Sarthavaha** (सार्थवाह) is the caravan leader. **Nagaram** (नगरम) is a south Indian town merchant body.
11. **Manigrama** (मणिग्रामम) is the **foreign / overseas** trade institution. **Nanadesi** (नानादेशी) means merchants of many lands, but the foreign-trade key is still **Manigrama**.
12. **Lothal** is the Harappan **dockyard** (गोदीबाड़ा). Boat models come from **Mohenjo-daro and Lothal**, not from Dholavira alone.
13. Periplus west ports: **Barygaza** is **Broach** (Narmada mouth); **Barbarikon** is the **Indus-mouth** port — do not swap them.
14. **Tamralipti** (ताम्रलिप्ति) at the Ganga mouth faces the Bay of Bengal. **Muziris (Muchiri)** on the Malabar is the Roman **pepper** (काली मिर्च) port.
15. Inland highways: **Uttarapatha** (उत्तरापथ) runs Taxila toward **Pataliputra**; **Dakshinapatha** (दक्षिणापथ) runs from the Ganga belt through **Ujjain** (उज्जैन) into the Deccan. Dakshinapatha is a **road**, not "only sea."
16. Roman trade peaks about the first to third centuries CE. The ***Periplus of the Erythraean Sea*** is the coastal handbook; **Pliny** complains of a **gold drain** to India.
17. Sangam poems call western foreign traders **Yavana** (यवन). **Arikamedu** near Puducherry yields Roman amphorae and related ware; the *Periplus* calls it **Poduke**.
18. Punch-marked silver carries geometric and animal punches — **no royal portrait**. Common marks include sun, six-armed symbol, hill, elephant, bull, and tree-in-railing.
19. Later Vedic dues appear as **bali** (बलि) and **bhaga** (भाग). From the mahajanapada age, towns, **NBPW**, and punch-marked silver travel with long-distance trade.
20. **Sopara** (शूर्पारक) and **Kalyan** on the Konkan run from Mauryan times onward. **Puhar / Kaveripattinam** is the Sangam Chola port at the Kaveri mouth. **Uraiyur** is the Sangam Chola capital and a **cotton** centre.
21. Pepper, cotton, ivory, pearls, and gems leave Indian ports; **horses**, wine, gold, and glass are famous western imports. Sailors use **monsoon** reversal. Sanskrit ***Yavanapriya*** (यवनप्रिय) means **pepper** (काली मिर्च).
22. East-coast **Tamralipti** is **not** the main Roman door. The pepper–gold circuit centres on Malabar and Broach.
23. Gupta markets still use silver and copper for daily exchange even while gold dinaras advertise imperial prestige.

24. The **Ainnurruvar** (“500”) are a later south merchant network. They are not a Mauryan guild label.
25. Harappan west end on the Makran is **Sutkagen-dor**. Harappan sea traffic runs toward the Gulf from Lothal and the Makran coast.
26. After the Guptas, imperial gold thins. Roman **aurei** in south Indian hoards remain pepper-trade bullion evidence, not Gupta mintage.
27. Guild custom is treated as usable law in the *Arthashastra* (अर्थशास्त्र), and Sanchi–Bharhut gifts name shrenis — so shreni is **not** “only foreign trade.”
28. Economy type changes by age: pastoral cattle wealth in the Rigveda, agrarian dues later, then coin-and-town trade from the sixth century BCE onward.
29. An **amphora** is a tall Roman jar with a long neck and **two handles**, used for wine or oil — a classic Arikamedu find type.
30. **Tagara** sat on the inland trade route connecting **Kalyan** with **Vengi**.
31. Land dues begin as Vedic **bali** and **bhaga**. Mauryan *Arthashastra* keeps **bhaga** (often about one-sixth): **Samaharta** collects, **Sannidhata** stores.
32. Forced labour appears as **vishti**. Gupta copper-plates thicken **brahmadeya** and **agrahara** holdings; feudatory **samanta** tribute sits beside the old share tax.
33. Under Harsha, agrahara grants continue and the moving royal camp is remembered as **skandhavara**. Land-grant thickening bridges Mauryan salaried collection toward post-Gupta feudal land control.
34. East-bound maritime memory runs from **Tamralipti** toward **Suvarnabhumi** (Southeast Asia). That eastern door is **not** the Roman pepper circuit of Muziris and Barygaza.
35. Gupta markets still use **silver and copper** for daily exchange even while gold **dinara** advertise prestige. After the Guptas, imperial gold thins.
36. UP economy nodes: **Varanasi** (textile / Ganga river-port), **Kaushambi** (Uttarapatha), later **Kannauj** (Harsha-age entrepot). **Alamgirpur** is IVC east fringe — **not** a sea-port.

📋 Must-score facts — coins, ports, guilds

Coin ladder

Stage	Lock
Indus	Weights / seals; **no coins**
Vedic nishka	Gold ornament / unit; **not minted**
Punch-marked silver	First coins (~6th c. BCE); **karshapana / pana**
Indo-Greek	First **portrait** die-struck coins
Kushan (Vima)	Gold coinage becomes common
Gupta dinara	Prestige gold (~120–144 grains)
Chandragupta II silver	~**33 grains** = Shaka-victory proof
Yajna Sri Satakarni	**Ship** on coins

Economy type ladder

Indus = Urban · Rigvedic = Pastoral · Later Vedic = Agrarian · Medieval = landlordism

Master Table — Ancient Indian Ports & Maritime Entrepôts (प्राचीन भारतीय पत्तन)

(Categorized by Coast, River Basin, Ancient/Periplus names, and Key Trade Commodities)

Port Name (प्राचीन पत्तन)	Periplus / Classical Name	Coast / Modern State	River / Geographical Location	Key Commercial Role & Commodities
Lothal (लोथल)	—	Gujarat (Gulf of Khambhat)	Bhogavo river, Saurashtra	World's earliest tidal **dockyard** (गोदीबाड़ा); Harappan bead factories & Persian Gulf seal
Barbaricum / Barbarikon	*Barbarike*	Sindh (Pakistan)	Indus river mouth	Trade terminus for Central Asian goods, lapis lazuli, turquoise, silk
Barygaza / Bharuch (भृगुकच्छ)	*Barygaza*	Gujarat (Gulf of Khambhat)	Narmada river mouth	**Chief western entrepôt** of India; terminus of Dakshinapatha; export of cotton, onyx, agates, spikenard
Sopara / Surparaka (शूर्पारक)	*Souppara*	Maharashtra (North Konkan)	Near Mumbai / Vaitarna river	Ancient port since Buddhist/Mauryan times (Ashokan Edicts found here); trade with Arabia & Egypt
Kalyan (कल्याण)	*Calliena*	Maharashtra	Ulhas river / Thane Creek	Major Satavahana naval & commercial port mentioned in *Periplus*
Chaula / Chemula	*Saimur / Chaul*	Maharashtra	Alibag / Revdanda Creek	Prominent port connecting Deccan with Persian Gulf & Red Sea
Tyndis / Tondi (तोंडी)	*Tyndis*	Kerala (Malabar Coast)	Ponnani / Kadalundi river mouth	Sangam **Chera kingdom** port; transshipment point for Roman ships
Muziris / Muchiri (मुज़िरिस)	*Muziris*	Kerala (Malabar Coast)	Periyar river mouth (Kodungallur)	**Greatest Roman pepper emporium** (*Yavanapriya*); temple of Augustus built by Roman merchants
Nelcynda & Bacare	*Nelkynda / Bakare*	Kerala / Pandya border	Meenachil / Pamba river basin	Spices, tortoiseshell, pearls; deep-water anchorage for Roman freighters
Korkai (कोरकई)	*Colchoi*	Tamil Nadu (Gulf of Mannar)	Tambraparni river mouth	Sangam **Pandya capital & port**; world-famous **pearl fisheries** (*Muthu*)
Alagankulam	—	Tamil Nadu (Palk Strait)	Vaigai river mouth	Excavated Roman rouletted ware, coins of Roman Emperor Arcadius & Valentinian
Arikamedu (अरिकामेडु)	*Poduke*	Puducherry (Coromandel Coast)	Ariyankuppam river lagoon	**Indo-Roman trading station**; huge yields of Roman *amphorae* (wine jars), *Arretine ware*, glass beads
Kaveripattinam / Poompuhar	*Khabiris Emporion / Puhar*	Tamil Nadu (Coromandel Coast)	Kaveri river mouth	Sangam **Chola chief port**; described vividly in *Silappadikaram* and *Manimekalai*
Motupalli (मोटुपल्ली)	*Mutfili*	Andhra Pradesh	Prakasam district	**Kakatiya dynasty** port; famous *Abhaya Shasana* (charter of security) by Ganapatideva; visited by **Marco Polo**
Machilipatnam / Maisolia	*Maisolia*	Andhra Pradesh	Krishna delta	Famous in *Periplus* for manufacture and export of exceptionally fine **muslin** (*Maslin*)
Dantapura / Palur (दन्तपुर)	*Paloura*	Odisha (Ganjam Coast)	Rushikulya river mouth	Chief Kalinga port; direct sailing point for merchant ships bound for **Suvarnabhumi** (SE Asia)
Tamralipti / Tamluk (ताम्रलिप्ति)	*Tamalites*	West Bengal (Bay of Bengal)	Rupnarayan river (Ganga delta)	**Supreme eastern gateway** of ancient India; embarkation port for Southeast Asia, Sri Lanka, and China; visited by Faxian, Xuanzang, and Yijing

Master Table — Ancient Merchant Guilds & Trade Corporations (व्यापारिक श्रेणियां एवं निगम)

(Tested in administrative and economic history questions — UPPCS 2018, 2022, 2024)

Guild / Body (संस्था)	Nature & Operational Scope	Geographic Sphere	Key Characteristics & Powers
Shreni (श्रेणी)	Occupational guild of artisans or merchants of the **same profession**	Pan-India	Headed by **Shreshthin** (or *Jyeshthaka*); had judicial powers over members; maintained own militia (*Shrenibala*); accepted fixed deposits and paid interest
Nigama (निगम)	Guild organization / assembly of merchants of **varied professions**	Urban centres / market towns	Issued own coins and tokens in Post-Mauryan period (e.g., Kausambi, Taxila); functioned as town corporation
Sarthavaha (सार्थवाह)	Leader of mobile caravan traders (*Sartha*)	Long-distance trade highways (*Uttarapatha*, *Dakshinapatha*)	Managed logistics, security, and provisions for caravan merchants travelling across deserts, forests, and borders
Manigrama / Manigramam	Guild of traveling merchants engaging in **inland and overseas trade**	South India (Tamil Nadu, Kerala) & **Southeast Asia**	Formed in Sangam/Pallava era; set up trade enclaves abroad; recorded in the 9th-century **Takua Pa inscription** (Thailand)
Ayyavole 500 / Nanadesi (*Ainnurruvar*)	"The Five Hundred Lords of Aihole" — premier **trans-national merchant corporation**	Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Sri Lanka, Sumatra (Indonesia), Myanmar	Symbolized by tiger/bull; operated armed mercantile convoys across the Indian Ocean; patronized temples and civic works
Anjuvannam (अंजुवण्णम्)	Guild of **foreign / West Asian merchants** (Jews, Christians, Muslims, Persians)	Malabar & Coromandel coasts (Kerala, TN)	Autonomous trading privileges granted by royal charters (e.g., **Jewish Copper Plates of Cochin** to Joseph Rabban, 1000 CE; **Quilon Syrian Plates** to Mar Sapir Iso)
Valanjiyar (वलंजियर)	Martial merchant community / trading corporation	South India & Ceylon	Often associated with the Ayyavole 500; traded in jewels, spices, and fine textiles; maintained martial guards
Nagaram (नगरम)	Local assembly of resident merchants in market towns	Chola Empire (Tamil Nadu)	Handled urban local administration, commercial dispute resolution, and trade tax collection for the crown

Topic 13 — Archaeology

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. The **Archaeological Survey of India** was founded in **1861** under Viceroy Canning. The first Director-General was **Alexander Cunningham**.
2. ASI headquarters is **24 Tilak Marg, New Delhi**. It is **not** Lucknow; Lucknow holds UP State Archaeology and the State Museum.
3. **John Marshall** (DG 1902–1928) **announced** the Indus civilization to the world in **1924**. **Mortimer Wheeler** (DG 1944–1948) brought the **balk-and-grid** method and re-dug Harappa in **1946** — he did **not** discover IVC.
4. **Stratigraphy** (स्तरिकी) is relative dating by layers: in an undisturbed stack, **deeper is older**. A **balk** is the uncut wall left so layers can still be read.
5. **Carbon-14** is absolute dating invented on **Willard Libby's** path. Half-life is about **5730 years**. It works only on **organic** samples (charcoal, bone, wood, seed, shell) — not bare stone or metal.
6. **Daya Ram Sahni** opened **Harappa** in **1921**. **R.D. Banerjee** opened **Mohenjo-daro** (मोहनजोदड़ो) in **1922**. Marshall announced; Wheeler re-dug later.
7. **S.R. Rao** excavated **Lothal** and its dockyard. **B.B. Lal** excavated **Kalibangan** (कालीबंगा). **R.S. Bisht** excavated **Dholavira** (धोलावीरा).
8. **V.S. Wakankar** established **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) rock-art prehistory in **1957–58**. Bhimbetka is in **Madhya Pradesh**, not Uttar Pradesh.
9. **Sanauli** (सनौली) (Baghpat, UP), excavated in **2018**, yielded copper **chariots**, coffins, and antenna swords in a Late Harappan / OCP setting.
10. Boat **models** come from **Mohenjo-daro and Lothal**. Dholavira is not that boat-model pair.
11. Prehistoric site–state facts: **Nevasa–Maharashtra**, **Isampur–Karnataka**, **Didwana–Rajasthan**, **Gudiyam–Tamil Nadu**.
12. Harappan site–state facts: **Balu–Haryana**, **Manda–Jammu & Kashmir**, **Padri–Gujarat**, **Hulas–Uttar Pradesh**.
13. Uttar Pradesh Harappan trio: **Alamgirpur** (आलमगीरपुर) (Meerut, Hindon), **Hulas** (हुलास) (Saharanpur), and **Mandi** (मंडी) (Muzaffarnagar).
14. **Alamgirpur** is the **easternmost** Harappan site in India. **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी) (Haryana) is the largest mound — it is **not** UP and **not** the eastern edge.
15. **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar, UP) is **not Manda** (Chenab belt, J&K). Mixing the two names is a frequent trap.
16. UP IVC questions often want **Mandi and Hulas** together and reject **Rakhigarhi**. Hulas also appears with Alamgirpur in older UP pairs.
17. Other UP trenches: **Koldihwa / Mahagara** (Belan, early rice claim), **Hastinapur** (हस्तिनापुर) (PGW), **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी), **Ahichchhatra**, **Sarnath** (सारनाथ), **Shravasti**, **Atranjikhera**.
18. **Robert Bruce Foote** at **Pallavaram** in **1863** first recognised Indian Paleolithic tools.
19. A find is useful only **in situ**, still in its layer. Looting kills the date. Typology sits beside stratigraphy as another relative clock.
20. Fired pottery can use **thermoluminescence (TL)** instead of C-14. That is a different clock and a different sample.
21. After 1947 the giant IVC cities Harappa and Mohenjo-daro lie in Pakistan. Indian trenches shift to Gujarat, Haryana, Rajasthan, Punjab, and **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश).
22. Monument law sits under the **AMASR Act 1958**. Antiquities export sits under the **1972** Act. Field units are ASI **Circles**; HQ remains New Delhi.
23. **Mehrgarh** (मेहरगढ़) (Balochistan) is pre-Harappan farming and is **not** an Indian-state match option.
24. Rock shelter vs cave: Bhimbetka is an overhang **rock-shelter** complex, not a hollow cave system wording.
25. Relative dating answers "older / younger." Absolute dating answers calendar years. Stratigraphy alone cannot give "2600 BCE."

26. Cunningham used Chinese pilgrim routes to hunt Buddhist sites such as Sarnath, Sanchi, and Bharhut — Survey foundation, not IVC discovery.
27. Mature Harappan chronology near **about 2600–1900 BCE** rests on absolute clocks plus pottery and stratigraphy, not "guesswork from bricks."
28. Site is the place with remains; **excavation** is the dig. Papers ask present **state / UT** for site matching, not the excavator's birthplace.
29. Doab pottery clock: **Late Harappan / OCP → PGW → NBPW**. **OCP** pairs with Copper Hoards; **PGW** is Later Vedic; **NBPW** rises with second urbanisation / Mauryan cities.
30. **Megalithic** burials with large stones belong mainly to the Iron-age **south**. They are not a Harappan city label.
31. Signature Harappan cards: **Rakhigarhi** (largest in India, Haryana); **Dholavira** (reservoirs + signboard, R.S. Bisht); **Kalibangan** (plough + fire altars, B.B. Lal); **Banawali** (fortified Haryana town); **Surkotada** (horse-bone debate).
32. **Thermoluminescence (TL)** dates fired pottery or bricks by asking when the object was last heated. Use relative methods to order a trench; use C-14 or TL when the stem wants a calendar band.
33. **Typology** matches pottery and tool shapes across sites as another relative clock beside stratigraphy.
34. UP trenches beyond the Harappan trio: **Koldihwa / Mahagara** (Belan rice), **Hastinapur** (PGW / OCP), **Kaushambi**, **Ahichchhatra**, **Sarnath**, **Shravasti**, **Atranjikhera**, **Sanauli** (Baghpat chariots).

📋 Must-score facts — ASI, dating, site↔state

ASI / method tags

Item	Lock
ASI founded	**1861**; first DG **Alexander Cunningham**
HQ	**24 Tilak Marg, New Delhi** (not Lucknow)
John Marshall	Announced IVC **1924**
Mortimer Wheeler	Balk-and-grid; re-dug Harappa **1946** (≠ discoverer)
Stratigraphy	Deeper = older (undisturbed)
Carbon-14	Libby; ~**5730** yr half-life; **organic** only
TL	Fired pottery clock

Excavator ↔ site

Excavator	Site
Daya Ram Sahni	Harappa **1921**
R.D. Banerjee	Mohenjo-daro **1922**
S.R. Rao	**Lothal**
B.B. Lal	**Kalibangan**
R.S. Bisht	**Dholavira**
V.S. Wakankar	**Bhimbetka** (MP) **1957–58**
Robert Bruce Foote	Pallavaram Paleolithic **1863**

Site ↔ state (high-yield)

Site	State / UT
Nevasa	Maharashtra
Isampur	Karnataka

Site	State / UT
Didwana	Rajasthan
Gudiyam	Tamil Nadu
Balu	Haryana
Manda	J&K
Padri	Gujarat
Hulas	**Uttar Pradesh**
Alamgirpur	**UP** (easternmost Harappan)
Mandi	**UP** (≠ Manda J&K)
Rakhigarhi	Haryana (largest; not UP)
Sanauli	Baghpat, UP (chariots **2018**)

UP trenches (beyond IVC)

Koldihwa / Mahagara · Hastinapur · Kaushambi · Ahichchhatra · Sarnath · Shravasti · Atranjikhera

Topic 14 — Ancient India Miscellaneous

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. The four Old World Bronze urban cores are **Mesopotamia**, **Egypt**, **Indus** (सिंधु), and **Shang China**. Iron-Age Greece, Rome, and Persia belong to a later bucket.
2. **Mesopotamia** sits on the **Tigris–Euphrates**, runs competing **city-states**, writes **cuneiform** on clay, and builds stepped **ziggurat** temple-towers — not tombs.
3. **Egypt** sits on the **Nile**, is a unified **pharaoh** monarchy, writes **hieroglyphs** on papyrus, and builds **pyramid** royal tombs.
4. **Indus / Harappan** Mature phase is about **2600–1900 BCE**. Signatures include grid streets, baked brick, drains, and standard weights. The script is still **undeciphered**.
5. Mesopotamia knew the Indus land as **Meluhha**. Harappans built neither ziggurats nor pyramid tomb-fields and left no named pharaoh.
6. **Shang China** on the **Yellow River** uses readable **oracle-bone** script and ritual bronze **ding** vessels. Unlike the Indus script, Shang writing **is** read.
7. Puranas are post-Vedic smriti encyclopaedias shaped mainly in the Gupta age and after. Count fact is **18 Mahapuranas** and **18 Upapuranas**.
8. A Mahapurana is supposed to carry **panchalakshana**: sarga, pratisarga, vamsha, manvantara, and vamshanucharita.
9. The **Vishnu Purana** (विष्णु पुराण) preserves a **Mauryan** (मौर्य) genealogy. The **Matsya Purana** (मत्स्य पुराण) gives the longest **Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन) list. The **Vayu Purana** (वायु पुराण) lists Gupta **kings** but does **not** give a usable Gupta system of governance.
10. Puranic **Shriparvatiya** means the **Ikshvakus** of **Nagarjunakonda / Vijayapuri**. Trap options include Vakataka, Shaka, and Kharavela.
11. Indian materialism in the is **Charvaka / Lokayata** (चार्वाक). The only accepted pramana is **pratyaksha** (प्रत्यक्ष) (perception). It denies lasting soul, karma fruit, rebirth, and Veda authority.
12. **Charvaka ≠ Charaka**. Charaka is the Ayurveda compiler; Charvaka is the materialist school. Mixing the names is the cheap trap.
13. *Charaka Samhita* has **120 chapters** in **8 sections**. **Sushruta** (सुश्रुत) is the surgery fact; Charaka is internal medicine.
14. Buddhism is **not** materialist: it keeps **karma and rebirth** while denying a permanent soul. That is a different denial from Charvaka.
15. The **Kakatiyas** rose as Western Chalukya feudatories and became independent in Telangana. Early seat is **Hanamkonda**; match-paper capital is **Warangal (Orugallu)**.
16. Capital match set: **Pallava–Kanchi**, **Pandya–Madura**, **Yadava–Devagiri**, **Kakatiya–Warangal**.
17. Kakatiya ruler order is **Prola II → Rudradeva → Ganapati Deva → Rudrama Devi → Prataparudra II**. Prataparudra II is the **last** king, not the founder.
18. **Rudrama Devi** ruled as a reigning queen under the male throne-name **Rudradeva Maharaja**. She is Ganapati's daughter, not a Chola queen.
19. **Warangal–Ramchandra Dev** is **NOT** matched. Ramachandra is the **Yadava** of **Devagiri**. Warangal's last Kakatiya is **Prataparudra II**.
20. Delhi pressure: **Malik Kafur** took tribute at Warangal in **1310**; the dynasty fell in **1323** to Ulugh Khan under **Ghiyasuddin Tughluq**.
21. **Thousand Pillar Temple** at Hanamkonda belongs to **Rudradeva** (tradition **1163**). It is **not** inside Warangal fort.
22. **Ramappa (Rudreshwara) Temple** at **Palampet** (Telangana) was built in **1213** under Ganapati's general Recharla Rudra and became **UNESCO** World Heritage in **2021**.

23. Historiography book facts: **Jayaswal–Hindu Polity**, **Basham–Wonder that was India**, **Kosambi–Introduction to the Study of Indian History**, **Smith–Early History of India**.
24. Ziggurat is a stepped **temple**; pyramid is a royal **tomb**. Cuneiform is clay wedges; hieroglyphs are picture signs.
25. Harappan cities look corporate — standard brick, weak palace skyline — while Egypt is tomb-centred and Mesopotamia is temple-centred and war-prone.
26. Ganapati Deva issued the **Motupalli** abhaya-shasana safety-charter for sea merchants; Marco Polo later calls the port **Mutfili**.
27. Kakatiya polity used **nayankara** chiefs who held land, raised troops, and remitted revenue. Court language was **Telugu** and **Sanskrit**, with mainly Shaiva temple religion.
28. Purana Qila in Delhi is a **fort** name, not a Sanskrit Purana text. Use Puranas as genealogy supplements to inscriptions, not as year-perfect chronicles.
29. Ajita Kesakambalin in the Pali canon is a materialist neighbour of Charvaka thought. Nyaya is **Gautama**; Vaisheshika is **Kanada** — neither is Charvaka.
30. Shang ends with Zhou conquest; Harappan cities **thin out** around **1900 BCE**; Egypt shows unusual dynastic continuity — decline is not one shared story.
31. **Meluhha** in Mesopotamian texts is commonly linked with the Indus. Harappan Gulf trade sits with **Dilmun / Magan** memory — not a named UP river dock.
32. **Ajivika** doctrine centres on **Makkhali Gosala** and fatalist **niyati**. Barabar caves were gifted to Ajivikas under Ashoka's age — not to Buddhists.
33. **Upapuranas** are the eighteen minor Puranas beside the eighteen Mahapuranas. Use Puranas as genealogy supplements to inscriptions, not as year-perfect chronicles.
34. *Charaka Samhita* is internal medicine; **Sushruta** is surgery. **Charvaka ≠ Charaka** remains the cheap name trap beside both cards.

📋 Must-score facts — world civs, Puranas, Kakatiya

Old World Bronze cores

Civilization	Lock
Mesopotamia	Tigris–Euphrates; **cuneiform**; **ziggurat** (temple)
Egypt	Nile; hieroglyphs; **pyramid** (tomb)
Indus	~2600–1900 BCE; grid / drains; undeciphered script
Shang China	Yellow River; readable **oracle-bone** script

Purana / philosophy tags

Item	Lock
Mahapuranas	**18** (+ 18 Upapuranas)
Vishnu Purana (विष्णु पुराण)	Preserves **Mauryan** (मौर्य) genealogy
Matsya Purana (मत्स्य पुराण)	Longest **Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन) list (~30 kings)
Vayu Purana (वायु पुराण)	Gupta **kings**; does **not** give usable Gupta governance
Shriparvatiya	**Ikshvakus** of Nagarjunakonda
Charvaka / Lokayata	Perception only; denies soul / karma fruit
Charaka	Ayurveda (*Charaka Samhita* **120** ch / **8** sections) ≠ Charvaka
Sushruta	Surgery fact

Kakatiya tags

Item	Lock
Capital	**Warangal (Orugallu)**; early **Hanamkonda**
Order	Prola II → Rudradeva → Ganapati → **Rudrama Devi** → Prataparudra II (last)
Rudrama	Reigning queen as **Rudradeva Maharaja**
Thousand Pillar Temple	Hanamkonda; **Rudradeva** (~1163)
Ramappa Temple	Palampet **1213**; UNESCO **2021**
Fall	Tribute to Malik Kafur **1310**; end **1323**
Motupalli	Ganapati sea-merchant charter (*Mutfili* in Marco Polo)

Capital match set

Dynasty	Capital
Pallava	Kanchi
Pandya	Madurai
Yadava	Devagiri
Kakatiya	**Warangal**

Historiography books

Author	Book
Jayaswal	*Hindu Polity*
Basham	*Wonder that was India*
Kosambi	*Introduction to the Study of Indian History*
Smith	*Early History of India*

Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Prehistoric & Protohistoric UK

Consolidated — 24 Must-Score Facts

1. Uttarakhand rock art cluster: **Lakhudiyar** (Almora, Suyal), **Gwarkha Udyar** (Chamoli, Alaknanda), **Hudli** (Uttarkashi — **blue** pigment), **Kimni** (Chamoli — light white weapons/cattle), **Luethap** and **Falsima** (Almora), **Phadkanauli / Petshal** (Almora, Yashodhar Mathpal).
2. **Lakhudiyar** ("One Lakh Caves") at Barechhina, Almora, on the **Suyal** was found by **M. P. Joshi** in **1968**. Motifs use **red, black, and white**; interlocking-hand dance figures are the signature.
3. **Hudli** on the Kamal river in **Uttarkashi** is the only UK prehistoric site famous for **blue-colour** rock paintings.
4. **Gwarkha Udyar** at Dungri, Chamoli, on the **Alaknanda**, found by Rakesh Bhatt, shows vivid red animal depictions.
5. **Kimni** (Pindar valley, Chamoli) uses **light white** pigment for weapons and cattle. **Luethap** (Almora) shows blood-red group dancing. **Falsima** shows yogic / dancing postures and cup-marks (*Okhal*).
6. **Phadkanauli** and **Petshal** (Almora) were recorded by **Yashodhar Mathpal** (1989–90) with ochre dance motifs.
7. **Malari** (Chamoli) was first reported by **Shiv Prasad Dabral** in **1956** and excavated by HNB Garhwal University (**B. M. Khanduri**, 1983 and 2001).
8. Malari master finds: **5.2 kg gold funerary mask**, complete Himalayan **Zebu** bull skeleton, bronze chalices, and fine grey pottery linked to **Swat Valley** grave culture of the 2nd millennium BCE.
9. **Bankot** (Pithoragarh, 1989) yielded **8 copper anthropomorphs** of the Gangetic **Copper Hoard** family — not a Harappan dockyard find.
10. **Bahadrabad** (Haridwar) was excavated **1951–53** by **Y. D. Sharma** and yields Copper Hoards with **OCP**.
11. **Naula Jainal** (Almora) has megalithic **cist-burials** recorded by M. P. Joshi.
12. **Kalsi** Ashokan Rock Edict sits at the **Yamuna–Tons** confluence in **Dehradun**, in **Prakrit** language and **Brahmi** script (**257 BCE**). It proves Mauryan reach into the central Himalayan foothills.
13. Protohistoric UK memory is **rock art → copper hoards / OCP → megalithic cists → Mauryan Kalsi**. Do not collapse all of these into one "Stone Age only" label.
14. Malari's Swat-style pottery points to Himalayan–NW cultural contact. It is **not** a Mature Harappan grid-city.
15. Bankot anthropomorphs belong with doab **Copper Hoard** culture, not with Kuninda silver coins.
16. Lakhudiyar is Almora / Suyal — not Uttarkashi. Hudli's blue pigment is the Uttarkashi trap key.
17. Gwarkha is Chamoli / Alaknanda — do not move it to Almora.
18. Kalsi is an **Ashokan** rock edict, not a Gupta or Katyuri copper plate.
19. Malari gold mask weight (**5.2 kg**) and Zebu skeleton are the two high-yield Malari tags.
20. Bahadrabad = Haridwar Copper Hoard / OCP; Bankot = Pithoragarh anthropomorphs — keep district and find type separate.
21. Cup-marks (*Okhal*) at Falsima are a rock-art / ritual surface fact, not a burial inventory.
22. Mathpal's Almora survey sites (Phadkanauli, Petshal) sit beside Joshi's Lakhudiyar discovery — two different discovery tags.
23. National Stone Age facts (Bhimbetka, Belan) are **not** UK substitutes; UKPCS pulls the local site–district–pigment matrix.
24. After Kalsi, the next historic UK layers are tribes → Kuninda / Yaudheya → Brahmapura / Taleshwar → Kartikepur (Katyuri).

Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Ancient Tribes

Consolidated — 22 Must-Score Facts

1. Ancient ethnic wave order in Uttarakhand: **Kol (Munda) → Kirat (Kinnar) → Khas → Shakas / Kushanas**.
2. **Kol** are the earliest inhabitants in Dabral's scheme — Munda affinity, totemism, snake / linga worship.
3. **Kirat** defeated the Kols; epic memory has Shiva testing Arjuna in Kirat guise at **Bilvakedar**. Direct descendants remembered as **Raji**.
4. **Khas** entered via Central Asia / Kashmir and are classed as degraded Kshatriyas in Manusmriti memory. They become the dominant ancient hill race.
5. Khas customary laws: **Ghar-Javai** (son-in-law in wife's house), **Tekwa** (widow / woman keeps a companion without formal wedding), **Jethon** (extra ancestral share to eldest son), **Dev-Dasi / Dhol-Chhad** (dedicating daughters to shrines).
6. Shaka / Kushana presence in the hills is read through **Sun temples** — **Katarmal** (Almora), Palothi, Madh.
7. In **1967**, five communities were notified as Scheduled Tribes of Uttarakhand: **Tharu, Jaunsari, Bhotia, Buksa, and Raji**.
8. **Tharu** are the largest ST by population (Udham Singh Nagar: Khatima, Sitarganj). They observe Diwali as **Shok Parva** (mourning), offering rice and meat cakes to ancestors.
9. **Jaunsari** are second-largest (Dehradun: Chakrata, Kalsi, Tyuni). Polyandry tradition and **Mahasu Devta** worship are signature tags.
10. **Bhotia** are trans-Himalayan traders (Johar, Darma, Byans, Niti, Mana) practising transhumance and Indo-Tibetan barter.
11. **Raji (Van Rawat / Van Raji)** are the smallest ST, Askot–Didihat belt of Pithoragarh; cave overhangs (*Rauthiyada*) and historic **silent trade** (*Mook Vyapar* with *Theki* bowls).
12. **Buksa (Bhoksa)** of the Terai (Bazpur, Kashipur, Ramnagar) claim descent from **Mewar Rajputs**.
13. Do not swap **Kol** (earliest) with **Khas** (dominant later race). Do not swap **Kirat** epic identity with modern **Jaunsari**.
14. **Raji** silent trade is not the same as **Bhotia** Indo-Tibetan caravan trade.
15. Tharu **Shok Parva** is mourning Diwali — not a festival-of-lights stem.
16. Katarmal Sun Temple is an Almora **Shaka-wave** culture tag, not a Katyuri capital fact.
17. ST notification year **1967** and the five names are a fixed list — do not add Chand or Rajput hill houses into that five.
18. Jaunsari heartland is Chakrata–Kalsi–Tyuni (Dehradun), not US Nagar Terai.
19. Bhotia valleys (Johar / Darma / Byans / Niti / Mana) are high-altitude trade corridors, not Terai wet-rice belts.
20. Kol → Kirat → Khas chronology is the ethnic spine; Shaka / Kushana is the next foreign cultural layer, not a fifth ST.
21. National tribe lists are not UK substitutes — UKPCS asks the local wave order and the 1967 five.
22. Pair this chapter with prehistoric rock art and Kuninda coins; do not merge Khas customary law into Katyuri admin titles.

Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Kuninda & Yaudheya

Consolidated — 24 Must-Score Facts

1. **Kuninda (Kulinda)** are the first historic dynasty of the central Himalayan foothills, about **2nd century BCE to 3rd century CE**.
2. Epic identity: Mahabharata king **Subahu** of Subahupur (Srinagar tradition); hailed as **Dwij Srestha**.
3. Greatest Kuninda monarch is **Amoghbhuti** (1st century BCE) — the **only** Kuninda king to mint **silver** as well as copper.
4. Amoghbhuti coins are **bi-scriptural**: obverse **Brahmi**, reverse **Kharoshthi**; motifs include Goddess Lakshmi, deer, and tree-in-railing.
5. Three Kuninda coin series: **Amoghbhuti Type** (bilingual silver/copper), **Almora Type** (pure copper, local named kings), **Chhatreshwar / Shiva Type** (late Kushana-influenced Shiva with trident).
6. Almora Type names eight rulers including **Shivdatt, Shivpalit, Haridatt, Gomitra, Aashadh, Mrigbhuti, Vijayabhuti** — single Brahmi script, British Museum holdings.
7. Chhatreshwar Type legend memory: *Bhagavata Chhatreshwara*; standing Shiva with **trishula-parashu**.
8. **Yaudheya** are a martial *Ayudhajivi Gana*. Hill hoards appear at **Jaunsar-Bawar, Bhadraj, and Lansdowne**.
9. Yaudheya coin motifs: **Karttikeya** with peacock and Goddess Devsena; legend *"Yaudheya Ganasya Jaya"*.
10. **Brahmapura** is the 6th–7th century hill kingdom recorded by **Hiuen Tsang** (*Po-lo-hih-mo-pu-lo*), ruled by **Paurava / Vrishavardhan** tradition.
11. Xuanzang (about **634 CE**) visited Haridwar (*Mo-yu-lo* / Mayapura) and noted Brahmapura's **female monarch / Suvarnagotra / Stree Rajya** memory.
12. **Taleshwar copper plates** (Almora) record Paurava grants (Dvijavardhan, Vishnuvardhan) to God **Biraneswar** and name officials such as **Kottapala** and **Pratihara**.
13. Do not swap **Kuninda Amoghbhuti silver** with **Yaudheya Karttikeya copper**. Do not swap **Brahmapura** with later **Kartikeyapura**.
14. Amoghbhuti bilingual = Brahmi + Kharoshthi. Almora Type = copper + Brahmi only.
15. Yaudheya are a **gana**, not a Kuninda royal house. Their UK fact is hill **coin hoards**, not a capital list like Sangam Madurai.
16. Taleshwar plates are **Paurava / Brahmapura** epigraphy — not Pandukeshwar Katyuri plates.
17. Hiuen Tsang's UK name for the Kumaon hill entity in the famous stem is **Brahmapura**, not Kartikeyapur.
18. Subahu / Dwij Srestha is the **epic** Kuninda tag; Amoghbhuti is the **coin** tag.
19. Chhatreshwar Type is late / Shiva-devotional — after Amoghbhuti's bilingual peak.
20. Karttikeya on Yaudheya coins is the peacock-bearing war god — not a Katyuri temple-builder name.
21. Official titles on Taleshwar plates (*Kottapala*, *Pratihara*) foreshadow later Katyuri admin vocabulary without making Pauravas into Katyuris.
22. Kuninda span ends by about the 3rd century CE; Brahmapura / Paurava is the next early historic epigraphic layer.
23. Pair national Post-Mauryan NW coinage with this chapter — UKPCS still wants Almora / Jaunsar findspots.
24. Next chapter is **Kartikepur (Katyuri)** — Joshimath → Baijnath — after Brahmapura memory.

Uttarakhand — Topic 4 — Kartikepur Dynasty

Consolidated — 26 Must-Score Facts

1. **Kartikepur / Katyuri** is the first historic imperial kingdom of Uttarakhand, about **740–1050 CE**.
2. First capital is **Joshimath (Kartikeyapura)** in the Alaknanda valley (Garhwal). Second capital is **Baijnath (Katyur Valley)** on the Gomti in Bageshwar (Kumaon).
3. Capital shift Joshimath → Baijnath is remembered for harsh winters, landslides, and Tibetan pressure — not a Chand conquest story.
4. Founder tradition is **Basantandev (Basu Dev)** with the title *Parama-bhattaraka Maharajadhiraja*.
5. Three dynastic houses: **Basantandev House** → **Nimbar House** → **Salonaditya House**.
6. **Ishtaganadeva** (Nimbar house) is the first monarch to politically **unify** Garhwal and Kumaon; he built Durga / Mahishamardini temples at Joshimath.
7. **Lalitsuradeva** is the most powerful builder-king; Pandukeshwar plates (21st–22nd regnal years) compare him to **Varaha** and **Bhagiratha**.
8. Primary epigraphy: **Bageshwar stone inscription** of **Bhuwandev** and **four Pandukeshwar copper plates** (two of Lalitsuradeva, one of Padmata, one of Subhiksharajadeva).
9. Bageshwar inscription gives Nimbar genealogy and land gifts to **Vyaghreswar** (Bageshwar) Shiva.
10. Tyrannical last king is **Bir Dev (Biram Dev)**, overthrown by local uprising. Post-Katyuri branches: **Askot (Rajbars), Doti (Raiykas), Dwarahat, Baijnath**.
11. Official language / script: **Sanskrit** with **Kutila / Siddhamatrika**.
12. Admin titles: **Mahasamanta**, **Kottapala** (forts/passes), **Doshaparadhika** (investigator), **Dandapashika / Dandanayaka** (penal justice), **Bhogika** (revenue), **Saulkika** (tolls), **Tarika / Ghattapala** (ferries), **Khadgika** (bodyguard), **Pratihara**, **Kishorvadhabhikrit** (horses).
13. **Doshaparadhika** investigates crime; **Dandapashika** enforces punishment — do not swap.
14. Temple heritage: **Baijnath** complex (Gomti–Garur confluence; green-schist Parvati), **Jageshwar Dham** (124+ temples), **Dwarahat** ("Khajuraho of the Hills"), **Katarmal Sun Temple** (Almora; wood-carved doors in National Museum).
15. Architectural style: Himalayan **Phamsana / Shikhara** and Nagara ashlar with snow-resistant canopies.
16. **Kartikeyapura ≠ Brahmapura**. Kartikeyapura = Katyuri capital line; Brahmapura = 6th–7th century Xuanzang / Taleshwar entity.
17. **Basantandev** = founder; **Ishtaganadeva** = unifier; **Lalitsuradeva** = greatest builder — three different jobs.
18. Bageshwar = stone inscription of Bhuwandev; Pandukeshwar = copper plates near Joshimath (Chamoli).
19. **Bir Dev** ends Katyuri power; **Somchand** begins Chand dynasty in Kali Kumaon — keep the succession pair straight.
20. Taleshwar plates can carry Paurava / early Katyuri land-grant memory — read the stem for which dynasty is asked.
21. Katarmal Sun Temple is Almora temple heritage (Katarmal Deva, 9th century) — also appears in Shaka-wave tribe notes.
22. Nimbar house order for ratta: Nimbar → Ishtaganadeva → Lalitsuradeva → Bhuwandev.
23. Salonaditya house includes Padmata and Subhiksharajadeva of the Pandukeshwar plate set.
24. Katyuri bureaucracy models Gupta–Harsha titles (*mahasamanta*, *pratihara*) on a Himalayan fort-and-toll landscape.
25. UKPCS frequently asks Hiuen Tsang's **Brahmapura** vs Katyuri **Kartikeyapur** — that pair is the capital-name trap of this desk.
26. After Katyuri fragmentation, full medieval cards live under Medieval India `uttarakhand/` (Kattyuri / Chand).